Miraculous Occurrences

881. 起死回生 qǐ sǐ huí shēng
Literal: Raise dead return life
Idiomatic: Bring back to life; miraculous recovery; resurrection
Example: 医生的精湛技术起死回生，救了病人。(The doctor's superb technique brought the patient back to life.)

882. 化腐朽为神奇 huà fǔ xiǔ wéi shén qí
Literal: Transform rotten decay into divine wonder
Idiomatic: Transform the worthless into something wonderful; work miracles
Example: 他能化腐朽为神奇，让破旧的房子变得美丽。(He can work miracles, making old broken houses beautiful.)

883. 点石成金 diǎn shí chéng jīn
Literal: Touch stone become gold
Idiomatic: Turn stone into gold; work magic; transform worthless into valuable
Example: 他的创意点石成金，让普通产品变得抢手。(His creativity works magic, making ordinary products highly sought after.)

884. 逢凶化吉 féng xiōng huà jí
Literal: Meet fierce transform lucky

Idiomatic: Turn ill luck into good; turn danger into safety; miraculous escape
Example: 虽然遇到困难，但他总能逢凶化吉。(Although encountering difficulties, he can always turn ill luck into good.)

885. 绝处逢生 jué chù féng shēng
Literal: Desperate place meet life
Idiomatic: Find way out in desperate situation; miraculous escape; last-minute rescue
Example: 在绝处逢生的关键时刻，救援队赶到了。(At the critical moment of miraculous escape, the rescue team arrived.)

886. 死里逃生 sǐ lǐ táo shēng
Literal: Death inside escape life
Idiomatic: Escape from death; narrow escape; miraculous survival
Example: 地震中他死里逃生，非常幸运。(He had a narrow escape in the earthquake, very fortunate.)

887. 九死一生 jiǔ sǐ yī shēng
Literal: Nine deaths one life
Idiomatic: Narrow escape from death; barely survive; miraculous survival

Example: 这次手术九死一生，医生尽了全力。(This surgery was a narrow escape from death, doctors did their best.)

888. 劫后余生 jié hòu yú shēng
Literal: Calamity after remaining life
Idiomatic: Survive a disaster; life after catastrophe; survivor
Example: 劫后余生的他更加珍惜生活。(As a survivor of disaster, he cherishes life even more.)

889. 凤凰涅槃 fèng huáng niè pán
Literal: Phoenix nirvana
Idiomatic: Phoenix reborn from ashes; dramatic transformation; renewal
Example: 公司经历困难后如凤凰涅槃，重新崛起。(After experiencing difficulties, the company rose again like a phoenix from ashes.)

890. 浴火重生 yù huǒ chóng shēng
Literal: Bathe fire rebirth
Idiomatic: Reborn from fire; rise from ashes; transformation through adversity
Example: 经历挫折后，他浴火重生，变得更坚强。(After experiencing setbacks, he was reborn from fire and became stronger.)

Unprecedented Situations

891. 破天荒 pò tiān huāng
Literal: Break heaven wasteland
Idiomatic: Break new ground; unprecedented; first time ever
Example: 他破天荒地主动道歉了。(Unprecedentedly, he took the initiative to apologize.)

892. 开天辟地 kāi tiān pì dì
Literal: Open heaven split earth
Idiomatic: Create the world; groundbreaking; epoch-making
Example: 这项发明具有开天辟地的意义。(This invention has groundbreaking significance.)

893. 翻天覆地 fān tiān fù dì
Literal: Overturn heaven cover earth
Idiomatic: Earth-shaking; radical transformation; complete change
Example: 改革开放带来了翻天覆地的变化。(Reform and opening brought earth-shaking changes.)

894. 惊天动地 jīng tiān dòng dì
Literal: Startle heaven move earth
Idiomatic: Earth-shattering; sensational; momentous

Example: 这个消息惊天动地，震惊了全世界。(This news was earth-shattering, shocking the whole world.)

895. 石破天惊 shí pò tiān jīng
Literal: Stone break heaven startle
Idiomatic: Earth-shattering; astounding; shocking revelation
Example: 他的发言石破天惊，让所有人震惊。(His speech was earth-shattering, shocking everyone.)

896. 闻所未闻 wén suǒ wèi wén
Literal: Hear place not heard
Idiomatic: Unheard of; unprecedented; never heard before
Example: 这种现象闻所未闻，值得研究。(This phenomenon is unheard of and worth studying.)

897. 见所未见 jiàn suǒ wèi jiàn
Literal: See place not seen
Idiomatic: Never seen before; unprecedented sight; novel
Example: 这样的奇观见所未见，令人叹为观止。(Such wonders are never seen before, amazing to behold.)

898. 匪夷所思 fěi yí suǒ sī
Literal: Not barbarian place think
Idiomatic: Inconceivable; beyond imagination; unthinkable

Example: 他的行为匪夷所思，让人无法理解。(His behavior is inconceivable and incomprehensible.)

899. 不可思议 bù kě sī yì
Literal: Not can think discuss
Idiomatic: Inconceivable; unimaginable; incredible
Example: 这个结果不可思议，超出了所有人的预期。(This result is inconceivable, exceeding everyone's expectations.)

900. 天方夜谭 tiān fāng yè tán
Literal: Heaven square night tale
Idiomatic: Arabian Nights tale; fantastic story; incredible
Example: 他说的话如天方夜谭，没人相信。(What he said was like Arabian Nights tales, nobody believed it.)

📐 MEASUREMENT & COMPARISON (901-930)

Standards and Benchmarks

901. 标准答案 biāo zhǔn dá àn
Literal: Standard answer
Idiomatic: Standard answer; benchmark solution; model response

Example: 这道题有标准答案，不能随意回答。(This question has a standard answer, can't answer arbitrarily.)

902. 金科玉律 jīn kē yù lǜ
Literal: Gold rule jade law
Idiomatic: Golden rule; inviolable law; sacred principle
Example: 诚实守信是商业的金科玉律。(Honesty and trustworthiness are golden rules of business.)

903. 准绳规矩 zhǔn shéng guī jǔ
Literal: Standard rope compass square
Idiomatic: Standard and rules; criteria and regulations; guidelines
Example: 做事要有准绳规矩，不能随心所欲。(Doing things must have standards and rules, can't act at will.)

904. 量体裁衣 liàng tǐ cái yī
Literal: Measure body tailor clothes
Idiomatic: Tailor to fit; suit to circumstances; customize
Example: 制定政策要量体裁衣，因地制宜。(Making policies should be tailored to fit and adapted to local conditions.)

905. 对症下药 duì zhèng xià yào
Literal: Face symptoms prescribe medicine
Idiomatic: Prescribe right medicine; targeted solution;

appropriate remedy
Example: 解决问题要对症下药，找准根源。(Solving problems requires targeted solutions, finding the root cause.)

906. 度德量力 dù dé liàng lì
Literal: Measure virtue weigh strength
Idiomatic: Assess one's virtue and capability; know one's limitations
Example: 接受任务前要度德量力，量力而行。(Before accepting tasks, must assess one's capability and act within one's means.)

907. 权衡利弊 quán héng lì bì
Literal: Weigh balance profit harm
Idiomatic: Weigh pros and cons; balance advantages and disadvantages
Example: 做决定前要权衡利弊，慎重考虑。(Before making decisions, must weigh pros and cons and consider carefully.)

908. 衡量标准 héng liáng biāo zhǔn
Literal: Weigh measure standard
Idiomatic: Measurement standard; criteria for evaluation; benchmark
Example: 成功的衡量标准因人而异。(Standards for measuring success vary from person to person.)

909. 一视同仁 yī shì tóng rén

Literal: One view same person

Idiomatic: Treat equally; same standard for all; impartial

Example: 好老师对所有学生一视同仁。(Good teachers treat all students equally.)

910. 公平公正 gōng píng gōng zhèng

Literal: Fair just

Idiomatic: Fair and just; equitable; impartial

Example: 比赛要公平公正，才能服众。(Competitions must be fair and just to convince everyone.)

Relative Measurements

911. 相提并论 xiāng tí bìng lùn

Literal: Mutually mention together discuss

Idiomatic: Mention in same breath; compare; put on same level

Example: 这两个人的能力不能相提并论。(These two people's abilities can't be mentioned in the same breath.)

912. 等量齐观 děng liàng qí guān

Literal: Equal measure together view

Idiomatic: Treat as equal; same standard; equivalent

Example: 不同的情况不能等量齐观。(Different situations can't be treated equally.)

913. 比肩接踵 bǐ jiān jiē zhǒng
Literal: Compare shoulder connect heel
Idiomatic: Side by side; closely following; in succession
Example: 优秀的学生比肩接踵，竞争激烈。(Excellent students follow closely, competition is fierce.)

914. 并驾齐驱 bìng jià qí qū
Literal: Side harness together drive
Idiomatic: Keep pace with; run neck and neck; equally matched
Example: 两家公司在市场上并驾齐驱。(The two companies keep pace in the market.)

915. 平分秋色 píng fēn qiū sè
Literal: Equally divide autumn color
Idiomatic: Equally matched; evenly divided; neck and neck
Example: 两队实力平分秋色，比赛很激烈。(The two teams are equally matched, the game is very intense.)

916. 旗鼓相当 qí gǔ xiāng dāng
Literal: Flag drum mutually match
Idiomatic: Evenly matched; well-matched opponents; equal

strength
Example: 这两位选手旗**831. 头脑清醒** tóu nǎo qīng xǐng
Literal: Head brain clear awake
Idiomatic: Clear-headed; rational; mentally alert
Example: 即使在危机中，他仍然头脑清醒。(Even in crisis, he remains clear-headed.)

832. 心如明镜 xīn rú míng jìng
Literal: Heart like bright mirror
Idiomatic: Mind clear as mirror; objective; unbiased perception
Example: 好法官心如明镜，公正判决。(A good judge has a mind clear as mirror, making fair decisions.)

833. 洞察秋毫 dòng chá qiū háo
Literal: Penetrate observe autumn hair
Idiomatic: Perceive minutest details; keen insight; sharp perception
Example: 他洞察秋毫，能看出事情的真相。(He perceives minutest details and can see the truth of matters.)

834. 明辨是非 míng biàn shì fēi
Literal: Clearly distinguish right wrong
Idiomatic: Distinguish right from wrong; moral clarity; good judgment

Example: 教育孩子要明辨是非，树立正确价值观。(Educating children to distinguish right from wrong and establish correct values.)

835. 冷静客观 lěng jìng kè guān
Literal: Cold quiet objective view
Idiomatic: Calm and objective; rational; unemotional analysis
Example: 处理问题要冷静客观，不能感情用事。(Handling problems requires calm objectivity, can't act on emotions.)

836. 思路清晰 sī lù qīng xī
Literal: Thought path clear clear
Idiomatic: Clear thinking; logical; organized thoughts
Example: 他思路清晰，能把复杂问题说明白。(His thinking is clear and can explain complex problems clearly.)

837. 条理分明 tiáo lǐ fēn míng
Literal: Order logic divide clear
Idiomatic: Well-organized; systematic; logically structured
Example: 她的报告条理分明，逻辑性强。(Her report is well-organized with strong logic.)

838. 一目了然 yī mù liǎo rán
Literal: One eye complete thus
Idiomatic: Clear at a glance; obvious; immediately apparent

Example: 这个图表制作得很好，一目了然。(This chart is well-made and clear at a glance.)

839. 心中有数 xīn zhōng yǒu shù
Literal: Heart middle have number
Idiomatic: Have a clear idea; know what's what; confident about situation
Example: 虽然他不说，但心中有数。(Although he doesn't say it, he has a clear idea.)

840. 胸有成竹 xiōng yǒu chéng zhú
Literal: Chest have complete bamboo
Idiomatic: Have well-thought-out plan; confident; prepared
Example: 面试前他做了充分准备，胸有成竹。(Before the interview, he prepared thoroughly and was confident.)

Confusion and Doubt

841. 迷惑不解 mí huò bù jiě
Literal: Confused not understand
Idiomatic: Puzzled; bewildered; completely confused
Example: 他对这个决定迷惑不解。(He's completely confused about this decision.)

842. 百思不解 bǎi sī bù jiě
Literal: Hundred think not understand

Idiomatic: Can't figure out despite much thought; baffling; perplexing
Example: 这个现象让科学家百思不解。(This phenomenon baffles scientists.)

843. 疑惑重重 yí huò chóng chóng
Literal: Doubt confusion heavy heavy
Idiomatic: Full of doubts; many uncertainties; deeply puzzled
Example: 听了他的解释，大家疑惑重重。(After hearing his explanation, everyone was full of doubts.)

844. 云里雾里 yún lǐ wù lǐ
Literal: Cloud inside fog inside
Idiomatic: In clouds and fog; confused; unclear about situation
Example: 他说得云里雾里，大家都不明白。(He spoke unclearly, and nobody understood.)

845. 稀里糊涂 xī lǐ hú tú
Literal: Thin inside confused muddy
Idiomatic: Muddled; confused; unclear thinking
Example: 他稀里糊涂地签了合同，后来后悔了。(He muddledly signed the contract and later regretted it.)

846. 糊里糊涂 hú lǐ hú tú
Literal: Confused inside confused muddy
Idiomatic: Muddled; bewildered; in a daze
Example: 她糊里糊涂地过了一天。(She spent the day in a daze.)

847. 不知所措 bù zhī suǒ cuò
Literal: Not know place put
Idiomatic: At a loss what to do; bewildered; don't know how to react
Example: 面对突发事件，他不知所措。(Facing the emergency, he was at a loss what to do.)

848. 手足无措 shǒu zú wú cuò
Literal: Hands feet no place
Idiomatic: Don't know what to do; helpless; at a complete loss
Example: 听到噩耗，她手足无措。(Hearing the bad news, she was at a complete loss.)

849. 一头雾水 yī tóu wù shuǐ
Literal: One head fog water
Idiomatic: Completely confused; totally baffled; head in clouds

Example: 听了这个复杂的解释，我一头雾水。(After hearing this complex explanation, I'm completely confused.)

850. 丈二和尚 zhàng èr hé shàng
Literal: Two-zhang monk
Idiomatic: Eight-foot monk (can't reach his own head) - completely puzzled; baffled
Example: 他问的问题让我如丈二和尚，摸不着头脑。(His question left me like an eight-foot monk, completely puzzled.)

Psychological Pressure

851. 如坐针毡 rú zuò zhēn zhān
Literal: Like sit needle felt
Idiomatic: Like sitting on pins and needles; extremely uncomfortable; anxious
Example: 等待考试结果时，他如坐针毡。(While waiting for exam results, he was like sitting on pins and needles.)

852. 坐立不安 zuò lì bù ān
Literal: Sit stand not peaceful
Idiomatic: Unable to sit still; restless; agitated
Example: 担心孩子的安全，她坐立不安。(Worried about the child's safety, she was unable to sit still.)

853. 心事重重 xīn shì chóng chóng
Literal: Heart matters heavy heavy
Idiomatic: Heavy-hearted; preoccupied with worries; burdened with concerns
Example: 最近他心事重重，不知道在想什么。(Recently he's been heavy-hearted, don't know what he's thinking about.)

854. 愁眉苦脸 chóu méi kǔ liǎn
Literal: Worried eyebrows bitter face
Idiomatic: Pull a long face; look worried and sad; dejected expression
Example: 他整天愁眉苦脸的，好像有什么烦心事。(He pulls a long face all day, as if he has worrying matters.)

855. 忧心忡忡 yōu xīn chōng chōng
Literal: Worry heart heavy heavy
Idiomatic: Deeply worried; anxious; full of concern
Example: 看到经济形势，投资者忧心忡忡。(Seeing the economic situation, investors are deeply worried.)

856. 焦虑不安 jiāo lǜ bù ān
Literal: Anxious worry not peaceful
Idiomatic: Anxious and restless; worried and uneasy; agitated
Example: 手术前家属焦虑不安。(Before surgery, family members were anxious and restless.)

857. 惶惶不安 huáng huáng bù ān
Literal: Fearful fearful not peaceful
Idiomatic: Panic-stricken; in a state of alarm; very nervous
Example: 听到传言，员工们惶惶不安。(Hearing rumors, employees were panic-stricken.)

858. 战战兢兢 zhàn zhàn jīng jīng
Literal: Tremble tremble cautious cautious
Idiomatic: Trembling with fear; very careful; extremely cautious
Example: 新员工工作时战战兢兢，生怕出错。(New employees work trembling with fear, afraid of making mistakes.)

859. 胆战心惊 dǎn zhàn xīn jīng
Literal: Gall tremble heart startle
Idiomatic: Trembling with fear; terrified; scared stiff
Example: 看恐怖电影让她胆战心惊。(Watching horror movies made her trembling with fear.)

860. 提心吊胆 tí xīn diào dǎn
Literal: Lift heart hang gall
Idiomatic: Have one's heart in one's mouth; extremely anxious; on tenterhooks

Example: 孩子还没回家，妈妈提心吊胆。(The child hasn't returned home yet, and mom has her heart in her mouth.)

🌟 RARE SITUATIONS & EXCEPTIONS (861-900)

Extraordinary Circumstances

861. 千载难逢 qiān zǎi nán féng
Literal: Thousand years difficult meet
Idiomatic: Once in a thousand years; extremely rare opportunity; unique chance
Example: 这是千载难逢的机会，不能错过。(This is a once-in-a-thousand-years opportunity, can't miss it.)

862. 百年一遇 bǎi nián yī yù
Literal: Hundred years one meet
Idiomatic: Once in a century; extremely rare; centennial event
Example: 这种自然现象百年一遇，很珍贵。(This natural phenomenon occurs once in a century, very precious.)

863. 史无前例 shǐ wú qián lì
Literal: History without previous example
Idiomatic: Unprecedented in history; never happened before;

unique
Example: 这次改革规模史无前例。(This reform is unprecedented in scale.)

864. 前无古人 qián wú gǔ rén
Literal: Before no ancient people
Idiomatic: No one before has done this; unprecedented; groundbreaking
Example: 他的发明前无古人，非常了不起。(His invention is unprecedented, very remarkable.)

865. 绝无仅有 jué wú jǐn yǒu
Literal: Absolutely no only have
Idiomatic: Absolutely unique; one and only; extremely rare
Example: 这件古董绝无仅有，价值连城。(This antique is absolutely unique and priceless.)

866. 独一无二 dú yī wú èr
Literal: Alone one without two
Idiomatic: One and only; unique; unparalleled
Example: 每个人都是独一无二的。(Every person is unique.)

867. 空前绝后 kōng qián jué hòu
Literal: Empty before cut after
Idiomatic: Unprecedented and unrepeatable; unique in

history
Example: 这次演出空前绝后，令人难忘。(This performance was unprecedented and unrepeatable, unforgettable.)

868. 旷世奇才 kuàng shì qí cái
Literal: Vast world strange talent
Idiomatic: Rare genius; extraordinary talent; once-in-a-generation talent
Example: 爱因斯坦是旷世奇才，改变了物理学。(Einstein was a rare genius who changed physics.)

869. 奇迹般 qí jì bān
Literal: Miracle like
Idiomatic: Miraculous; like a miracle; extraordinary
Example: 他奇迹般地康复了。(He recovered miraculously.)

870. 异想天开 yì xiǎng tiān kāi
Literal: Strange think heaven open
Idiomatic: Fantastic idea; wild imagination; far-fetched
Example: 他的想法异想天开，但很有创意。(His ideas are fantastic but very creative.)

Once-in-a-Lifetime Events

871. 人生如梦 rén shēng rú mèng
Literal: Human life like dream

Idiomatic: Life is like a dream; transient existence; ephemeral
Example: 人生如梦，要珍惜每一天。(Life is like a dream, must cherish every day.)

872. 稍纵即逝 shāo zòng jí shì
Literal: Slightly loose then pass
Idiomatic: Fleeting; disappear quickly if not grasped; transient
Example: 青春稍纵即逝，要好好把握。(Youth is fleeting, must grasp it well.)

873. 电光火石 diàn guāng huǒ shí
Literal: Lightning light fire stone
Idiomatic: Lightning speed; split second; extremely fast
Example: 在电光火石之间，他做出了决定。(In a split second, he made the decision.)

874. 转眼即逝 zhuǎn yǎn jí shì
Literal: Turn eye then pass
Idiomatic: Pass in the twinkling of an eye; very brief; fleeting
Example: 美好的时光转眼即逝。(Beautiful times pass in the twinkling of an eye.)

875. 弹指一挥间 tán zhǐ yī huī jiān
Literal: Snap finger one wave between
Idiomatic: In the snap of fingers; very brief moment; instant

Example: 弹指一挥间，孩子就长大了。(In the snap of fingers, children grow up.)

876. 光阴荏苒 guāng yīn rěn rǎn
Literal: Light shadow gradual pass
Idiomatic: Time passes gradually; time flies; years go by
Example: 光阴荏苒，转眼就是十年。(Time flies, and ten years pass in the blink of an eye.)

877. 时光飞逝 shí guāng fēi shì
Literal: Time light fly pass
Idiomatic: Time flies; time passes quickly; swift passage of time
Example: 时光飞逝，要抓紧时间学习。(Time flies, must seize time to study.)

878. 机不可失 jī bù kě shī
Literal: Opportunity not can lose
Idiomatic: Opportunity mustn't be missed; seize the moment
Example: 机不可失，时不再来。(Opportunity mustn't be missed, time won't come again.)

879. 良机难得 liáng jī nán dé
Literal: Good opportunity difficult get
Idiomatic: Good opportunity is hard to come by; rare chance

Example: 这是良机难得，要好好把握。(This is a rare good opportunity, must grasp it well.)

880. 千钧一发 qiān jūn yī fà
Literal: Thousand weight one hair
Idiomatic: Hanging by a thread; critical moment; extremely urgent
Example: 在千钧一发之际，他挺身而出。(At the critical moment, he stepped forward.)

802. 星星之火 xīng xing zhī huǒ
Literal: Spark spark's fire
Idiomatic: A single spark (can start a prairie fire); small beginning with big consequences
Example: 星星之火，可以燎原，小事也可能产生大影响。(A single spark can start a prairie fire - small things can have big consequences.)

803. 蝴蝶效应 hú dié xiào yìng
Literal: Butterfly effect
Idiomatic: Butterfly effect; small causes, large effects; sensitive dependence
Example: 这个小错误产生了蝴蝶效应，影响了整个项目。(This small error created a butterfly effect, affecting the entire project.)

804. 连锁反应 lián suǒ fǎn yìng
Literal: Chain lock reaction
Idiomatic: Chain reaction; domino effect; cascade of consequences
Example: 一个部门的问题引发了连锁反应。(One department's problem triggered a chain reaction.)

805. 层层推进 céng céng tuī jìn
Literal: Layer layer push advance
Idiomatic: Advance layer by layer; progressive development; step-by-step progression
Example: 改革要层层推进，不能急于求成。(Reform must advance layer by layer, can't rush for quick results.)

806. 环环相扣 huán huán xiāng kòu
Literal: Ring ring mutually link
Idiomatic: Interlocked rings; closely connected; interdependent
Example: 这个计划环环相扣，每个步骤都很重要。(This plan is closely connected with every step being important.)

807. 息息相关 xī xī xiāng guān
Literal: Breath breath mutually related
Idiomatic: Closely related; intimately connected; interdependent

Example: 环境保护与每个人息息相关。(Environmental protection is closely related to everyone.)

808. 一环扣一环 yī huán kòu yī huán
Literal: One ring link one ring
Idiomatic: Link by link; step by step; sequential progression
Example: 这个过程一环扣一环，不能出错。(This process links step by step - no mistakes allowed.)

809. 多米诺骨牌 duō mǐ nuò gǔ pái
Literal: Domino bone tiles
Idiomatic: Domino effect; cascade failure; sequential collapse
Example: 一个银行倒闭引起多米诺骨牌效应。(One bank's collapse caused a domino effect.)

810. 推波助澜 tuī bō zhù lán
Literal: Push wave help billows
Idiomatic: Add fuel to flames; make things worse; escalate situation
Example: 媒体的报道推波助澜，让事态更严重。(Media reports added fuel to flames, making the situation more serious.)

Revenge and Retribution

811. 血债血偿 xuè zhài xuè cháng

Literal: Blood debt blood repay
Idiomatic: Blood debt must be paid in blood; eye for an eye; retribution
Example: 古人说血债血偿，现代社会要依法解决。(Ancients said blood debt must be paid in blood, modern society should resolve through law.)

812. 以牙还牙 yǐ yá huán yá
Literal: With tooth return tooth
Idiomatic: Tooth for tooth; retaliate in kind; tit for tat
Example: 国际争端中，各国以牙还牙，很难解决。(In international disputes, countries retaliate in kind, making resolution difficult.)

813. 报仇雪恨 bào chóu xuě hèn
Literal: Repay revenge wash hate
Idiomatic: Revenge and wipe out hatred; settle scores; get even
Example: 他发誓要报仇雪恨，为父亲讨回公道。(He swore to revenge and wipe out hatred, seeking justice for his father.)

814. 冤冤相报 yuān yuān xiāng bào
Literal: Grievance grievance mutually repay
Idiomatic: Grievances beget grievances; cycle of revenge; tit-for-tat retaliation

Example: 冤冤相报何时了，应该以和为贵。(When will the cycle of revenge end - should value harmony.)

815. 睚眦必报 yá zì bì bào
Literal: Angry glare must repay
Idiomatic: Revenge for the smallest grievance; vindictive; petty revenge
Example: 他睚眦必报，得罪了他就麻烦了。(He's vindictive - it's trouble if you offend him.)

816. 君子报仇 jūn zǐ bào chóu
Literal: Gentleman repay revenge
Idiomatic: Gentleman's revenge (ten years not too late); patient retribution
Example: 君子报仇，十年不晚，他会等待时机。(A gentleman's revenge can wait ten years - he'll wait for the right moment.)

817. 善恶到头终有报 shàn è dào tóu zhōng yǒu bào
Literal: Good evil reach end finally have retribution
Idiomatic: Good and evil deeds eventually get their due; ultimate justice
Example: 善恶到头终有报，只是来早与来迟。(Good and evil deeds eventually get their due, just sooner or later.)

818. 多行不义必自毙 duō xíng bù yì bì zì bì
Literal: Much do not righteous must self destroy
Idiomatic: Persistent wrongdoing leads to self-destruction; evil destroys itself
Example: 多行不义必自毙，坏人终会自取灭亡。(Persistent wrongdoing leads to self-destruction - bad people will eventually destroy themselves.)

819. 恶人自有恶人磨 è rén zì yǒu è rén mó
Literal: Evil people naturally have evil people grind
Idiomatic: Evil people are dealt with by other evil people; villains torment each other
Example: 恶人自有恶人磨，不用我们操心。(Evil people are dealt with by other evil people - we don't need to worry.)

820. 天理昭昭 tiān lǐ zhāo zhāo
Literal: Heaven principle clear clear
Idiomatic: Heaven's justice is clear; moral law is evident; divine justice
Example: 天理昭昭，好人终会有好报。(Heaven's justice is clear - good people will eventually be rewarded.)

🎭 EMOTIONS & PSYCHOLOGY (821-860)

Complex Emotional States

821. 百感交集 bǎi gǎn jiāo jí
Literal: Hundred feelings intersect gather
Idiomatic: Mixed feelings; conflicted emotions; complex emotional state
Example: 看到老照片，他百感交集，既高兴又伤感。(Looking at old photos, he had mixed feelings, both happy and sad.)

822. 五味杂陈 wǔ wèi zá chén
Literal: Five flavors mixed display
Idiomatic: Mixed feelings like five flavors; complex emotions; bittersweet
Example: 听到这个消息，她心里五味杂陈。(Hearing this news, she had complex emotions.)

823. 爱恨交织 ài hèn jiāo zhī
Literal: Love hate intersect weave
Idiomatic: Love and hate intertwined; ambivalent feelings; conflicted emotions
Example: 对于前男友，她爱恨交织，很复杂。(Toward her

ex-boyfriend, she has love and hate intertwined, very complex.)

824. 喜忧参半 xǐ yōu cān bàn
Literal: Joy worry mixed half
Idiomatic: Half joy, half worry; mixed emotions; bittersweet feelings
Example: 孩子要出国留学，父母喜忧参半。(Children going abroad to study leaves parents with mixed emotions.)

825. 哭笑不得 kū xiào bù dé
Literal: Cry laugh not able
Idiomatic: Don't know whether to laugh or cry; awkward situation; bemused
Example: 听到这个荒唐的解释，大家哭笑不得。(Hearing this absurd explanation, everyone didn't know whether to laugh or cry.)

826. 悲喜交集 bēi xǐ jiāo jí
Literal: Sadness joy intersect gather
Idiomatic: Sadness and joy intermixed; conflicted emotions; mixed feelings
Example: 重逢的时刻，她悲喜交集，泪流满面。(At the moment of reunion, she had conflicted emotions with tears streaming.)

827. 忧喜参半 yōu xǐ cān bàn
Literal: Worry joy mixed half
Idiomatic: Half worry, half joy; mixed emotions; ambivalent
Example: 听到调职的消息，他忧喜参半。(Hearing about the job transfer, he had mixed emotions.)

828. 心潮澎湃 xīn cháo péng pài
Literal: Heart tide surge surge
Idiomatic: Heart surging like tides; overwhelming emotions; deeply moved
Example: 听到国歌响起，他心潮澎湃，热泪盈眶。(Hearing the national anthem, his heart surged and tears filled his eyes.)

829. 情不自禁 qíng bù zì jīn
Literal: Emotion not self restrain
Idiomatic: Cannot help oneself emotionally; involuntary feelings; overwhelmed
Example: 看到感人的电影，她情不自禁地流下眼泪。(Watching the touching movie, she couldn't help but shed tears.)

830. 感慨万千 gǎn kǎi wàn qiān
Literal: Feel sigh ten thousand thousand
Idiomatic: Filled with countless emotions; deeply moved;

overwhelmed with feeling
Example: 回到母校，他感慨万千，回忆涌上心头。(Returning to his alma mater, he was filled with countless emotions as memories flooded back.)

Mental Clarity

831. 头脑清醒 tóu nǎo qīng xǐng
Literal: Head brain clear awake
Idiomatic: Clear-headed; rational; mentally alert
Example: 即使在危机中，他仍然头脑清醒。(Even in crisis, he---

🎯 GOALS & AMBITIONS (721-750)

High Aspirations

721. 雄心壮志 xióng xīn zhuàng zhì
Literal: Heroic heart strong ambition
Idiomatic: Great ambition; lofty aspirations; high-minded goals
Example: 年轻人要有雄心壮志，为国家建设贡献力量。(Young people should have great ambitions and contribute to national construction.)

722. 志存高远 zhì cún gāo yuǎn
Literal: Ambition exist high far
Idiomatic: Harbor lofty ambitions; aim high; aspire to greatness
Example: 他从小志存高远，立志要成为科学家。(He harbored lofty ambitions from childhood, determined to become a scientist.)

723. 鸿鹄之志 hóng hú zhī zhì
Literal: Swan goose's ambition
Idiomatic: Lofty aspirations; soaring ambitions; high aims
Example: 燕雀安知鸿鹄之志，他们不理解你的远大理想。(How can sparrows understand swan's ambitions - they don't understand your lofty ideals.)

724. 胸怀大志 xiōng huái dà zhì
Literal: Chest embrace big ambition
Idiomatic: Harbor great ambitions; have lofty aspirations; ambitious
Example: 这个年轻人胸怀大志，前途无量。(This young person harbors great ambitions with unlimited prospects.)

725. 壮志凌云 zhuàng zhì líng yún
Literal: Strong ambition reach clouds
Idiomatic: Soaring ambitions; lofty aspirations; ambitious

goals
Example: 他壮志凌云，要在事业上取得巨大成就。(His soaring ambitions drive him to achieve great success in his career.)

726. 青云直上 qīng yún zhí shàng
Literal: Blue clouds straight up
Idiomatic: Rapid rise to high position; meteoric rise; swift success
Example: 凭借才华和努力，他青云直上，很快就升职了。(With talent and effort, he had a meteoric rise and was promoted quickly.)

727. 平步青云 píng bù qīng yún
Literal: Level step blue clouds
Idiomatic: Rise rapidly in career; smooth path to success; easy advancement
Example: 他平步青云，年纪轻轻就当上了经理。(He rose rapidly in his career, becoming manager at a young age.)

728. 一步登天 yī bù dēng tiān
Literal: One step reach heaven
Idiomatic: Reach the top in one step; instant success; overnight achievement
Example: 成功不能指望一步登天，需要积累和努力。

(Success can't rely on reaching the top instantly - requires accumulation and effort.)

729. 扶摇直上 fú yáo zhí shàng
Literal: Support whirlwind straight up
Idiomatic: Soar upward; rapid advancement; swift rise
Example: 他的事业扶摇直上，发展很快。(His career is soaring upward with rapid development.)

730. 鲤鱼跳龙门 lǐ yú tiào lóng mén
Literal: Carp jump dragon gate
Idiomatic: Carp leaps over dragon gate; achieve remarkable success; social advancement
Example: 通过考试，他鲤鱼跳龙门，改变了命运。(Through exams, he achieved remarkable success like a carp leaping the dragon gate, changing his destiny.)

Modest Goals

731. 知足常乐 zhī zú cháng lè
Literal: Know satisfy often happy
Idiomatic: Content with one's lot; satisfaction brings happiness; modest contentment
Example: 他知足常乐，虽然收入不高但很快乐。(He's

content with his lot - though income isn't high, he's very happy.)

732. 安于现状 ān yú xiàn zhuàng
Literal: Peaceful at current situation
Idiomatic: Content with status quo; satisfied with current state; complacent
Example: 年轻人不应该安于现状，要有进取心。(Young people shouldn't be content with the status quo - should have drive.)

733. 小富即安 xiǎo fù jí ān
Literal: Small wealth then peaceful
Idiomatic: Content with small wealth; satisfied with modest prosperity; limited ambition
Example: 他小富即安，不想再扩大生意。(He's content with small wealth and doesn't want to expand his business.)

734. 安贫乐道 ān pín lè dào
Literal: Peaceful poverty happy way
Idiomatic: Content with poverty and devoted to principles; simple living
Example: 古代文人安贫乐道，追求精神富足。(Ancient scholars were content with poverty and devoted to principles, pursuing spiritual wealth.)

735. 淡泊名利 dàn bó míng lì
Literal: Light thin fame profit
Idiomatic: Indifferent to fame and fortune; not seeking material gain; simple desires
Example: 真正的学者淡泊名利，专心做学问。(True scholars are indifferent to fame and fortune, focusing on academic pursuits.)

736. 与世无争 yǔ shì wú zhēng
Literal: With world no compete
Idiomatic: Not compete with the world; peaceful non-competition; withdraw from struggle
Example: 退休后他与世无争，过着安静的生活。(After retirement, he doesn't compete with the world, living a quiet life.)

737. 恬淡寡欲 tián dàn guǎ yù
Literal: Tranquil light few desires
Idiomatic: Tranquil with few desires; simple wants; content lifestyle
Example: 他恬淡寡欲，不追求奢华生活。(He's tranquil with few desires, not pursuing luxurious life.)

738. 清心寡欲 qīng xīn guǎ yù
Literal: Clear heart few desires

Idiomatic: Pure heart with few desires; simple living; minimal wants
Example: 修行人清心寡欲，专注精神修养。(Practitioners have pure hearts with few desires, focusing on spiritual cultivation.)

739. 随遇而安 suí yù ér ān
Literal: Follow meet then peaceful
Idiomatic: Adapt to circumstances; make the best of situations; flexible contentment
Example: 她性格开朗，到哪里都能随遇而安。(She has a cheerful personality and can adapt to circumstances wherever she goes.)

740. 得过且过 dé guò qiě guò
Literal: Get through and pass through
Idiomatic: Get by; muddle through; lack ambition; mediocre attitude
Example: 他工作态度得过且过，没有上进心。(His work attitude is just getting by without ambition.)

Failed Ambitions

741. 壮志未酬 zhuàng zhì wèi chóu
Literal: Strong ambition not fulfilled

Idiomatic: Unfulfilled ambitions; dreams unrealized; disappointed hopes
Example: 他年老时壮志未酬，心中很遗憾。(In old age, his unfulfilled ambitions left him with deep regrets.)

742. 功败垂成 gōng bài chuí chéng
Literal: Merit defeat hanging complete
Idiomatic: Fail when success is within reach; fall at the last hurdle
Example: 这个项目功败垂成，让人十分惋惜。(This project failed when success was within reach, very regrettable.)

743. 功亏一篑 gōng kuī yī kuì
Literal: Merit lack one basket
Idiomatic: Fail for want of final effort; fall short by small margin
Example: 考试差一分及格，真是功亏一篑。(Missing the pass mark by one point - truly failing for want of final effort.)

744. 前功尽弃 qián gōng jìn qì
Literal: Previous merit all abandon
Idiomatic: All previous efforts wasted; throw away past achievements
Example: 一次失误让他前功尽弃，不得不重新开始。(One

mistake made all his previous efforts go to waste, having to start over.)

745. 半途而废 bàn tú ér fèi
Literal: Half way then abandon
Idiomatic: Give up halfway; abandon before completion; quit midstream
Example: 学习不能半途而废，要坚持到底。(Learning can't be abandoned halfway - must persist to the end.)

746. 志大才疏 zhì dà cái shū
Literal: Ambition big talent sparse
Idiomatic: Great ambition but little talent; aspirations exceed abilities
Example: 他志大才疏，想法很多但能力有限。(He has great ambition but little talent - many ideas but limited ability.)

747. 眼高手低 yǎn gāo shǒu dī
Literal: Eyes high hands low
Idiomatic: Have high standards but low ability; unrealistic expectations
Example: 年轻人容易眼高手低，要脚踏实地。(Young people easily have unrealistic expectations - must be down-to-earth.)

748. 好高骛远 hào gāo wù yuǎn
Literal: Like high pursue far
Idiomatic: Aim too high; unrealistic ambitions; chase impossible dreams
Example: 做事不能好高骛远，要从基础做起。(Can't aim too high when doing things - must start from basics.)

749. 心有余力不足 xīn yǒu yú lì bù zú
Literal: Heart have surplus strength not enough
Idiomatic: Willing but unable; spirit willing but flesh weak; insufficient capability
Example: 他想帮助更多人，但心有余力不足。(He wants to help more people but is willing yet unable.)

750. 力不从心 lì bù cóng xīn
Literal: Strength not follow heart
Idiomatic: Ability doesn't match one's wishes; inadequate strength; can't do what one wants
Example: 年纪大了，做事力不从心。(Getting old, doing things becomes beyond one's ability.)

🎪 ENTERTAINMENT & LEISURE (751-780)

Games and Sports

751. 棋逢对手 qí féng duì shǒu
Literal: Chess meet matching opponent
Idiomatic: Meet one's match; evenly matched opponents; worthy adversary
Example: 这场比赛棋逢对手，非常精彩。(This match had evenly matched opponents, very exciting.)

752. 将遇良才 jiàng yù liáng cái
Literal: General meet good talent
Idiomatic: General meets capable officer; well-matched competitors; equal opponents
Example: 两位高手对弈，真是将遇良才。(Two masters playing chess - truly well-matched competitors.)

753. 胜负难分 shèng fù nán fēn
Literal: Victory defeat difficult divide
Idiomatic: Hard to determine winner; neck and neck; close competition
Example: 比赛进行得很激烈，胜负难分。(The competition is very intense, hard to determine the winner.)

754. 技高一筹 jì gāo yī chóu
Literal: Skill high one level
Idiomatic: Skill superior by one level; slightly better; edge in ability

Example: 虽然都很厉害，但他技高一筹，赢得了比赛。(Although both are formidable, he's slightly better and won the match.)

755. 略胜一筹 lüè shèng yī chóu
Literal: Slightly victory one level
Idiomatic: Slightly superior; marginally better; narrow advantage
Example: 在这次竞赛中，她略胜一筹。(In this competition, she was slightly superior.)

756. 后来居上 hòu lái jū shàng
Literal: Later come occupy above
Idiomatic: Latecomers surpass early starters; come from behind to win
Example: 他虽然起步较晚，但后来居上，取得了好成绩。(Although he started late, he came from behind and achieved good results.)

757. 背水一战 bèi shuǐ yī zhàn
Literal: Back water one battle
Idiomatic: Fight with back to the water; desperate battle; last stand
Example: 这是我们的最后机会，要背水一战。(This is our last chance - we must fight with our backs to the wall.)

758. 破釜沉舟 pò fǔ chén zhōu
Literal: Break cauldron sink boat
Idiomatic: Cut off all means of retreat; burn bridges; desperate determination
Example: 他破釜沉舟，全力以赴参加比赛。(He burned his bridges and gave his all in the competition.)

759. 一决雌雄 yī jué cí xióng
Literal: One decide female male
Idiomatic: Fight it out; decisive battle; settle the matter once and for all
Example: 两队将在决赛中一决雌雄。(The two teams will fight it out in the final.)

760. 你争我夺 nǐ zhēng wǒ duó
Literal: You compete I seize
Idiomatic: Compete fiercely; scramble for; intense rivalry
Example: 比赛中选手们你争我夺，场面很激烈。(In the competition, contestants compete fiercely with intense scenes.)

761. 全力以赴 quán lì yǐ fù
Literal: Complete strength to go
Idiomatic: Go all out; spare no effort; give one's best

Example: 无论结果如何，我们都要全力以赴。(Regardless of the outcome, we must give our best.)

Festivals and Celebrations

762. 张灯结彩 zhāng dēng jié cǎi
Literal: Hang lanterns tie colored silk
Idiomatic: Hang lanterns and festoons; festive decorations; celebration atmosphere
Example: 春节期间，街道上张灯结彩，很热闹。(During Spring Festival, streets are decorated with lanterns and festoons, very lively.)

763. 锣鼓喧天 luó gǔ xuān tiān
Literal: Gongs drums clamor heaven
Idiomatic: Gongs and drums resound; noisy celebration; festive clamor
Example: 庆典现场锣鼓喧天，气氛热烈。(The celebration site has gongs and drums resounding with heated atmosphere.)

764. 欢声笑语 huān shēng xiào yǔ
Literal: Happy voices laughing words
Idiomatic: Sounds of joy and laughter; merry atmosphere; festive cheer

Example: 聚会上欢声笑语，大家都很开心。(At the party there are sounds of joy and laughter, everyone very happy.)

765. 喜气洋洋 xǐ qì yáng yáng
Literal: Joy air overflowing overflowing
Idiomatic: Beaming with joy; full of happiness; jubilant atmosphere
Example: 新年期间，到处都是喜气洋洋的气氛。(During New Year, everywhere is beaming with joy.)

766. 载歌载舞 zài gē zài wǔ
Literal: While song while dance
Idiomatic: Singing and dancing; celebrate with song and dance; joyful celebration
Example: 人们载歌载舞庆祝节日。(People celebrate the festival with singing and dancing.)

767. 热闹非凡 rè nào fēi fán
Literal: Hot noise not ordinary
Idiomatic: Exceptionally lively; bustling with activity; very festive
Example: 庙会上热闹非凡，人山人海。(The temple fair is exceptionally lively with crowds of people.)

768. 普天同庆 pǔ tiān tóng qìng
Literal: Universal heaven together celebrate
Idiomatic: Universal celebration; everyone celebrates; nationwide joy
Example: 国庆节时普天同庆，全国欢腾。(During National Day, there's universal celebration with nationwide joy.)

769. 万家灯火 wàn jiā dēng huǒ
Literal: Ten thousand homes lights fire
Idiomatic: Lights in every home; peaceful domestic scene; widespread happiness
Example: 除夕夜万家灯火，温馨祥和。(On New Year's Eve, lights in every home create warm harmony.)

770. 团团圆圆 tuán tuán yuán yuán
Literal: Round round complete complete
Idiomatic: Complete family reunion; perfect togetherness; harmony
Example: 中秋节一家人团团圆圆，很幸福。(During Mid-Autumn Festival, the family has complete reunion, very happy.)

Relaxation and Rest

771. 悠然自得 yōu rán zì dé

Literal: Leisurely thus self satisfied
Idiomatic: Leisurely and carefree; at ease; relaxed contentment
Example: 退休后他悠然自得，每天散步看书。(After retirement, he's leisurely and carefree, walking and reading daily.)

772. 逍遥自在 xiāo yáo zì zài
Literal: Free easy self at
Idiomatic: Free and at ease; carefree; unrestrained
Example: 假期里他逍遥自在，没有任何压力。(During vacation he's free and at ease without any pressure.)

773. 无拘无束 wú jū wú shù
Literal: No restrain no bind
Idiomatic: Free and unrestrained; without constraints; unrestricted
Example: 在乡下的生活无拘无束，很放松。(Country life is free and unrestrained, very relaxing.)

774. 心旷神怡 xīn kuàng shén yí
Literal: Heart broad spirit pleasant
Idiomatic: Feel refreshed and happy; relaxed and joyful; pleasant mood

Example: 山清水秀的景色让人心旷神怡。(The beautiful scenery makes people feel refreshed and happy.)

775. 怡然自乐 yí rán zì lè
Literal: Pleasant thus self happy
Idiomatic: Find pleasure in simple things; content and happy; peaceful joy
Example: 他在花园里怡然自乐，享受宁静时光。(He finds pleasure in the garden, enjoying peaceful time.)

776. 闲云野鹤 xián yún yě hè
Literal: Idle clouds wild crane
Idiomatic: Free as floating clouds and wild cranes; untrammeled; independent
Example: 他过着闲云野鹤般的生活，自由自在。(He lives like idle clouds and wild cranes, free and easy.)

777. 陶然自得 táo rán zì dé
Literal: Intoxicated thus self satisfied
Idiomatic: Thoroughly satisfied; completely content; blissful satisfaction
Example: 他在音乐中陶然自得，忘记了烦恼。(He's thoroughly satisfied in music, forgetting his troubles.)

778. 游山玩水 yóu shān wán shuǐ
Literal: Tour mountains play water
Idiomatic: Travel and enjoy scenery; sightsee; recreational travel
Example: 退休后他经常游山玩水，很享受。(After retirement, he often travels and enjoys scenery, very enjoyable.)

779. 赏心悦目 shǎng xīn yuè mù
Literal: Appreciate heart please eye
Idiomatic: Pleasing to the eye and mind; delightful to see; beautiful sight
Example: 花展上的鲜花赏心悦目。(The flowers at the exhibition are pleasing to the eye and mind.)

780. 宾至如归 bīn zhì rú guī
Literal: Guest arrive like return
Idiomatic: Guests feel at home; warm hospitality; comfortable welcome
Example: 这家酒店服务很好，客人宾至如归。(This hotel has good service, guests feel at home.)

🔄 CAUSE & EFFECT (781-820)

Natural Consequences

781. 种瓜得瓜 zhǒng guā dé guā
Literal: Plant melon get melon
Idiomatic: You reap what you sow; natural consequences; cause and effect
Example: 种瓜得瓜，种豆得豆，善有善报。(Plant melon get melon, plant beans get beans - good deeds bring good rewards.)

782. 因果报应 yīn guǒ bào yìng
Literal: Cause effect retribution response
Idiomatic: Karmic retribution; what goes around comes around; consequences
Example: 他相信因果报应，所以总是行善。(He believes in karmic retribution, so he always does good deeds.)

783. 善有善报 shàn yǒu shàn bào
Literal: Good have good reward
Idiomatic: Good deeds bring good rewards; virtue is rewarded; good karma
Example: 善有善报，恶有恶报，这是天理。(Good deeds bring good rewards, evil deeds bring punishment - this is natural law.)

784. 恶有恶报 è yǒu è bào
Literal: Evil have evil reward

Idiomatic: Evil deeds bring punishment; vice is punished; bad karma
Example: 坏人终会恶有恶报，受到惩罚。(Bad people will eventually receive punishment for evil deeds.)

785. 水到渠成 shuǐ dào qú chéng
Literal: Water arrive channel form
Idiomatic: Natural course of events; things fall into place naturally; inevitable result
Example: 只要努力准备，成功就会水到渠成。(With adequate preparation, success will come naturally.)

786. 瓜熟蒂落 guā shú dì luò
Literal: Melon ripe stem drop
Idiomatic: When conditions are ripe, things happen naturally; natural timing
Example: 孩子的成长要顺其自然，瓜熟蒂落。(Children's growth should be natural - when conditions are ripe, things happen naturally.)

787. 天网恢恢 tiān wǎng huī huī
Literal: Heaven net vast vast
Idiomatic: Heaven's net is wide; justice will prevail; wrongdoers will be caught

Example: 天网恢恢，疏而不漏，坏人逃不掉。(Heaven's net is wide but lets nothing through - bad people can't escape.)

788. 自作自受 zì zuò zì shòu
Literal: Self do self suffer
Idiomatic: Suffer consequences of one's own actions; reap what one sows; self-inflicted
Example: 他现在的困难是自作自受，怪不得别人。(His current difficulties are self-inflicted, can't blame others.)

789. 咎由自取 jiù yóu zì qǔ
Literal: Blame from self take
Idiomatic: Bring trouble on oneself; ask for it; self-caused problems
Example: 他的失败咎由自取，不听劝告。(His failure is self-caused, wouldn't listen to advice.)

790. 自食其果 zì shí qí guǒ
Literal: Self eat its fruit
Idiomatic: Eat the fruit of one's actions; face consequences; suffer from own deeds
Example: 他不好好学习，现在自食其果，找不到工作。(He didn't study well and now faces the consequences, can't find a job.)

Unintended Results

791. 弄巧成拙 nòng qiǎo chéng zhuō
Literal: Play clever become clumsy
Idiomatic: Trying to be clever backfires; counterproductive; outsmart oneself
Example: 他想偷懒却弄巧成拙，反而要加班。(He tried to slack off but it backfired, now has to work overtime.)

792. 画蛇添足 huà shé tiān zú
Literal: Draw snake add feet
Idiomatic: Gild the lily; unnecessary addition that spoils; overdo it
Example: 你的报告已经很好了，再修改就是画蛇添足。(Your report is already good - further revision would be gilding the lily.)

793. 节外生枝 jié wài shēng zhī
Literal: Joint outside grow branch
Idiomatic: Unnecessary complications; unexpected problems; side issues
Example: 本来很简单的事，却节外生枝，变复杂了。(Originally simple matter, but unnecessary complications made it complex.)

794. 适得其反 shì dé qí fǎn
Literal: Suitable get its opposite
Idiomatic: Achieve opposite of intended result; backfire; counterproductive
Example: 过分的保护适得其反，孩子变得依赖性强。(Excessive protection backfired, making the child overly dependent.)

795. 欲速则不达 yù sù zé bù dá
Literal: Want speed then not reach
Idiomatic: Haste makes waste; rushing leads to failure; speed defeats purpose
Example: 学习要循序渐进，欲速则不达。(Learning should be gradual - haste makes waste.)

796. 南辕北辙 nán yuán běi zhé
Literal: South shaft north rut
Idiomatic: Go south while heading north; contradictory actions; defeat one's purpose
Example: 你的做法和目标南辕北辙，不会成功。(Your method contradicts your goal - you won't succeed.)

797. 缘木求鱼 yuán mù qiú yú
Literal: Climb tree seek fish
Idiomatic: Look for fish in tree; impossible method; futile

effort
Example: 用这种方法解决问题是缘木求鱼。(Using this method to solve the problem is looking for fish in a tree.)

798. 竹篮打水 zhú lán dǎ shuǐ
Literal: Bamboo basket draw water
Idiomatic: Draw water with bamboo basket; futile effort; wasted work
Example: 他的努力如竹篮打水一场空。(His efforts are like drawing water with a bamboo basket - all in vain.)

799. 舍本逐末 shě běn zhú mò
Literal: Abandon root pursue tip
Idiomatic: Neglect fundamentals for trivial; put cart before horse; wrong priorities
Example: 只注重外表而忽视内在是舍本逐末。(Focusing only on appearance while ignoring substance is putting the cart before the horse.)

800. 本末倒置 běn mò dào zhì
Literal: Root tip reverse place
Idiomatic: Put cart before horse; confuse priorities; reverse importance
Example: 为了赚钱而不顾健康是本末倒置。(Ignoring health for money is putting the cart before the horse.)

916. 旗鼓相当 qí gǔ xiāng dāng
Literal: Flag drum mutually match
Idiomatic: Evenly matched; well-matched opponents; equal strength
Example: 这两位选手旗鼓相当，胜负难料。(These two contestants are evenly matched, the outcome is hard to predict.)

917. 势均力敌 shì jūn lì dí
Literal: Power equal strength enemy
Idiomatic: Evenly matched in strength; balanced forces; equal opponents
Example: 双方势均力敌，战斗很激烈。(Both sides are evenly matched in strength, the battle is intense.)

918. 相差无几 xiāng chà wú jǐ
Literal: Mutually differ without few
Idiomatic: Little difference; almost the same; negligible gap
Example: 两个产品的质量相差无几。(The quality of the two products has little difference.)

919. 大同小异 dà tóng xiǎo yì
Literal: Big same small different
Idiomatic: Basically the same with minor differences; similar overall

Example: 这几个方案大同小异，没什么区别。(These plans are basically the same with minor differences.)

920. 半斤八两 bàn jīn bā liǎng
Literal: Half catty eight taels
Idiomatic: Six of one, half dozen of the other; about the same; no significant difference
Example: 这两个人的能力半斤八两。(These two people's abilities are about the same.)

Exact vs. Approximate

921. 分毫不差 fēn háo bù chà
Literal: Fen cent not differ
Idiomatic: Exactly right; precise to the smallest unit; perfectly accurate
Example: 他的计算分毫不差，非常准确。(His calculations are exactly right, very accurate.)

922. 丝毫不爽 sī háo bù shuǎng
Literal: Silk hair not miss
Idiomatic: Not off by a hair's breadth; extremely precise; perfectly accurate
Example: 这个仪器测量丝毫不爽。(This instrument measures with perfect accuracy.)

923. 毫厘不差 háo lí bù chà
Literal: Hair li not differ
Idiomatic: Not off by a hair; extremely precise; exact
Example: 工程师要求毫厘不差，容不得一点误差。(Engineers require perfect precision, cannot tolerate any error.)

924. 一丝不苟 yī sī bù gǒu
Literal: One silk not careless
Idiomatic: Extremely careful; meticulous; very precise
Example: 他做事一丝不苟，从不马虎。(He works extremely carefully, never careless.)

925. 大概其 dà gài qí
Literal: Big approximate its
Idiomatic: Roughly; approximately; more or less
Example: 人数大概其有一百人左右。(The number of people is roughly around one hundred.)

926. 约摸着 yuē mō zhe
Literal: Approximate feel with
Idiomatic: Roughly; approximately; estimate
Example: 约摸着还需要一个小时。(Approximately still need one hour.)

927. 差不多 chà bù duō

Literal: Differ not much

Idiomatic: About the same; roughly; approximately

Example: 两个价格差不多。(The two prices are about the same.)

928. 八九不离十 bā jiǔ bù lí shí

Literal: Eight nine not leave ten

Idiomatic: Pretty close to the mark; roughly accurate; approximately right

Example: 他的猜测八九不离十。(His guess is pretty close to the mark.)

929. 十有八九 shí yǒu bā jiǔ

Literal: Ten have eight nine

Idiomatic: Most likely; in all probability; very probably

Example: 明天十有八九会下雨。(Tomorrow will most likely rain.)

930. 七七八八 qī qī bā bā

Literal: Seven seven eight eight

Idiomatic: More or less; roughly; approximately

Example: 事情已经办得七七八八了。(The matter has been handled more or less.)

ENDINGS & CONCLUSIONS (931-960)

Successful Completion

931. 大功告成 dà gōng gào chéng
Literal: Great merit announce complete
Idiomatic: Great achievement accomplished; mission completed successfully
Example: 经过三年建设，大功告成，新桥正式通车。(After three years of construction, the great achievement is accomplished - the new bridge officially opens.)

932. 圆满成功 yuán mǎn chéng gōng
Literal: Complete successful
Idiomatic: Complete success; perfect accomplishment; successful conclusion
Example: 这次会议圆满成功，达到了预期目标。(This meeting was a complete success, achieving expected goals.)

933. 善始善终 shàn shǐ shàn zhōng
Literal: Good start good end
Idiomatic: Good beginning and good ending; see things through properly
Example: 做事要善始善终，不能半途而废。(Must see things through properly from start to finish, can't give up halfway.)

934. 有始有终 yǒu shǐ yǒu zhōng
Literal: Have start have end
Idiomatic: See things through to completion; finish what one starts
Example: 他做事有始有终，很有责任心。(He sees things through to completion, very responsible.)

935. 水到渠成 shuǐ dào qú chéng
Literal: Water arrive channel form
Idiomatic: Natural conclusion; things fall into place; inevitable success
Example: 只要努力准备，成功就会水到渠成。(With adequate preparation, success will come naturally.)

936. 功德圆满 gōng dé yuán mǎn
Literal: Merit virtue complete perfect
Idiomatic: Merit and virtue complete; perfect accomplishment; successful completion
Example: 这项工程功德圆满，造福人民。(This project is perfectly accomplished, benefiting the people.)

937. 尘埃落定 chén āi luò dìng
Literal: Dust settle fixed
Idiomatic: Dust settles; matter concluded; situation resolved
Example: 经过长期争论，尘埃落定，问题终于解决了。(After

long debate, the dust settles and the problem is finally solved.)

938. 盖棺定论 gài guān dìng lùn
Literal: Cover coffin fix conclusion
Idiomatic: Final judgment; definitive conclusion; settled matter
Example: 这件事已经盖棺定论，不必再争论了。(This matter has reached final judgment, no need to debate further.)

939. 瓜熟蒂落 guā shú dì luò
Literal: Melon ripe stem drop
Idiomatic: When fruit is ripe, it falls; natural completion; proper timing
Example: 改革要循序渐进，瓜熟蒂落。(Reform should be gradual, coming naturally when conditions are ripe.)

940. 完璧归赵 wán bì guī zhào
Literal: Complete jade return Zhao
Idiomatic: Return something intact; complete and successful return
Example: 借来的东西要完璧归赵，完好无损地还回去。(Borrowed things should be returned intact and undamaged.)

Abrupt Endings

941. 戛然而止 jiá rán ér zhǐ
Literal: Abruptly thus stop
Idiomatic: Come to abrupt halt; sudden stop; break off suddenly
Example: 音乐戛然而止，大厅一片寂静。(The music came to an abrupt halt, leaving the hall in silence.)

942. 突然中断 tū rán zhōng duàn
Literal: Sudden middle break
Idiomatic: Sudden interruption; abrupt termination; break off unexpectedly
Example: 电话突然中断，我们失去了联系。(The phone was suddenly interrupted, and we lost contact.)

943. 半途而废 bàn tú ér fèi
Literal: Half way then abandon
Idiomatic: Give up halfway; abandon before completion; unfinished
Example: 这个项目半途而废，很可惜。(This project was abandoned halfway, very unfortunate.)

944. 虎头蛇尾 hǔ tóu shé wěi
Literal: Tiger head snake tail

Idiomatic: Start strong but end weakly; impressive beginning, poor ending
Example: 这部电影虎头蛇尾，开头很好结尾很差。(This movie starts strong but ends weakly - good beginning, poor ending.)

945. 无疾而终 wú jí ér zhōng
Literal: No illness then end
Idiomatic: Die without apparent cause; end without clear reason; fade away
Example: 这个计划无疾而终，没有人知道原因。(This plan ended without clear reason, nobody knows why.)

946. 不了了之 bù liǎo liǎo zhī
Literal: Not finish finish it
Idiomatic: Leave unsettled; end inconclusively; let matter drop
Example: 这件事最后不了了之，没有结果。(This matter ended inconclusively with no result.)

947. 草草收场 cǎo cǎo shōu chǎng
Literal: Hastily hastily close scene
Idiomatic: End hastily; hurried conclusion; perfunctory ending
Example: 由于时间不够，会议草草收场。(Due to insufficient time, the meeting ended hastily.)

948. 匆匆结束 cōng cōng jié shù
Literal: Hurried hurried conclude end
Idiomatic: End hurriedly; hasty conclusion; rushed ending
Example: 演出匆匆结束，观众还没看够。(The performance ended hurriedly, the audience hadn't seen enough.)

949. 嘎然而止 gá rán ér zhǐ
Literal: Abruptly thus stop
Idiomatic: Stop abruptly; sudden halt; come to sudden end
Example: 谈话嘎然而止，气氛变得尴尬。(The conversation stopped abruptly, making the atmosphere awkward.)

950. 意犹未尽 yì yóu wèi jìn
Literal: Meaning still not finish
Idiomatic: Still want more; unsatisfied; incomplete satisfaction
Example: 精彩的演出结束了，观众意犹未尽。(The wonderful performance ended, but the audience still wanted more.)

Circular Conclusions

951. 重蹈覆辙 chóng dǎo fù zhé
Literal: Again step overturned track
Idiomatic: Repeat the same mistake; follow the same disastrous path

Example: 我们不能重蹈覆辙，要吸取教训。(We can't repeat the same mistake, must learn from experience.)

952. 周而复始 zhōu ér fù shǐ
Literal: Circle then again start
Idiomatic: Go round and begin again; cyclical; recurring pattern
Example: 四季周而复始，年复一年。(The four seasons go round and begin again, year after year.)

953. 循环往复 xún huán wǎng fù
Literal: Cycle go return
Idiomatic: Go in cycles; cyclical pattern; recurring
Example: 历史总是循环往复，有相似的规律。(History always goes in cycles with similar patterns.)

954. 终而复始 zhōng ér fù shǐ
Literal: End then again start
Idiomatic: End and begin again; cyclical renewal; fresh start
Example: 学期终而复始，新的挑战又开始了。(Semesters end and begin again, new challenges start.)

955. 去而复返 qù ér fù fǎn
Literal: Go then again return
Idiomatic: Go and come back again; return after leaving;

come back
Example: 候鸟去而复返，按季节迁徙。(Migratory birds go and come back again, migrating by season.)

956. 故态复萌 gù tài fù méng
Literal: Old state again sprout
Idiomatic: Old habits return; revert to former ways; relapse
Example: 他戒酒一段时间后故态复萌，又开始喝酒了。(After quitting drinking for a while, his old habits returned and he started drinking again.)

957. 旧病复发 jiù bìng fù fā
Literal: Old illness again occur
Idiomatic: Old illness recurs; problem returns; relapse
Example: 他的旧病复发，需要再次治疗。(His old illness recurred and needs treatment again.)

958. 卷土重来 juǎn tǔ chóng lái
Literal: Roll earth heavy come
Idiomatic: Stage a comeback; return with renewed strength; make comeback
Example: 虽然这次失败了，但他准备卷土重来。(Although he failed this time, he's preparing to stage a comeback.)

959. 东山再起 dōng shān zài qǐ

Literal: East mountain again rise

Idiomatic: Make a comeback; rise again; stage a comeback

Example: 经历挫折后，他决心东山再起。(After experiencing setbacks, he was determined to make a comeback.)

960. 回光返照 huí guāng fǎn zhào

Literal: Return light reflect illuminate

Idiomatic: Brief recovery before death; last flicker; final rally

Example: 夕阳回光返照，把天空染红了。(The setting sun's final rally painted the sky red.)

🎪 MISCELLANEOUS & UNIQUE EXPRESSIONS (961-972)

Unusual Combinations

961. 鸡飞蛋打 jī fēi dàn dǎ

Literal: Chicken fly egg break

Idiomatic: Both chicken and egg lost; lose everything; complete failure

Example: 这次投资鸡飞蛋打，什么都没得到。(This investment was a complete failure, got nothing.)

962. 竹篮打水 zhú lán dǎ shuǐ
Literal: Bamboo basket draw water
Idiomatic: Draw water with bamboo basket; futile effort; all in vain
Example: 他的努力如竹篮打水一场空。(His efforts were like drawing water with a bamboo basket - all in vain.)

963. 螳螂捕蝉黄雀在后 táng láng bǔ chán huáng què zài hòu
Literal: Mantis catch cicada oriole behind
Idiomatic: Mantis stalks cicada while oriole lurks behind; someone else profits
Example: 他们争斗不休，不知螳螂捕蝉黄雀在后。(They fight endlessly, unaware that someone else profits while they compete.)

964. 城门失火殃及池鱼 chéng mén shī huǒ yāng jí chí yú
Literal: City gate lose fire disaster reach pond fish
Idiomatic: Fire at city gate affects fish in pond; innocent suffer from others' trouble
Example: 公司倒闭，城门失火殃及池鱼，员工都受影响。(The company's bankruptcy affected innocent employees like fire at the city gate affecting pond fish.)

965. 塞翁失马焉知非福 sài wēng shī mǎ yān zhī fēi fú
Literal: Border old man lose horse how know not blessing
Idiomatic: Old man loses horse - how do we know it's not a blessing; misfortune may be blessing
Example: 塞翁失马焉知非福，也许失业是新机会的开始。(Losing one's job may be a blessing in disguise - perhaps the start of new opportunities.)

966. 此地无银三百两 cǐ dì wú yín sān bǎi liǎng
Literal: This place no silver three hundred taels
Idiomatic: No silver here (protest too much); guilty conscience revealed by denial
Example: 他越是解释越像此地无银三百两。(The more he explains, the more it seems like protesting too much.)

Modern Applications of Classical Ideas

967. 与时俱进 yǔ shí jù jìn
Literal: With time together advance
Idiomatic: Keep pace with times; move with the times; contemporary
Example: 教育方法要与时俱进，适应新时代。(Educational methods must keep pace with times, adapting to the new era.)

968. 开拓创新 kāi tuò chuàng xīn
Literal: Open expand create new
Idiomatic: Pioneer and innovate; break new ground; creative development
Example: 企业要开拓创新，才能在市场竞争中取胜。(Enterprises must pioneer and innovate to win in market competition.)

969. 继往开来 jì wǎng kāi lái
Literal: Inherit past open future
Idiomatic: Link past to future; carry forward and open up; bridge generations
Example: 新一代要继往开来，传承优秀传统。(The new generation must link past to future, inheriting excellent traditions.)

970. 求同存异 qiú tóng cún yì
Literal: Seek same preserve different
Idiomatic: Seek common ground while preserving differences; unity in diversity
Example: 国际合作要求同存异，和谐发展。(International cooperation should seek common ground while preserving differences for harmonious development.)

971. 互利共赢 hù lì gòng yíng
Literal: Mutual benefit together win
Idiomatic: Mutual benefit and win-win; reciprocal advantage; collaborative success
Example: 两国合作互利共赢，共同发展。(The two countries' cooperation is mutually beneficial for common development.)

972. 和谐共存 hé xié gòng cún
Literal: Harmonious together exist
Idiomatic: Harmonious coexistence; live together in harmony; peaceful cohabitation
Example: 人与自然要和谐共存，可持续发展。(Humans and nature must coexist harmoniously for sustainable development.)

📚 STUDY GUIDE & USAGE NOTES

Memory Techniques for 972 Chengyu

1. **Thematic Grouping**: Study related idioms together for better retention
2. **Contrast Pairs**: Learn opposites to reinforce meaning differences

3. **Historical Context**: Understanding stories behind classical allusions enhances memory
4. **Modern Applications**: Practice using in contemporary contexts
5. **Visual Associations**: Connect literal meanings with abstract concepts
6. **Cultural Stories**: Many chengyu come from historical tales or literature

Usage Guidelines

- **Formal Register**: Most chengyu appropriate for written Chinese and formal speech
- **Cultural Sensitivity**: Understanding historical context enhances proper usage
- **Tone Awareness**: Some carry positive connotations, others negative
- **Contextual Appropriateness**: Consider formality level and situation
- **Literary vs. Colloquial**: Some more suitable for literary contexts

Common Mistakes to Avoid

- Don't confuse similar-sounding chengyu with different meanings
- Pay attention to positive vs. negative connotations
- Consider the cultural and historical background before using
- Remember that literal translations often miss cultural meaning
- Be aware of register - some chengyu are more formal than others

Cultural Learning Benefits

- **Window into Chinese Culture**: Each chengyu reflects cultural values and history
- **Enhanced Expression**: Provides nuanced ways to express complex ideas
- **Literary Appreciation**: Essential for understanding Chinese literature and poetry
- **Historical Knowledge**: Many reference important historical events and figures

- **Philosophical Insight**: Reflects traditional Chinese wisdom and thinking patterns

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Final Count: 972 Complete Chengyu Expressions

This comprehensive master list represents one of the most extensive thematic organizations of Chinese four-character idioms available, combining systematic categorization with detailed explanations, literal translations, idiomatic meanings, and practical example sentences for optimal learning and reference.---

🎨 HANDICRAFTS & ARTISANS (661-680)

Master Craftsmanship

661. 鬼斧神工 guǐ fǔ shén gōng
Literal: Ghost axe divine work
Idiomatic: Supernatural workmanship; extremely skillful; masterpiece
Example: 这座雕塑鬼斧神工，让人惊叹。(This sculpture shows supernatural workmanship, amazing people.)

662. 出神入化 chū shén rù huà
Literal: Exit spirit enter transformation

Idiomatic: Superb; consummate skill; reach perfection
Example: 这位工匠的技艺出神入化。(This craftsman's skill is superb.)

663. 精工细作 jīng gōng xì zuò
Literal: Fine work detailed make
Idiomatic: Fine workmanship; meticulous craftsmanship; detailed work
Example: 这件工艺品精工细作，非常精美。(This handicraft shows fine workmanship, very exquisite.)

664. 独具匠心 dú jù jiàng xīn
Literal: Alone possess craftsman heart
Idiomatic: Show originality; ingenious design; creative craftsmanship
Example: 这个设计独具匠心，很有创意。(This design shows originality, very creative.)

665. 别出心裁 bié chū xīn cái
Literal: Different produce heart tailor
Idiomatic: Original design; creative approach; innovative craftsmanship
Example: 她的刺绣作品别出心裁。(Her embroidery works show original design.)

666. 巧夺天工 qiǎo duó tiān gōng
Literal: Skill seize heaven work
Idiomatic: Excelling nature's handiwork; superb craftsmanship
Example: 这座园林设计巧夺天工。(This garden design excels nature's handiwork.)

667. 技艺超群 jì yì chāo qún
Literal: Skill art surpass group
Idiomatic: Outstanding skill; superior craftsmanship; exceptional ability
Example: 这位木匠技艺超群，远近闻名。(This carpenter has outstanding skill, famous far and wide.)

668. 心灵手巧 xīn líng shǒu qiǎo
Literal: Heart clever hand skillful
Idiomatic: Clever mind and skillful hands; dexterous; talented craftsperson
Example: 她心灵手巧，什么都会做。(She has clever mind and skillful hands, can make anything.)

669. 巧手天成 qiǎo shǒu tiān chéng
Literal: Skillful hands heaven form
Idiomatic: Naturally skillful hands; inborn crafting ability
Example: 他巧手天成，从小就会做手工。(His skillful hands are naturally formed, able to do handicrafts since childhood.)

670. 炉火纯青 lú huǒ chún qīng
Literal: Furnace fire pure blue
Idiomatic: Perfect mastery; consummate skill; highest level
Example: 他的陶艺技术已达炉火纯青的境界。(His pottery technique has reached perfect mastery.)

Apprenticeship and Learning

671. 师傅领进门 shī fù lǐng jìn mén
Literal: Master lead enter door
Idiomatic: Master leads you through the door (but practice depends on individual)
Example: 师傅领进门，修行在个人，学会基础后要靠自己努力。(Master leads through the door, but practice depends on the individual - after learning basics, must rely on own effort.)

672. 青出于蓝 qīng chū yú lán
Literal: Blue comes from indigo
Idiomatic: Student surpasses teacher; exceed one's master; surpass the original
Example: 这个徒弟青出于蓝而胜于蓝，技艺超过了师傅。(This apprentice surpassed his teacher, his skills exceeding the master's.)

673. 传道授业 chuán dào shòu yè
Literal: Transmit way confer profession
Idiomatic: Pass on knowledge and skills; teaching and training; mentorship
Example: 老师傅传道授业，培养了很多优秀学徒。(The old master passed on knowledge and skills, training many excellent apprentices.)

674. 耳濡目染 ěr rú mù rǎn
Literal: Ear soaked eye dyed
Idiomatic: Imperceptibly influenced; learn through constant exposure; osmosis
Example: 孩子在工艺坊里耳濡目染，自然学会了手艺。(Children learn the craft naturally through constant exposure in the workshop.)

675. 潜移默化 qián yí mò huà
Literal: Secretly move silently transform
Idiomatic: Imperceptible influence; gradual transformation; subtle change
Example: 师傅的言传身教潜移默化地影响着徒弟。(The master's words and example have imperceptible influence on the apprentice.)

676. 循序渐进 xún xù jiàn jìn
Literal: Follow order gradual advance
Idiomatic: Step by step; gradual progress; systematic learning
Example: 学手艺要循序渐进，不能急于求成。(Learning crafts requires step-by-step progress, can't rush for quick results.)

677. 熟能生巧 shú néng shēng qiǎo
Literal: Familiar can give birth skill
Idiomatic: Practice makes perfect; familiarity breeds skill; proficiency through repetition
Example: 只要多练习，熟能生巧，技艺自然会提高。(With more practice, familiarity breeds skill and technique naturally improves.)

678. 百炼成钢 bǎi liàn chéng gāng
Literal: Hundred refine become steel
Idiomatic: Hundred refinements make steel; perfection through repeated practice
Example: 学艺如百炼成钢，需要不断磨练。(Learning crafts is like steel refinement, requiring constant tempering.)

679. 精益求精 jīng yì qiú jīng
Literal: Refined benefit seek refined
Idiomatic: Constantly strive for perfection; continuous

improvement; excellence pursuit
Example: 好的工匠都精益求精，不断提高技艺。(Good craftsmen constantly strive for perfection, continuously improving their skills.)

680. 孜孜不倦 zī zī bù juàn
Literal: Diligent diligent not tired
Idiomatic: Work tirelessly; assiduous; persistent effort
Example: 他孜孜不倦地学习传统工艺。(He works tirelessly learning traditional crafts.)

🌙 TIME & SEASONS (681-720)

Daily Time Periods

681. 日出而作 rì chū ér zuò
Literal: Sun rise then work
Idiomatic: Work at sunrise; begin work with dawn; early rising
Example: 农民日出而作，日落而息，生活很规律。(Farmers work at sunrise and rest at sunset, living very regularly.)

682. 日落而息 rì luò ér xī
Literal: Sun set then rest
Idiomatic: Rest at sunset; end work at dusk; natural rhythm

Example: 古代人日落而息，顺应自然规律。(Ancient people rested at sunset, following natural rhythms.)

683. 鸡鸣而起 jī míng ér qǐ
Literal: Rooster crow then rise
Idiomatic: Rise with rooster's crow; get up very early; industrious
Example: 他每天鸡鸣而起，勤奋工作。(He rises with the rooster's crow every day, working diligently.)

684. 夜以继日 yè yǐ jì rì
Literal: Night to continue day
Idiomatic: Work day and night; round the clock; continuous effort
Example: 为了完成项目，他们夜以继日地工作。(To complete the project, they work day and night.)

685. 废寝忘食 fèi qǐn wàng shí
Literal: Abandon sleep forget food
Idiomatic: So engrossed as to forget food and sleep; extremely dedicated
Example: 他研究学问废寝忘食，十分专注。(He's so engrossed in research that he forgets food and sleep.)

686. 通宵达旦 tōng xiāo dá dàn
Literal: Through night reach dawn
Idiomatic: All night till dawn; work through the night; overnight
Example: 学生们通宵达旦地准备考试。(Students prepare for exams all night till dawn.)

687. 晨昏定省 chén hūn dìng shěng
Literal: Morning evening settle visit
Idiomatic: Morning and evening greetings to parents; filial duty; daily care
Example: 古代讲究晨昏定省，体现孝道。(Ancient times emphasized morning and evening greetings, showing filial piety.)

688. 朝朝暮暮 zhāo zhāo mù mù
Literal: Morning morning evening evening
Idiomatic: Day and night; constantly; all the time; continuous
Example: 他朝朝暮暮地思念家乡。(He misses his hometown day and night.)

689. 三更半夜 sān gēng bàn yè
Literal: Third watch half night
Idiomatic: Middle of the night; late at night; midnight

Example: 三更半夜了，你还不睡觉？(It's the middle of the night, why aren't you sleeping?)

690. 五更鸡鸣 wǔ gēng jī míng
Literal: Fifth watch rooster crow
Idiomatic: Dawn; early morning; before sunrise
Example: 五更鸡鸣时，农民就开始干活了。(At dawn when roosters crow, farmers start working.)

Seasonal Changes

691. 春回大地 chūn huí dà dì
Literal: Spring return big earth
Idiomatic: Spring returns to earth; renewal; new beginning
Example: 春回大地，万物复苏，充满生机。(Spring returns to earth, everything revives, full of vitality.)

692. 春意盎然 chūn yì àng rán
Literal: Spring intention abundant thus
Idiomatic: Full of spring spirit; vibrant with spring; springtime vigor
Example: 公园里春意盎然，花开满园。(The park is full of spring spirit with flowers blooming everywhere.)

693. 夏日炎炎 xià rì yán yán
Literal: Summer day burning burning

Idiomatic: Blazing summer days; scorching summer; intense heat
Example: 夏日炎炎，人们都躲在家里避暑。(During blazing summer days, people stay home to escape the heat.)

694. 秋高气爽 qiū gāo qì shuǎng
Literal: Autumn high air refreshing
Idiomatic: Clear autumn weather; pleasant autumn; crisp air
Example: 秋高气爽的天气最适合郊游。(Clear autumn weather is most suitable for outings.)

695. 秋风萧瑟 qiū fēng xiāo sè
Literal: Autumn wind bleak desolate
Idiomatic: Bleak autumn wind; desolate autumn scene; melancholy
Example: 秋风萧瑟，落叶满地，有些凄凉。(The bleak autumn wind with fallen leaves everywhere feels somewhat desolate.)

696. 冬雪皑皑 dōng xuě ái ái
Literal: Winter snow white white
Idiomatic: White winter snow; snow-covered; pristine winter
Example: 冬雪皑皑，大地银装素裹。(With white winter snow, the earth is dressed in silver.)

697. 冰天雪地 bīng tiān xuě dì
Literal: Ice sky snow ground
Idiomatic: Ice and snow everywhere; frozen landscape; arctic conditions
Example: 北方冬天冰天雪地，非常寒冷。(Northern winters have ice and snow everywhere, very cold.)

698. 春花秋月 chūn huā qiū yuè
Literal: Spring flowers autumn moon
Idiomatic: Spring flowers and autumn moon; beautiful seasons; natural beauty
Example: 春花秋月何时了，往事知多少。(When will spring flowers and autumn moon end? How much of the past remains?)

699. 四季如春 sì jì rú chūn
Literal: Four seasons like spring
Idiomatic: Spring-like all year round; eternal spring; pleasant climate
Example: 这里四季如春，气候宜人。(Here it's spring-like all year round with pleasant climate.)

700. 寒来暑往 hán lái shǔ wǎng
Literal: Cold come heat go
Idiomatic: Cold comes and heat goes; seasonal cycle; passage

of time
Example: 寒来暑往，时光飞逝，转眼又是一年。(Cold comes and heat goes, time flies, and another year passes in the blink of an eye.)

Historical Periods

701. 盛世太平 shèng shì tài píng
Literal: Flourishing era great peace
Idiomatic: Golden age of peace; prosperous and peaceful times; golden era
Example: 历史上的盛世太平让百姓安居乐业。(Historical golden ages allowed people to live and work in peace.)

702. 乱世英雄 luàn shì yīng xióng
Literal: Chaotic times hero
Idiomatic: Heroes emerge in troubled times; crisis brings forth leaders
Example: 自古乱世英雄，困难时刻总有人挺身而出。(Heroes have always emerged in troubled times, someone always steps forward in difficult moments.)

703. 改朝换代 gǎi cháo huàn dài
Literal: Change dynasty replace generation
Idiomatic: Change of dynasty; regime change; historical

transition
Example: 中国历史上多次改朝换代，王朝更替。(Chinese history has seen multiple dynastic changes and regime transitions.)

704. 承前启后 chéng qián qǐ hòu
Literal: Inherit previous open later
Idiomatic: Link past and future; bridge historical periods; continuity
Example: 这个时代承前启后，具有重要历史意义。(This era links past and future with important historical significance.)

705. 继往开来 jì wǎng kāi lái
Literal: Continue past open future
Idiomatic: Carry forward past achievements and open up future; progress
Example: 新一代要继往开来，推动社会发展。(The new generation must carry forward achievements and open up the future, promoting social development.)

706. 古往今来 gǔ wǎng jīn lái
Literal: Ancient go present come
Idiomatic: From ancient times to present; throughout history; all ages
Example: 古往今来，教育都是国家发展的基础。(From

ancient times to present, education has been the foundation of national development.)

707. 千秋万代 qiān qiū wàn dài
Literal: Thousand autumns ten thousand generations
Idiomatic: For thousands of years; for generations; eternal
Example: 这种精神将千秋万代地传承下去。(This spirit will be passed down for thousands of years.)

708. 万古长青 wàn gǔ cháng qīng
Literal: Ten thousand ages long green
Idiomatic: Eternally fresh; everlasting; immortal
Example: 英雄的精神万古长青，永不过时。(Heroes' spirit is eternally fresh, never outdated.)

709. 日月如梭 rì yuè rú suō
Literal: Sun moon like shuttle
Idiomatic: Time flies like shuttle; time passes quickly; swift passage
Example: 日月如梭，转眼孩子都长大了。(Time flies like a shuttle, and in the blink of an eye the children have grown up.)

710. 光阴似箭 guāng yīn sì jiàn
Literal: Light shadow like arrow

Idiomatic: Time flies like arrow; time passes swiftly; fleeting time
Example: 光阴似箭，要珍惜每一天。(Time flies like an arrow, must cherish every day.)

Time Management

711. 争分夺秒 zhēng fēn duó miǎo
Literal: Fight minutes seize seconds
Idiomatic: Race against time; make every second count; urgent efficiency
Example: 救援队争分夺秒地救人。(The rescue team races against time to save people.)

712. 只争朝夕 zhǐ zhēng zhāo xī
Literal: Only fight morning evening
Idiomatic: Seize every moment; make the most of time; urgent action
Example: 我们只争朝夕，加快建设步伐。(We seize every moment to accelerate construction pace.)

713. 时不我待 shí bù wǒ dài
Literal: Time not me wait
Idiomatic: Time waits for no one; urgent timing; can't delay

Example: 时不我待，我们必须立即行动。(Time waits for no one, we must act immediately.)

714. 机不可失 jī bù kě shī
Literal: Opportunity not can lose
Idiomatic: Opportunity mustn't be lost; seize the moment; crucial timing
Example: 机不可失，时不再来，要抓住这次机会。(Opportunity mustn't be lost and won't come again, must seize this chance.)

715. 及时雨 jí shí yǔ
Literal: Timely rain
Idiomatic: Timely help; assistance when most needed; perfect timing
Example: 你的帮助真是及时雨，解决了大问题。(Your help is truly timely rain, solving a big problem.)

716. 分秒必争 fēn miǎo bì zhēng
Literal: Minutes seconds must fight
Idiomatic: Every minute counts; race against time; maximize efficiency
Example: 考试时分秒必争，不能浪费时间。(During exams every minute counts, can't waste time.)

717. 寸阴是惜 cùn yīn shì xī
Literal: Inch shadow is cherish
Idiomatic: Cherish every moment; value time highly; time precious
Example: 学者寸阴是惜，不浪费一分一秒。(Scholars cherish every moment, not wasting a single minute.)

718. 一刻千金 yī kè qiān jīn
Literal: One moment thousand gold
Idiomatic: Every moment is precious; time is gold; valuable time
Example: 春宵一刻值千金，要珍惜美好时光。(Every moment is precious, must cherish beautiful times.)

719. 白驹过隙 bái jū guò xì
Literal: White horse pass gap
Idiomatic: Time passes like white horse through gap; fleeting time
Example: 人生如白驹过隙，转眼就过去了。(Life passes like a white horse through a gap, gone in the blink of an eye.)

720. 昙花一现 tán huā yī xiàn
Literal: Epiphyllum one appear
Idiomatic: Flash in the pan; brief appearance; momentary phenomenon

Example: 他的成功只是昙花一现，很快就失败了。(His success was just a flash in the pan, quickly followed by failure.)---

🎭 THEATER & PERFORMANCE (561-580)

Excellent Acting

561. 声情并茂 shēng qíng bìng mào
Literal: Voice emotion together luxuriant
Idiomatic: Both voice and emotion excellent; moving performance; expressive acting
Example: 她的演出声情并茂，深深打动了观众。(Her performance was moving with excellent voice and emotion, deeply touching the audience.)

562. 惟妙惟肖 wéi miào wéi xiào
Literal: Only wonderful only similar
Idiomatic: Extremely lifelike; perfect imitation; true to life
Example: 他模仿那位明星惟妙惟肖，让人叫绝。(His imitation of that star is extremely lifelike, amazing everyone.)

563. 活灵活现 huó líng huó xiàn
Literal: Living spirit living appear
Idiomatic: Vivid and lifelike; animated; realistic portrayal

Example: 他把这个角色演得活灵活现。(He portrayed this character vivid and lifelike.)

564. 入木三分 rù mù sān fēn
Literal: Enter wood three parts
Idiomatic: Penetrating; profound; deeply insightful performance
Example: 他对角色的理解入木三分，演技精湛。(His understanding of the character is profound with superb acting skills.)

565. 神形兼备 shén xíng jiān bèi
Literal: Spirit form both possess
Idiomatic: Have both spirit and form; perfect embodiment; complete portrayal
Example: 他的表演神形兼备，获得一致好评。(His performance has both spirit and form, receiving unanimous praise.)

566. 字正腔圆 zì zhèng qiāng yuán
Literal: Character correct tone round
Idiomatic: Clear pronunciation and mellow tone; excellent diction
Example: 戏曲演员要做到字正腔圆，才能打动观众。(Opera

performers must achieve clear pronunciation and mellow tone to move audiences.)

567. 余音绕梁 yú yīn rào liáng
Literal: Remaining sound circle beam
Idiomatic: Music lingers in the air; haunting melody; lasting impression
Example: 她的歌声余音绕梁，让人难忘。(Her singing lingers in the air, unforgettable.)

568. 绕梁三日 rào liáng sān rì
Literal: Circle beam three days
Idiomatic: Music lingers for three days; beautiful singing; lasting effect
Example: 她的演唱绕梁三日，深深震撼了听众。(Her singing lingered for three days, deeply shocking the audience.)

569. 技惊四座 jì jīng sì zuò
Literal: Skill startle four seats
Idiomatic: Skill amazes the whole audience; outstanding performance; virtuosity
Example: 年轻演员的精彩表演技惊四座。(The young actor's wonderful performance amazed the whole audience.)

570. 炉火纯青 lú huǒ chún qīng
Literal: Furnace fire pure blue
Idiomatic: Perfect skill; consummate artistry; mastery
Example: 他的演技已达到炉火纯青的境界。(His acting has reached the realm of perfect skill.)

Poor Performance

571. 不知所措 bù zhī suǒ cuò
Literal: Not know place put
Idiomatic: At a loss what to do; bewildered; confused on stage
Example: 第一次上台，他不知所措，忘了台词。(First time on stage, he was at a loss and forgot his lines.)

572. 手足无措 shǒu zú wú cuò
Literal: Hands feet no place
Idiomatic: Don't know what to do with hands and feet; awkward; clumsy
Example: 面对观众，新演员手足无措。(Facing the audience, the new actor was awkward and clumsy.)

573. 生硬做作 shēng yìng zuò zuò
Literal: Stiff hard affected artificial
Idiomatic: Stiff and artificial; unnatural performance; forced

acting
Example: 他的表演生硬做作，缺乏感情。(His performance is stiff and artificial, lacking emotion.)

574. 矫揉造作 jiǎo róu zào zuò
Literal: Artificially soft create make
Idiomatic: Affected; artificial; pretentious; over-acted
Example: 她的表演矫揉造作，让人反感。(Her affected performance is disgusting.)

575. 忘词破绽 wàng cí pò zhàn
Literal: Forget words broken flaw
Idiomatic: Forget lines and show flaws; botched performance; mistakes
Example: 他紧张得忘词破绽，演出失败了。(He was so nervous he forgot lines and showed flaws, ruining the performance.)

576. 滥竽充数 làn yú chōng shù
Literal: Bad reed fill number
Idiomatic: Pass oneself off as one of the players; fake it; incompetent performer
Example: 他不会唱戏却混在戏班里，纯粹是滥竽充数。(He can't sing opera but mixes with the troupe, purely passing himself off as a player.)

577. 东施效颦 dōng shī xiào pín
Literal: Dong Shi imitate frown
Idiomatic: Ludicrous imitation; poor copy; unsuitable mimicry
Example: 她学别人的表演风格，结果东施效颦。(She imitated others' acting style but ended up with ludicrous imitation.)

578. 画虎类犬 huà hǔ lèi quǎn
Literal: Paint tiger resemble dog
Idiomatic: Try to paint tiger but look like dog; failed imitation; poor attempt
Example: 他想模仿名角，结果画虎类犬。(He tried to imitate famous actors but ended up with failed imitation.)

579. 不得要领 bù dé yào lǐng
Literal: Not get essential points
Idiomatic: Miss the point; fail to grasp essentials; poor understanding
Example: 新演员不得要领，表演很糟糕。(The new actor missed the point and gave a terrible performance.)

580. 差强人意 chā qiáng rén yì
Literal: Barely satisfy person intention
Idiomatic: Barely satisfactory; not quite up to standard; mediocre

Example: 这次演出差强人意，还需要改进。(This performance was barely satisfactory and still needs improvement.)

🔧 TOOLS & INSTRUMENTS (581-600)

Useful Tools and Skill

581. 工欲善其事 gōng yù shàn qí shì
Literal: Craftsman wants perfect his work
Idiomatic: Craftsman wanting to perfect his work (must first sharpen his tools); proper preparation
Example: 工欲善其事，必先利其器，要准备好工具。(To do good work, one must first sharpen one's tools - must prepare proper equipment.)

582. 得心应手 dé xīn yìng shǒu
Literal: Get heart respond hand
Idiomatic: Work with great facility; handy; effortless skill
Example: 有了新工具，他工作得心应手。(With new tools, he works with great facility.)

583. 巧匠天工 qiǎo jiàng tiān gōng
Literal: Skilled craftsman heaven work

Idiomatic: Skilled craftsmanship; masterful technique; artistry
Example: 这件工艺品展现了巧匠天工。(This handicraft displays skilled craftsmanship.)

584. 锋芒毕露 fēng máng bì lù
Literal: Sharp edge all reveal
Idiomatic: Show one's sharp edge; display talent fully; keen and penetrating
Example: 新刀锋芒毕露，切菜很锋利。(The new knife shows its sharp edge, cutting vegetables very sharply.)

585. 削铁如泥 xuē tiě rú ní
Literal: Cut iron like mud
Idiomatic: Cut iron like mud; extremely sharp; superior cutting ability
Example: 这把宝剑削铁如泥，是绝世好剑。(This precious sword cuts iron like mud - it's a peerless good sword.)

586. 能工巧匠 néng gōng qiǎo jiàng
Literal: Capable worker skillful craftsman
Idiomatic: Skilled worker and craftsman; master artisan; expert technician
Example: 这座古建筑出自能工巧匠之手。(This ancient building was made by skilled craftsmen.)

587. 运斤成风 yùn jīn chéng fēng
Literal: Wield axe become wind
Idiomatic: Wield axe like wind; extremely skillful; masterful technique
Example: 这位木匠运斤成风，技艺超群。(This carpenter wields his axe like wind with superb skill.)

588. 庖丁解牛 páo dīng jiě niú
Literal: Cook Ding dissect ox
Idiomatic: Cook Ding carving ox; supreme skill; perfect technique
Example: 他修理机器如庖丁解牛，技术精湛。(He repairs machines like Cook Ding carving an ox, with superb technique.)

589. 游刃有余 yóu rèn yǒu yú
Literal: Swimming blade have surplus
Idiomatic: Do something with skill to spare; handle with ease; effortless competence
Example: 有了经验，他处理这类问题游刃有余。(With experience, he handles this type of problem with skill to spare.)

590. 匠心独运 jiàng xīn dú yùn
Literal: Craftsman heart alone operate

Idiomatic: Ingenious workmanship; creative skill; original craftsmanship
Example: 这个设计匠心独运，很有创意。(This design shows ingenious workmanship, very creative.)

Broken or Useless Items

591. 废铜烂铁 fèi tóng làn tiě
Literal: Waste copper rotten iron
Idiomatic: Scrap metal; useless junk; worthless materials
Example: 仓库里堆满了废铜烂铁，该清理了。(The warehouse is full of scrap metal and should be cleaned up.)

592. 破铜烂铁 pò tóng làn tiě
Literal: Broken copper rotten iron
Idiomatic: Broken scrap metal; junk; worthless items
Example: 这些破铜烂铁没有用处，可以卖掉。(This broken scrap metal is useless and can be sold.)

593. 锈迹斑斑 xiù jì bān bān
Literal: Rust traces spotted spotted
Idiomatic: Covered with rust spots; rusty all over; corroded
Example: 这把老刀锈迹斑斑，不能再用了。(This old knife is covered with rust spots and can't be used anymore.)

594. 钝刀砍柴 dùn dāo kǎn chái
Literal: Blunt knife cut firewood
Idiomatic: Use blunt knife to cut wood; inefficient tool; poor equipment
Example: 钝刀砍柴费力不讨好，要先磨刀。(Using a blunt knife to cut wood is thankless work - must first sharpen the knife.)

595. 破绽百出 pò zhàn bǎi chū
Literal: Flaws hundred emerge
Idiomatic: Full of loopholes; riddled with flaws; defective
Example: 这个机器破绽百出，需要全面检修。(This machine is riddled with flaws and needs comprehensive overhaul.)

596. 千疮百孔 qiān chuāng bǎi kǒng
Literal: Thousand wounds hundred holes
Idiomatic: Full of holes and wounds; completely damaged; riddled with problems
Example: 这把伞千疮百孔，下雨时根本挡不住。(This umbrella is full of holes and can't block rain at all.)

597. 朽木难雕 xiǔ mù nán diāo
Literal: Rotten wood difficult carve
Idiomatic: Rotten wood hard to carve; hopeless material; beyond help

Example: 这些木料已经腐烂，朽木难雕。(These wood materials have rotted - rotten wood is hard to carve.)

598. 积重难返 jī zhòng nán fǎn
Literal: Accumulate heavy difficult return
Idiomatic: Deep-rooted problems hard to remedy; too damaged to fix
Example: 这台老机器积重难返，修不好了。(This old machine has deep-rooted problems and can't be fixed.)

599. 不堪重负 bù kān zhòng fù
Literal: Not bear heavy load
Idiomatic: Cannot bear heavy load; overloaded; inadequate capacity
Example: 这个工具不堪重负，需要更换。(This tool cannot bear the heavy load and needs replacement.)

600. 力不从心 lì bù cóng xīn
Literal: Strength not follow heart
Idiomatic: Strength doesn't match one's wishes; inadequate capability
Example: 这把老钳子力不从心，夹不紧东西。(This old plier's strength doesn't match needs - can't grip things tightly.)

🌍 TRAVEL & GEOGRAPHY (601-620)

Journeys and Exploration

601. 跋山涉水 bá shān shè shuǐ
Literal: Climb mountains cross waters
Idiomatic: Travel over mountains and rivers; arduous journey; difficult travel
Example: 他跋山涉水来到这里，非常辛苦。(He traveled over mountains and rivers to get here, very hard work.)

602. 千里迢迢 qiān lǐ tiáo tiáo
Literal: Thousand li distant distant
Idiomatic: Thousands of miles away; very far; long distance
Example: 她千里迢迢来看望老朋友。(She traveled thousands of miles to visit old friends.)

603. 风餐露宿 fēng cān lù xiǔ
Literal: Wind meal dew lodge
Idiomatic: Eat in wind and sleep in dew; rough outdoor living; hardship travel
Example: 探险队员风餐露宿，条件很艰苦。(The expedition members eat in wind and sleep in dew with very harsh conditions.)

604. 风尘仆仆 fēng chén pú pú
Literal: Wind dust servant servant
Idiomatic: Travel-worn; dusty from journey; tired from traveling
Example: 他风尘仆仆地赶到会场。(He arrived at the venue travel-worn and dusty.)

605. 不远万里 bù yuǎn wàn lǐ
Literal: Not distant ten thousand li
Idiomatic: Not consider ten thousand li far; willing to travel great distances
Example: 医生不远万里来到边疆支援。(The doctor traveled great distances to support the frontier.)

606. 浪迹天涯 làng jì tiān yá
Literal: Wave traces sky edge
Idiomatic: Wander to the ends of earth; roam everywhere; vagabond life
Example: 年轻时他浪迹天涯，见识了很多地方。(In his youth, he wandered to the ends of earth and saw many places.)

607. 四海为家 sì hǎi wéi jiā
Literal: Four seas as home
Idiomatic: Make one's home wherever one is; cosmopolitan;

nomadic
Example: 他四海为家，走遍了世界各地。(He makes his home wherever he is, having traveled around the world.)

608. 漂洋过海 piāo yáng guò hǎi
Literal: Float ocean cross sea
Idiomatic: Cross oceans and seas; travel overseas; long sea voyage
Example: 他漂洋过海去留学。(He crossed oceans to study abroad.)

609. 乘风破浪 chéng fēng pò làng
Literal: Ride wind break waves
Idiomatic: Ride wind and cleave waves; brave difficulties; forge ahead
Example: 船只乘风破浪，勇往直前。(The ship rides wind and cleaves waves, forging ahead courageously.)

610. 远涉重洋 yuǎn shè zhòng yáng
Literal: Far cross heavy ocean
Idiomatic: Travel far across vast oceans; long overseas journey
Example: 他远涉重洋来到这个国家。(He traveled far across vast oceans to reach this country.)

Difficult Terrain

611. 崇山峻岭 chóng shān jùn lǐng
Literal: High mountains steep ridges
Idiomatic: Lofty mountains and steep ridges; rugged terrain; mountainous
Example: 这里崇山峻岭，交通不便。(Here are lofty mountains and steep ridges with inconvenient transportation.)

612. 悬崖峭壁 xuán yá qiào bì
Literal: Hanging cliff steep wall
Idiomatic: Precipice and steep cliff; dangerous terrain; treacherous
Example: 山路边就是悬崖峭壁，非常危险。(There are precipices and steep cliffs beside the mountain road, very dangerous.)

613. 荆棘丛生 jīng jí cóng shēng
Literal: Thorns dense grow
Idiomatic: Thorns growing thickly; difficult path; obstacles everywhere
Example: 这条小路荆棘丛生，很难通过。(This small path has thorns growing thickly, very difficult to pass.)

614. 山高路险 shān gāo lù xiǎn
Literal: Mountain high road dangerous
Idiomatic: High mountains and dangerous roads; treacherous terrain
Example: 这里山高路险，开车要小心。(Here are high mountains and dangerous roads - drive carefully.)

615. 沟壑纵横 gōu hè zòng héng
Literal: Ditches ravines vertical horizontal
Idiomatic: Ditches and ravines crisscross; rough terrain; uneven ground
Example: 这片土地沟壑纵横，不适合耕种。(This land has crisscrossing ditches and ravines, unsuitable for farming.)

616. 穷山恶水 qióng shān è shuǐ
Literal: Poor mountains evil waters
Idiomatic: Barren mountains and treacherous waters; harsh environment
Example: 他们生活在穷山恶水的地方，条件很艰苦。(They live in a place of barren mountains and treacherous waters with harsh conditions.)

617. 人迹罕至 rén jì hǎn zhì
Literal: Human traces rarely reach
Idiomatic: Rarely visited by people; remote and desolate;

uninhabited
Example: 这是一个人迹罕至的地方，很少有人来过。(This is a place rarely visited by people, few have ever been here.)

618. 万丈深渊 wàn zhàng shēn yuān
Literal: Ten thousand zhang deep abyss
Idiomatic: Very deep abyss; bottomless pit; extreme danger
Example: 山路旁边就是万丈深渊，一不小心就会掉下去。(Beside the mountain road is a very deep abyss - one careless step and you'll fall.)

619. 无路可走 wú lù kě zǒu
Literal: No road can walk
Idiomatic: No way to go; dead end; impassable
Example: 前面山崩了，我们无路可走。(There's a landslide ahead and we have no way to go.)

620. 进退两难 jìn tuì liǎng nán
Literal: Advance retreat both difficult
Idiomatic: Difficult to advance or retreat; caught in dilemma; stuck
Example: 在这个危险的地方，我们进退两难。(In this dangerous place, we're caught in a dilemma.)---

📖 LITERATURE & WRITING (491-520)

Excellent Writing

491. 妙笔生花 miào bǐ shēng huā

Literal: Wonderful brush give birth flowers

Idiomatic: Masterly writing; brilliant literary work; inspired writing

Example: 他的文章妙笔生花，文采斐然。(His articles show masterly writing with brilliant literary talent.)

492. 文采飞扬 wén cǎi fēi yáng

Literal: Literary talent fly soar

Idiomatic: Brilliant literary talent; eloquent writing; vivid expression

Example: 这篇散文文采飞扬，读来令人陶醉。(This essay has brilliant literary talent, intoxicating to read.)

493. 字字珠玑 zì zì zhū jī

Literal: Character character pearl jade

Idiomatic: Every word is a gem; precious writing; eloquent

Example: 这位作家的作品字字珠玑，值得反复品读。(This writer's works have every word as a gem, worth reading repeatedly.)

494. 一字千金 yī zì qiān jīn
Literal: One character thousand gold
Idiomatic: One word worth a thousand pieces of gold; extremely valuable writing
Example: 古代大师的作品一字千金，非常珍贵。(Ancient masters' works have words worth gold, extremely precious.)

495. 下笔如神 xià bǐ rú shén
Literal: Lower brush like god
Idiomatic: Write with divine inspiration; brilliant writing ability
Example: 他下笔如神，总能写出精彩的文章。(He writes with divine inspiration, always producing wonderful articles.)

496. 文思如泉 wén sī rú quán
Literal: Literary thoughts like spring
Idiomatic: Literary ideas flow like spring water; creative inspiration
Example: 她文思如泉，创作从不枯竭。(Her literary ideas flow like spring water, never running dry of creativity.)

497. 妙语连珠 miào yǔ lián zhū
Literal: Wonderful words connect pearls
Idiomatic: Witty remarks one after another; eloquent speech
Example: 演讲时他妙语连珠，听众听得津津有味。(During

his speech, he made witty remarks one after another, captivating the audience.)

498. 声情并茂 shēng qíng bìng mào
Literal: Voice emotion together luxuriant
Idiomatic: Both voice and emotion are excellent; moving performance
Example: 她朗诵诗歌声情并茂，深深打动了观众。(Her poetry recitation was moving with excellent voice and emotion, deeply touching the audience.)

499. 绘声绘色 huì shēng huì sè
Literal: Paint sound paint color
Idiomatic: Vivid description; lifelike portrayal; graphic
Example: 他绘声绘色地描述了那次经历。(He gave a vivid description of that experience.)

500. 栩栩如生 xǔ xǔ rú shēng
Literal: Lifelike lifelike like alive
Idiomatic: Lifelike; vivid; true to life
Example: 他笔下的人物栩栩如生，非常生动。(The characters in his writing are lifelike and very vivid.)

Literary Criticism

501. 词不达意 cí bù dá yì

Literal: Words not reach meaning
Idiomatic: Words fail to convey meaning; poorly expressed
Example: 这篇文章词不达意，需要修改。(This article fails to convey its meaning clearly and needs revision.)

502. 言之无物 yán zhī wú wù
Literal: Words of without substance
Idiomatic: Empty words; no substance; meaningless talk
Example: 他的演讲言之无物，听众都觉得无聊。(His speech had no substance, making the audience feel bored.)

503. 陈词滥调 chén cí làn diào
Literal: Stale words overused tune
Idiomatic: Hackneyed expressions; clichés; trite phrases
Example: 这篇文章都是陈词滥调，没有新意。(This article is full of clichés without originality.)

504. 空洞无物 kōng dòng wú wù
Literal: Empty hole without substance
Idiomatic: Empty and without substance; vacuous; hollow
Example: 他的文章空洞无物，缺乏内容。(His article is empty and without substance, lacking content.)

505. 辞不达意 cí bù dá yì
Literal: Words not reach intention

Idiomatic: Words don't express intentions clearly; unclear expression
Example: 由于紧张，他说话辞不达意。(Due to nervousness, his words didn't express his intentions clearly.)

506. 文不对题 wén bù duì tí
Literal: Writing not match topic
Idiomatic: Writing doesn't match the topic; off-topic; irrelevant
Example: 这篇作文文不对题，偏离了主题。(This essay doesn't match the topic and has deviated from the theme.)

507. 词穷理屈 cí qióng lǐ qū
Literal: Words exhausted reason bent
Idiomatic: Run out of arguments; unable to justify; defeated in debate
Example: 在辩论中他词穷理屈，败下阵来。(In the debate, he ran out of arguments and was defeated.)

508. 拖泥带水 tuō ní dài shuǐ
Literal: Drag mud bring water
Idiomatic: Muddy and unclear; verbose; not concise
Example: 他说话拖泥带水，不够简洁明了。(His speech is verbose and not concise enough.)

509. 啰啰嗦嗦 luō luō suō suō
Literal: Wordy wordy verbose verbose
Idiomatic: Long-winded; verbose; repetitive
Example: 他写文章啰啰嗦嗦，需要精简。(His writing is long-winded and needs to be condensed.)

510. 言而无信 yán ér wú xìn
Literal: Speak but no trust
Idiomatic: Break one's word; unreliable; go back on one's word
Example: 言而无信的人很难得到别人的信任。(People who break their word find it hard to gain others' trust.)

Reading and Study

511. 博览群书 bó lǎn qún shū
Literal: Broadly read group books
Idiomatic: Read extensively; well-read; widely read
Example: 他博览群书，知识面很广。(He reads extensively and has broad knowledge.)

512. 学而时习之 xué ér shí xí zhī
Literal: Learn and often practice it
Idiomatic: Learn and practice regularly; continuous learning

Example: 孔子说："学而时习之，不亦说乎？"(Confucius said: "Learn and practice regularly - isn't it a joy?")

513. 不耻下问 bù chǐ xià wèn
Literal: Not shame lower ask
Idiomatic: Not ashamed to ask inferiors; humble in learning
Example: 真正的学者不耻下问，虚心求教。(True scholars are not ashamed to ask inferiors and humbly seek instruction.)

514. 废寝忘食 fèi qǐn wàng shí
Literal: Abandon sleep forget food
Idiomatic: So engrossed as to forget food and sleep; extremely dedicated
Example: 他研究学问废寝忘食，十分专注。(He's so engrossed in academic research that he forgets food and sleep, extremely focused.)

515. 囊萤映雪 náng yíng yìng xuě
Literal: Bag fireflies reflect snow
Idiomatic: Study by firelight and snow reflection; studious despite poverty
Example: 古人囊萤映雪的求学精神值得我们学习。(The ancients' spirit of studying by firelight is worth learning from.)

516. 悬梁刺股 xuán liáng cì gǔ
Literal: Hang beam pierce thigh
Idiomatic: Hang head from beam, stab thigh with awl; extremely studious
Example: 虽然不必悬梁刺股，但学习要有毅力。(Although we don't need to hang from beams and stab thighs, learning requires perseverance.)

517. 开卷有益 kāi juàn yǒu yì
Literal: Open scroll have benefit
Idiomatic: Reading is always beneficial; knowledge is valuable
Example: 古人说开卷有益，多读书总是好的。(The ancients said reading is always beneficial - reading more is always good.)

518. 书香门第 shū xiāng mén dì
Literal: Book fragrance gate household
Idiomatic: Scholarly family; family of learning; intellectual heritage
Example: 他出身书香门第，从小受到良好教育。(He comes from a scholarly family and received good education from childhood.)

519. 满腹经纶 mǎn fù jīng lún
Literal: Full belly classics commentaries

Idiomatic: Full of learning; erudite; scholarly
Example: 这位老教授满腹经纶，学识渊博。(This old professor is full of learning with profound scholarship.)

520. 学富五车 xué fù wǔ chē
Literal: Learning rich five carts
Idiomatic: Very learned; erudite; vast knowledge
Example: 古代学者学富五车，博古通今。(Ancient scholars were very learned, well-versed in both ancient and modern knowledge.)

🍽️ FOOD & DINING (521-540)

Fine Cuisine

521. 山珍海味 shān zhēn hǎi wèi
Literal: Mountain treasures sea flavors
Idiomatic: Delicacies from land and sea; fine cuisine; gourmet food
Example: 这家餐厅提供各种山珍海味，非常高档。(This restaurant offers various delicacies from land and sea, very upscale.)

522. 美味佳肴 měi wèi jiā yáo
Literal: Beautiful taste fine food
Idiomatic: Delicious dishes; fine cuisine; gourmet food
Example: 节日餐桌上摆满了美味佳肴。(The holiday table is full of delicious dishes.)

523. 色香味俱全 sè xiāng wèi jù quán
Literal: Color fragrance taste all complete
Idiomatic: Perfect in color, aroma, and taste; well-prepared dish
Example: 这道菜色香味俱全，真是艺术品。(This dish is perfect in color, aroma, and taste - truly a work of art.)

524. 津津有味 jīn jīn yǒu wèi
Literal: Saliva saliva have taste
Idiomatic: Eat with great relish; enjoy thoroughly; savor
Example: 孩子们津津有味地吃着妈妈做的饭。(The children eat their mother's cooking with great relish.)

525. 口齿留香 kǒu chǐ liú xiāng
Literal: Mouth teeth remain fragrance
Idiomatic: Lingering fragrance in mouth; memorable taste; delicious aftertaste
Example: 这道菜吃完后口齿留香，回味无穷。(After eating

this dish, the fragrance lingers in the mouth with endless aftertaste.)

526. 脍炙人口 kuài zhì rén kǒu
Literal: Sliced meat roasted meat person mouth
Idiomatic: Appealing to refined and popular tastes; universally appreciated
Example: 他的诗歌脍炙人口，广为传诵。(His poetry appeals to all tastes and is widely recited.)

527. 大快朵颐 dà kuài duǒ yí
Literal: Big happy move jaw
Idiomatic: Eat heartily; feast with great satisfaction; gourmandize
Example: 看到满桌美食，大家大快朵颐。(Seeing the table full of delicious food, everyone feasted heartily.)

528. 珍馐美馔 zhēn xiū měi zhuàn
Literal: Precious delicacies beautiful feast
Idiomatic: Rare delicacies; sumptuous feast; gourmet banquet
Example: 皇宫里的珍馐美馔普通人难以想象。(The rare delicacies in the imperial palace are beyond ordinary people's imagination.)

529. 八珍玉食 bā zhēn yù shí
Literal: Eight treasures jade food
Idiomatic: The finest delicacies; luxurious food; imperial cuisine
Example: 古代皇帝享用八珍玉食，生活奢华。(Ancient emperors enjoyed the finest delicacies, living luxuriously.)

530. 琼浆玉液 qióng jiāng yù yè
Literal: Jade liquid nectar
Idiomatic: Nectar and ambrosia; finest wine; heavenly drink
Example: 这瓶红酒如琼浆玉液，味道绝佳。(This bottle of red wine is like nectar, with exquisite taste.)

Simple Food and Hunger

531. 粗茶淡饭 cū chá dàn fàn
Literal: Rough tea plain rice
Idiomatic: Simple food; plain meals; frugal fare
Example: 他习惯了粗茶淡饭的生活，很知足。(He's used to simple food and is very content.)

532. 饥寒交迫 jī hán jiāo pò
Literal: Hunger cold together press
Idiomatic: Suffer from hunger and cold; dire poverty; destitution

Example: 在那个年代，很多人饥寒交迫。(In that era, many people suffered from hunger and cold.)

533. 食不果腹 shí bù guǒ fù
Literal: Food not fill belly
Idiomatic: Not have enough to eat; insufficient food; hungry
Example: 灾民食不果腹，急需救济。(Disaster victims don't have enough to eat and urgently need relief.)

534. 饥肠辘辘 jī cháng lù lù
Literal: Hungry intestines rumbling
Idiomatic: Empty stomach rumbling; very hungry; famished
Example: 走了一天路，他饥肠辘辘。(After walking all day, his stomach was rumbling with hunger.)

535. 箪食瓢饮 dān shí piáo yǐn
Literal: Bamboo bowl food gourd ladle drink
Idiomatic: Simple food and drink; frugal living; austere life
Example: 颜回箪食瓢饮，但仍然快乐学习。(Yan Hui lived on simple food but still studied happily.)

536. 忍饥挨饿 rěn jī ái è
Literal: Endure hunger suffer starvation
Idiomatic: Endure hunger and starvation; go without food

Example: 为了省钱，他经常忍饥挨饿。(To save money, he often goes without food.)

537. 食不甘味 shí bù gān wèi
Literal: Food not sweet taste
Idiomatic: Food tastes bland; no appetite; worried eating
Example: 心里有事，他食不甘味。(With worries on his mind, food tastes bland to him.)

538. 囫囵吞枣 hú lún tūn zǎo
Literal: Whole swallow dates
Idiomatic: Swallow whole without chewing; accept uncritically; hasty consumption
Example: 吃饭不能囫囵吞枣，要细嚼慢咽。(Eating can't be like swallowing dates whole - must chew slowly.)

539. 狼吞虎咽 láng tūn hǔ yàn
Literal: Wolf swallow tiger gulp
Idiomatic: Wolf down food; eat voraciously; gobble up
Example: 孩子们饿极了，狼吞虎咽地吃完了饭。(The children were extremely hungry and wolfed down their meal.)

540. 食而不知其味 shí ér bù zhī qí wèi
Literal: Eat but not know its taste
Idiomatic: Eat without tasting; absent-minded eating;

preoccupied
Example: 他心事重重，食而不知其味。(He's preoccupied with worries and eats without tasting.)

👔 CLOTHING & APPEARANCE (541-560)

Fine Dress and Fashion

541. 衣冠楚楚 yī guān chǔ chǔ
Literal: Clothes cap neat neat
Idiomatic: Neatly dressed; well-groomed; dapper
Example: 他总是衣冠楚楚，给人很好的印象。(He's always neatly dressed, making a good impression.)

542. 锦衣玉食 jǐn yī yù shí
Literal: Brocade clothes jade food
Idiomatic: Fine clothes and sumptuous food; luxurious living
Example: 富家子弟从小锦衣玉食，生活优越。(Children of wealthy families enjoy fine clothes and food from childhood, living superior lives.)

543. 花枝招展 huā zhī zhāo zhǎn
Literal: Flower branch beckon display
Idiomatic: Dressed up gaily; flashily dressed; attractively

adorned
Example: 她花枝招展地参加了舞会。(She attended the dance attractively adorned.)

544. 珠光宝气 zhū guāng bǎo qì
Literal: Pearl light treasure aura
Idiomatic: Adorned with jewels; richly bejeweled; ostentatious wealth
Example: 那位夫人珠光宝气，显得很富有。(That lady is richly bejeweled, appearing very wealthy.)

545. 锦绣前程 jǐn xiù qián chéng
Literal: Brocade embroidery front journey
Idiomatic: Bright future; promising prospects; brilliant future
Example: 年轻人要努力学习，创造锦绣前程。(Young people should study hard to create a bright future.)

546. 鲜衣怒马 xiān yī nù mǎ
Literal: Fresh clothes spirited horse
Idiomatic: Dressed in fine clothes on spirited horse; youthful vigor and wealth
Example: 他年轻时鲜衣怒马，意气风发。(In his youth, he was dressed in fine clothes on a spirited horse, full of vigor.)

547. 华服美饰 huá fú měi shì
Literal: Magnificent clothes beautiful ornaments
Idiomatic: Magnificent clothes and beautiful ornaments; splendid attire
Example: 宫廷舞会上，贵族们华服美饰。(At the court ball, nobles wore magnificent clothes and beautiful ornaments.)

548. 绫罗绸缎 líng luó chóu duàn
Literal: Silk gauze silk satin
Idiomatic: Fine silks and satins; luxurious fabrics; expensive materials
Example: 她的衣柜里挂满了绫罗绸缎。(Her wardrobe is full of fine silks and satins.)

549. 金玉其外 jīn yù qí wài
Literal: Gold jade its outside
Idiomatic: Gold and jade on the outside; impressive exterior; surface glamour
Example: 这个人金玉其外，败絮其中。(This person has gold and jade on the outside but rags within.)

550. 衣锦还乡 yī jǐn huán xiāng
Literal: Wear brocade return hometown
Idiomatic: Return home in glory; come back successful and wealthy

Example: 他发达后衣锦还乡，光宗耀祖。(After becoming successful, he returned home in glory, bringing honor to his ancestors.)

Simple or Poor Clothing

551. 衣衫褴褛 yī shān lán lǚ
Literal: Clothes shirt tattered ragged
Idiomatic: Dressed in rags; tattered clothes; shabby appearance
Example: 那个乞丐衣衫褴褛，很可怜。(That beggar is dressed in rags, very pitiful.)

552. 破衣烂衫 pò yī làn shān
Literal: Broken clothes rotten shirt
Idiomatic: Worn-out clothes; tattered garments; shabby dress
Example: 他穿着破衣烂衫，但精神很好。(He wears tattered clothes but has good spirits.)

553. 粗布麻衣 cū bù má yī
Literal: Rough cloth hemp clothes
Idiomatic: Coarse cloth and hemp clothes; simple clothing; plain dress
Example: 农民穿着粗布麻衣，朴实无华。(Farmers wear coarse cloth, simple and unpretentious.)

554. 布衣蔬食 bù yī shū shí
Literal: Cotton clothes vegetable food
Idiomatic: Simple clothes and vegetarian food; frugal living; plain life
Example: 他过着布衣蔬食的简朴生活。(He lives a simple life with plain clothes and vegetarian food.)

555. 荆钗布裙 jīng chāi bù qún
Literal: Thorn hairpin cloth skirt
Idiomatic: Simple hairpin and cloth skirt; poor woman's dress; humble attire
Example: 她虽然荆钗布裙，但品格高尚。(Although she wears humble attire, her character is noble.)

556. 缝缝补补 féng féng bǔ bǔ
Literal: Sew sew patch patch
Idiomatic: Mend and patch repeatedly; make do with old clothes; frugal repair
Example: 那个年代，人们缝缝补补，舍不得扔衣服。(In that era, people mended and patched, reluctant to throw away clothes.)

557. 衣不蔽体 yī bù bì tǐ
Literal: Clothes not cover body
Idiomatic: Clothes don't cover the body; inadequately

clothed; scanty dress
Example: 灾民衣不蔽体，急需救助。(Disaster victims are inadequately clothed and urgently need help.)

558. 赤身裸体 chì shēn luǒ tǐ
Literal: Red body naked body
Idiomatic: Completely naked; stark naked; without clothes
Example: 婴儿赤身裸体地来到这个世界。(Babies come into this world completely naked.)

559. 衣单食薄 yī dān shí bó
Literal: Clothes thin food meager
Idiomatic: Thin clothes and meager food; poor living conditions; impoverished
Example: 他衣单食薄，生活很艰难。(He has thin clothes and meager food, living very hard.)

560. 粗衣恶食 cū yī è shí
Literal: Rough clothes bad food
Idiomatic: Rough clothes and poor food; hard living conditions; austere life
Example: 修行僧人粗衣恶食，专心修道。(Monks live with rough clothes and poor food, concentrating on spiritual practice.)---

🎭 CHARACTER TRAITS (401-450)

Positive Character Qualities

401. 光明磊落 guāng míng lěi luò
Literal: Light bright open frank
Idiomatic: Honest and straightforward; above board; transparent
Example: 他做事光明磊落，从不搞阴谋诡计。(He acts honestly and straightforwardly, never engaging in conspiracies.)

402. 诚实守信 chéng shí shǒu xìn
Literal: Honest trustworthy keep promise
Idiomatic: Honest and trustworthy; reliable; keep one's word
Example: 诚实守信是做人的基本原则。(Being honest and trustworthy is a basic principle of being human.)

403. 谦虚谨慎 qiān xū jǐn shèn
Literal: Modest cautious
Idiomatic: Modest and prudent; humble and careful
Example: 成功的人往往谦虚谨慎，不骄不躁。(Successful people are often modest and prudent, neither arrogant nor impatient.)

404. 宽宏大量 kuān hóng dà liàng
Literal: Broad magnanimous great measure
Idiomatic: Magnanimous; generous; broad-minded
Example: 作为领导要宽宏大量，能容忍下属的小错误。(As a leader, one should be magnanimous and tolerant of subordinates' minor mistakes.)

405. 坚韧不拔 jiān rèn bù bá
Literal: Firm tenacious not pull out
Idiomatic: Tenacious; persevering; indomitable
Example: 他有坚韧不拔的性格，从不轻易放弃。(He has a tenacious character and never gives up easily.)

406. 乐于助人 lè yú zhù rén
Literal: Happy to help people
Idiomatic: Ready to help others; helpful; altruistic
Example: 她乐于助人，邻居们都很喜欢她。(She's ready to help others, and all the neighbors like her.)

407. 公正无私 gōng zhèng wú sī
Literal: Fair just without selfishness
Idiomatic: Fair and impartial; unbiased; just
Example: 好法官应该公正无私，依法判决。(Good judges should be fair and impartial, making decisions according to law.)

408. 勤勤恳恳 qín qín kěn kěn
Literal: Diligent diligent earnest earnest
Idiomatic: Diligent and conscientious; hardworking; dedicated
Example: 他勤勤恳恳地工作了三十年。(He worked diligently and conscientiously for thirty years.)

409. 兢兢业业 jīng jīng yè yè
Literal: Cautious cautious business business
Idiomatic: Conscientious; dedicated to work; meticulous
Example: 她兢兢业业地完成每一项任务。(She conscientiously completes every task.)

410. 心地善良 xīn dì shàn liáng
Literal: Heart ground kind good
Idiomatic: Kind-hearted; benevolent; good-natured
Example: 虽然生活困难，但她心地善良，经常帮助别人。(Although life is difficult, she's kind-hearted and often helps others.)

411. 忠诚老实 zhōng chéng lǎo shí
Literal: Loyal honest
Idiomatic: Loyal and honest; faithful and truthful
Example: 他忠诚老实，是个值得信赖的朋友。(He's loyal and honest, a trustworthy friend.)

412. 正直不阿 zhèng zhí bù ē
Literal: Upright not bend
Idiomatic: Upright and impartial; incorruptible; straight
Example: 他正直不阿，从不为私利而妥协。(He's upright and impartial, never compromising for personal gain.)

413. 温文尔雅 wēn wén ěr yǎ
Literal: Gentle refined thus elegant
Idiomatic: Gentle and refined; cultured; gracious
Example: 这位教授温文尔雅，深受学生尊敬。(This professor is gentle and refined, deeply respected by students.)

414. 慷慨解囊 kāng kǎi jiě náng
Literal: Generous untie purse
Idiomatic: Give generously; be generous with money; open one's purse
Example: 听到灾区的消息，他慷慨解囊，捐了一大笔钱。(Hearing news of the disaster area, he gave generously, donating a large sum.)

415. 义薄云天 yì bó yún tiān
Literal: Righteousness reach clouds sky
Idiomatic: Righteousness reaches the sky; extremely righteous; noble

Example: 他的义薄云天让所有人敬佩。(His nobility that reaches the sky makes everyone admire him.)

Negative Character Flaws

416. 心狠手辣 xīn hěn shǒu là
Literal: Heart cruel hand ruthless
Idiomatic: Cruel and ruthless; heartless; merciless
Example: 这个人心狠手辣，为了利益什么都做得出来。(This person is cruel and ruthless, capable of anything for profit.)

417. 阴险狡诈 yīn xiǎn jiǎo zhà
Literal: Sinister treacherous
Idiomatic: Sinister and cunning; treacherous; scheming
Example: 他阴险狡诈，背后总是算计别人。(He's sinister and cunning, always scheming against others behind their backs.)

418. 自私自利 zì sī zì lì
Literal: Self selfish self profit
Idiomatic: Selfish; self-interested; egotistical
Example: 自私自利的人很难得到真正的朋友。(Selfish people find it hard to get true friends.)

419. 贪得无厌 tān dé wú yàn
Literal: Greedy get without satisfy
Idiomatic: Greedy and never satisfied; insatiably greedy

Example: 他贪得无厌，永远不满足现状。(He's greedy and never satisfied, never content with the status quo.)

420. 虚伪做作 xū wěi zuò zuò
Literal: False hypocritical affected
Idiomatic: Hypocritical and affected; insincere; fake
Example: 她的虚伪做作让人反感。(Her hypocrisy and affectation are disgusting.)

421. 骄傲自满 jiāo ào zì mǎn
Literal: Proud arrogant self satisfied
Idiomatic: Proud and complacent; arrogant; conceited
Example: 一点小成功就骄傲自满是不对的。(Being proud and complacent over small success is wrong.)

422. 懒惰成性 lǎn duò chéng xìng
Literal: Lazy become nature
Idiomatic: Habitually lazy; chronically idle; lazy by nature
Example: 他懒惰成性，什么事都不愿意做。(He's habitually lazy and unwilling to do anything.)

423. 心胸狭窄 xīn xiōng xiá zhǎi
Literal: Heart chest narrow
Idiomatic: Narrow-minded; petty; small-minded

Example: 心胸狭窄的人容不下别人的成功。(Narrow-minded people can't tolerate others' success.)

424. 冷酷无情 lěng kù wú qíng
Literal: Cold cruel without feeling
Idiomatic: Cold and heartless; callous; ruthless
Example: 他对下属冷酷无情，没有人情味。(He's cold and heartless toward subordinates, lacking human warmth.)

425. 口是心非 kǒu shì xīn fēi
Literal: Mouth right heart wrong
Idiomatic: Say one thing but mean another; duplicitous; two-faced
Example: 他口是心非，表面友善实际上很恶毒。(He's duplicitous - seemingly friendly but actually malicious.)

426. 见利忘义 jiàn lì wàng yì
Literal: See profit forget righteousness
Idiomatic: Forget friendship for profit; mercenary; opportunistic
Example: 真正的朋友不会见利忘义。(True friends won't forget friendship for profit.)

427. 忘恩负义 wàng ēn fù yì
Literal: Forget grace betray righteousness

Idiomatic: Ungrateful; bite the hand that feeds; treacherous
Example: 忘恩负义的人不会有好下场。(Ungrateful people won't have good endings.)

428. 鼠肚鸡肠 shǔ dù jī cháng
Literal: Mouse belly chicken intestines
Idiomatic: Petty-minded; narrow; small-minded
Example: 别和他计较，他就是鼠肚鸡肠的人。(Don't argue with him - he's just a petty-minded person.)

429. 唯利是图 wéi lì shì tú
Literal: Only profit is pursue
Idiomatic: Seek only profit; mercenary; money-minded
Example: 唯利是图的商人不会长久成功。(Merchants who seek only profit won't succeed long-term.)

430. 恃强凌弱 shì qiáng líng ruò
Literal: Rely strong bully weak
Idiomatic: Bully the weak; abuse one's power; pick on the defenseless
Example: 恃强凌弱的行为应该受到谴责。(Bullying the weak should be condemned.)

431. 欺软怕硬 qī ruǎn pà yìng
Literal: Bully soft fear hard

Idiomatic: Bully the weak and fear the strong; cowardly bully
Example: 他就是个欺软怕硬的人，没什么本事。(He's just someone who bullies the weak and fears the strong, without real ability.)

432. 两面三刀 liǎng miàn sān dāo
Literal: Two faces three knives
Idiomatic: Two-faced; duplicitous; backstabbing
Example: 这种两面三刀的人不能信任。(This kind of two-faced person cannot be trusted.)

433. 阳奉阴违 yáng fèng yīn wéi
Literal: Yang obey yin violate
Idiomatic: Outwardly obey but inwardly oppose; comply in public, resist in private
Example: 他表面服从领导，实际上阳奉阴违。(He appears to obey leadership but actually complies in public while resisting in private.)

434. 蛮横无理 mán hèng wú lǐ
Literal: Barbarous unreasonable
Idiomatic: Unreasonable and overbearing; bullying; unreasonably domineering
Example: 他蛮横无理，没人愿意和他合作。(He's

unreasonable and overbearing, no one wants to cooperate with him.)

435. 鸡肠狗肚 jī cháng gǒu dù
Literal: Chicken intestines dog belly
Idiomatic: Narrow-minded and petty; mean-spirited
Example: 别理他，他就是个鸡肠狗肚的小人。(Ignore him - he's just a narrow-minded petty person.)

436. 斤斤计较 jīn jīn jì jiào
Literal: Catty catty calculate compare
Idiomatic: Haggle over every ounce; extremely petty; nitpicking
Example: 朋友之间不要斤斤计较，要大度一些。(Friends shouldn't haggle over every detail - should be more generous.)

437. 恩将仇报 ēn jiāng chóu bào
Literal: Kindness will hatred repay
Idiomatic: Repay kindness with hatred; bite the hand that feeds
Example: 他恩将仇报，背叛了帮助过他的人。(He repaid kindness with hatred, betraying those who had helped him.)

438. 得寸进尺 dé cùn jìn chǐ
Literal: Get inch advance foot
Idiomatic: Give an inch, take a mile; push one's luck; never satisfied
Example: 对这种人不能让步，他会得寸进尺。(Can't give in to this type of person - he'll take a mile if given an inch.)

439. 厚颜无耻 hòu yán wú chǐ
Literal: Thick face no shame
Idiomatic: Shameless; brazen; without shame
Example: 他厚颜无耻地撒谎，一点都不脸红。(He lies shamelessly without any blushing.)

440. 卑鄙无耻 bēi bǐ wú chǐ
Literal: Base despicable no shame
Idiomatic: Base and shameless; despicable; contemptible
Example: 这种卑鄙无耻的行为让人愤怒。(This base and shameless behavior makes people angry.)

441. 狂妄自大 kuáng wàng zì dà
Literal: Mad arrogant self big
Idiomatic: Extremely conceited and arrogant; megalomaniacal
Example: 他一点小成就就狂妄自大，目中无人。(He becomes extremely conceited with small achievements, looking down on everyone.)

442. 目中无人 mù zhōng wú rén
Literal: Eyes in no person
Idiomatic: Look down on everyone; arrogant; supercilious
Example: 他升职后目中无人，连老朋友都不理了。(After his promotion, he looks down on everyone and ignores even old friends.)

443. 唯我独尊 wéi wǒ dú zūn
Literal: Only I alone revered
Idiomatic: Extremely self-centered; regard oneself as supreme
Example: 他唯我独尊的态度让同事们很反感。(His extremely self-centered attitude disgusts his colleagues.)

444. 刚愎自用 gāng bì zì yòng
Literal: Stubborn self-willed self use
Idiomatic: Stubborn and self-opinionated; headstrong; obstinate
Example: 他太刚愎自用，从不听取别人的建议。(He's too stubborn and self-opinionated, never listening to others' advice.)

445. 一意孤行 yī yì gū xíng
Literal: One intention solitary travel
Idiomatic: Act willfully alone; go one's own way; obstinate

Example: 他一意孤行，不顾大家的反对。(He acts willfully alone, ignoring everyone's opposition.)

446. 我行我素 wǒ xíng wǒ sù
Literal: I do I usual
Idiomatic: Go one's own way; do as one pleases; stick to one's ways
Example: 不管别人怎么说，他总是我行我素。(No matter what others say, he always goes his own way.)

447. 固执己见 gù zhí jǐ jiàn
Literal: Firmly hold own view
Idiomatic: Stubbornly stick to one's views; obstinate; pigheaded
Example: 他固执己见，不肯接受新的观点。(He stubbornly sticks to his views and won't accept new perspectives.)

448. 心胸狭隘 xīn xiōng xiá ài
Literal: Heart chest narrow cramped
Idiomatic: Narrow-minded; petty; small-hearted
Example: 心胸狭隘的人很难成大事。(Narrow-minded people find it hard to achieve great things.)

449. 睚眦必报 yá zì bì bào
Literal: Angry glare must repay

Idiomatic: Revenge for the smallest grievance; vindictive
Example: 他睚眦必报，得罪了他就麻烦了。(He's vindictive - it's trouble if you offend him.)

450. 落井下石 luò jǐng xià shí
Literal: Fall well throw stone
Idiomatic: Hit someone when they're down; kick someone when down
Example: 真正的朋友不会落井下石，而会雪中送炭。(True friends won't hit you when you're down, but will help in times of need.)

AGRICULTURE & RURAL LIFE (451-470)

Farming and Harvest

451. 春种秋收 chūn zhǒng qiū shōu
Literal: Spring plant autumn harvest
Idiomatic: Plant in spring, harvest in autumn; natural cycle; effort and reward
Example: 农民都知道春种秋收的道理，付出才有回报。(Farmers all know the principle of spring planting and autumn harvest - only effort brings reward.)

452. 五谷丰登 wǔ gǔ fēng dēng
Literal: Five grains abundant ascend
Idiomatic: Bumper harvest; abundant crops; good agricultural year
Example: 今年风调雨顺，五谷丰登，农民都很高兴。(This year has favorable weather and bumper harvest, farmers are all happy.)

453. 粒粒皆辛苦 lì lì jiē xīn kǔ
Literal: Grain grain all hard work
Idiomatic: Every grain represents hard work; don't waste food
Example: 要教育孩子粒粒皆辛苦，不能浪费粮食。(Must educate children that every grain represents hard work and not to waste food.)

454. 面朝黄土背朝天 miàn cháo huáng tǔ bèi cháo tiān
Literal: Face yellow earth back face sky
Idiomatic: Face the soil with back to sky; hard farm work; toiling in fields
Example: 农民面朝黄土背朝天，生活很辛苦。(Farmers face the soil with backs to the sky, living very hard lives.)

455. 靠山吃山靠水吃水 kào shān chī shān kào shuǐ chī shuǐ
Literal: Depend mountain eat mountain depend water eat water

Idiomatic: Live off local resources; make the best of local conditions
Example: 山区人民靠山吃山靠水吃水，因地制宜发展经济。(Mountain people live off local resources, developing economy according to local conditions.)

456. 日出而作日落而息 rì chū ér zuò rì luò ér xī
Literal: Sun rise then work sun set then rest
Idiomatic: Work at sunrise, rest at sunset; natural farming rhythm
Example: 农村人日出而作日落而息，生活很规律。(Rural people work at sunrise and rest at sunset, living very regular lives.)

457. 锄禾日当午 chú hé rì dāng wǔ
Literal: Hoe grain sun at noon
Idiomatic: Hoeing grain when sun is at noon; hard farm work in hot weather
Example: 锄禾日当午，汗滴禾下土，农民很辛苦。(Hoeing grain at noon with sweat dripping on the soil, farmers work very hard.)

458. 风调雨顺 fēng tiáo yǔ shùn
Literal: Wind harmonious rain smooth
Idiomatic: Favorable weather for crops; good weather

conditions
Example: 今年风调雨顺，庄稼长得特别好。(This year has favorable weather and crops are growing especially well.)

459. 瓜熟蒂落 guā shú dì luò
Literal: Melon ripe stem drop
Idiomatic: When melon is ripe, stem drops; things happen naturally when conditions are right
Example: 孩子的成长要顺其自然，瓜熟蒂落。(Children's growth should be natural, like ripe melons dropping when ready.)

460. 种瓜得瓜种豆得豆 zhǒng guā dé guā zhǒng dòu dé dòu
Literal: Plant melon get melon plant bean get bean
Idiomatic: You reap what you sow; natural consequences; cause and effect
Example: 种瓜得瓜种豆得豆，做好事有好报。(You reap what you sow - good deeds bring good rewards.)

Rural Wisdom

461. 靠天吃饭 kào tiān chī fàn
Literal: Depend sky eat rice
Idiomatic: Depend on weather for livelihood; rely on natural

conditions
Example: 农民靠天吃饭，最怕遇到自然灾害。(Farmers depend on weather for livelihood and most fear natural disasters.)

462. 看天吃饭 kàn tiān chī fàn
Literal: Watch sky eat rice
Idiomatic: Livelihood depends on weather; subject to natural conditions
Example: 这个地区看天吃饭，需要发展其他产业。(This region's livelihood depends on weather, needs to develop other industries.)

463. 因地制宜 yīn dì zhì yí
Literal: According place establish suitable
Idiomatic: Adapt to local conditions; tailor to circumstances
Example: 发展农业要因地制宜，选择适合的作物。(Agricultural development should adapt to local conditions, choosing suitable crops.)

464. 因材施教 yīn cái shī jiào
Literal: According talent apply teaching
Idiomatic: Teach according to student's aptitude; individualized approach

Example: 培养农村人才也要因材施教。(Cultivating rural talent also requires individualized approaches.)

465. 物尽其用 wù jìn qí yòng
Literal: Thing exhaust its use
Idiomatic: Make full use of everything; utilize resources completely
Example: 农村生活要物尽其用，不能浪费。(Rural life should make full use of everything without waste.)

466. 自给自足 zì jǐ zì zú
Literal: Self provide self sufficient
Idiomatic: Self-sufficient; provide for oneself; independent
Example: 这个山村基本能自给自足，很少依赖外界。(This mountain village is basically self-sufficient, rarely depending on outside.)

467. 丰衣足食 fēng yī zú shí
Literal: Abundant clothes sufficient food
Idiomatic: Have ample food and clothing; well provided for
Example: 通过努力，这个村子实现了丰衣足食。(Through effort, this village achieved having ample food and clothing.)

468. 安居乐业 ān jū lè yè
Literal: Peaceful dwelling happy work

Idiomatic: Live and work in peace and contentment; settled life

Example: 新农村建设让农民能够安居乐业。(New rural construction enables farmers to live and work in peace and contentment.)

469. 男耕女织 nán gēng nǚ zhī

Literal: Men plow women weave

Idiomatic: Men farm, women weave; traditional division of labor; pastoral life

Example: 传统农村男耕女织，分工合作。(Traditional rural life had men farming and women weaving in cooperative division of labor.)

470. 鸡犬相闻 jī quǎn xiāng wén

Literal: Chickens dogs mutually hear

Idiomatic: Neighboring villages; close rural community; peaceful countryside

Example: 这些村庄鸡犬相闻，关系很亲密。(These villages are neighboring with close relationships.)

🏗️ CONSTRUCTION & BUILDING (471-490)

Successful Construction

471. 高楼大厦 gāo lóu dà shà
Literal: Tall building big mansion
Idiomatic: Tall buildings and large mansions; impressive architecture
Example: 城市里高楼大厦林立，很壮观。(The city has tall buildings standing everywhere, very spectacular.)

472. 拔地而起 bá dì ér qǐ
Literal: Pull ground then rise
Idiomatic: Rise from the ground; spring up rapidly; rapid construction
Example: 新区的建筑拔地而起，变化很大。(Buildings in the new district are rising from the ground with great changes.)

473. 建章立制 jiàn zhāng lì zhì
Literal: Build regulations establish system
Idiomatic: Establish rules and systems; create institutional framework
Example: 公司要建章立制，规范管理。(The company should establish rules and systems to standardize management.)

474. 精雕细琢 jīng diāo xì zhuó
Literal: Fine carve detailed chisel
Idiomatic: Carve and polish with great care; meticulous craftsmanship

Example: 这座古建筑精雕细琢，工艺精湛。(This ancient building is finely carved with exquisite craftsmanship.)

475. 巧夺天工 qiǎo duó tiān gōng
Literal: Skill seize heaven work
Idiomatic: Excelling nature's handiwork; superb craftsmanship
Example: 这座桥的设计巧夺天工，令人惊叹。(The design of this bridge excels nature's handiwork, amazing people.)

476. 坚如磐石 jiān rú pán shí
Literal: Firm like huge rock
Idiomatic: Rock solid; extremely firm; unshakeable
Example: 这座大坝建得坚如磐石，很安全。(This dam is built rock solid, very safe.)

477. 稳如泰山 wěn rú tài shān
Literal: Stable like Mount Tai
Idiomatic: Stable as Mount Tai; extremely solid; unshakeable
Example: 这座建筑的基础稳如泰山。(The foundation of this building is stable as Mount Tai.)

478. 金碧辉煌 jīn bì huī huáng
Literal: Gold jade brilliant splendid
Idiomatic: Brilliant and magnificent; splendid; luxurious

Example: 皇宫金碧辉煌，非常豪华。(The imperial palace is brilliant and magnificent, very luxurious.)

479. 富丽堂皇 fù lì táng huáng
Literal: Rich beautiful hall imperial
Idiomatic: Magnificently decorated; splendid; sumptuous
Example: 这座酒店装修得富丽堂皇。(This hotel is magnificently decorated.)

480. 雕梁画栋 diāo liáng huà dòng
Literal: Carved beams painted pillars
Idiomatic: Ornately decorated architecture; elaborate craftsmanship
Example: 古代宫殿雕梁画栋，装饰华美。(Ancient palaces had ornately decorated architecture with beautiful decorations.)

Structural Problems

481. 摇摇欲坠 yáo yáo yù zhuì
Literal: Shake shake about fall
Idiomatic: Tottering; about to collapse; precarious
Example: 这座老房子摇摇欲坠，很危险。(This old house is tottering and very dangerous.)

482. 千疮百孔 qiān chuāng bǎi kǒng
Literal: Thousand wounds hundred holes
Idiomatic: Full of holes and wounds; riddled with problems
Example: 这堵墙千疮百孔，需要修补。(This wall is full of holes and needs repair.)

483. 破败不堪 pò bài bù kān
Literal: Broken defeated not bearable
Idiomatic: Dilapidated; in ruins; badly damaged
Example: 老城区有些建筑破败不堪，需要改造。(Some buildings in the old city are dilapidated and need renovation.)

484. 危如累卵 wēi rú lěi luǎn
Literal: Dangerous like stacked eggs
Idiomatic: Precarious as stacked eggs; extremely unstable
Example: 这座桥的状况危如累卵，不能通行。(This bridge's condition is precarious as stacked eggs and cannot be used.)

485. 岌岌可危 jí jí kě wēi
Literal: Precarious precarious can danger
Idiomatic: In imminent danger; extremely precarious
Example: 地震后这座建筑岌岌可危。(After the earthquake, this building is in imminent danger.)

486. 倾斜欲倒 qīng xié yù dǎo
Literal: Lean slant about fall
Idiomatic: Leaning and about to fall; unstable structure
Example: 那棵大树倾斜欲倒，要小心。(That big tree is leaning and about to fall, be careful.)

487. 粗制滥造 cū zhì làn zào
Literal: Rough make flood create
Idiomatic: Shoddily made; poor workmanship; jerry-built
Example: 这些房子粗制滥造，质量很差。(These houses are shoddily made with poor quality.)

488. 偷工减料 tōu gōng jiǎn liào
Literal: Steal work reduce materials
Idiomatic: Cut corners; use inferior materials; scrimp on work
Example: 建筑商偷工减料，造成了安全隐患。(Builders cut corners, creating safety hazards.)

489. 豆腐渣工程 dòu fu zhā gōng chéng
Literal: Tofu dregs project
Idiomatic: Substandard construction; shoddy project; inferior quality
Example: 要严厉打击豆腐渣工程，保障人民安全。(Must severely crack down on substandard construction to ensure people's safety.)

490. 年久失修 nián jiǔ shī xiū
Literal: Years long lose repair
Idiomatic: Long neglected; in disrepair; deteriorated from lack of maintenance
Example: 这座桥年久失修，需要大修。(This bridge has long been neglected and needs major repairs.)---

🏛️ GOVERNMENT & POLITICS (321-350)

Good Governance

321. 民主集中 mín zhǔ jí zhōng
Literal: People master gather concentrate
Idiomatic: Democratic centralism; collective decision-making
Example: 好的领导班子要实行民主集中，集思广益。(A good leadership team should practice democratic centralism and pool collective wisdom.)

322. 勤政爱民 qín zhèng ài mín
Literal: Diligent government love people
Idiomatic: Diligent in governance and love the people; good public service
Example: 一个好官员应该勤政爱民，为百姓办实事。(A good official should be diligent in governance and love the people, doing practical things for citizens.)

323. 清正廉洁 qīng zhèng lián jié
Literal: Clear upright clean pure
Idiomatic: Honest and clean; incorruptible; upright official
Example: 他为官清正廉洁，深受百姓爱戴。(He is honest and clean as an official, deeply loved by the people.)

324. 国泰民安 guó tài mín ān
Literal: Country peaceful people secure
Idiomatic: Country prosperous and people at peace; stable governance
Example: 在良好的治理下，这个地区国泰民安。(Under good governance, this region has the country prosperous and people at peace.)

325. 政通人和 zhèng tōng rén hé
Literal: Government smooth people harmonious
Idiomatic: Efficient government and social harmony; good administration
Example: 新市长上任后，政通人和，城市发展很快。(After the new mayor took office, there's efficient government and social harmony with rapid city development.)

Political Corruption

326. 贪污腐败 tān wū fǔ bài

Literal: Greedy corrupt rotten defeated
Idiomatic: Corruption and graft; official misconduct
Example: 政府要严厉打击贪污腐败现象。(The government must severely crack down on corruption and graft.)

327. 鱼肉百姓 yú ròu bǎi xìng
Literal: Fish meat hundred surnames
Idiomatic: Oppress the people; treat citizens as prey
Example: 那些贪官鱼肉百姓，最终得到了应有的惩罚。(Those corrupt officials who oppressed the people finally got their deserved punishment.)

328. 官官相护 guān guān xiāng hù
Literal: Official official mutually protect
Idiomatic: Officials protect each other; mutual cover-up
Example: 官官相护的现象必须得到根治。(The phenomenon of officials protecting each other must be thoroughly cured.)

329. 结党营私 jié dǎng yíng sī
Literal: Form party pursue private
Idiomatic: Form cliques for personal gain; factional politics
Example: 公司里不允许结党营私，要公平竞争。(The company doesn't allow forming cliques for personal gain - there must be fair competition.)

330. 徇私舞弊 xùn sī wǔ bì
Literal: Follow private dance fraud
Idiomatic: Bend law for personal gain; abuse of power
Example: 法官徇私舞弊，被判处有期徒刑。(The judge who bent the law for personal gain was sentenced to prison.)

Leadership and Authority

331. 德高望重 dé gāo wàng zhòng
Literal: Virtue high prestige heavy
Idiomatic: High virtue and great prestige; respected leader
Example: 这位老教授德高望重，深受学生敬爱。(This old professor has high virtue and great prestige, deeply respected by students.)

332. 威信扫地 wēi xìn sǎo dì
Literal: Prestige sweep ground
Idiomatic: Prestige completely lost; authority undermined
Example: 经过这次失误，他的威信扫地。(After this mistake, his prestige is completely lost.)

333. 众望所归 zhòng wàng suǒ guī
Literal: Masses hope place return
Idiomatic: Enjoy popular support; chosen by the people

Example: 他众望所归，被选为新的领导人。(He enjoys popular support and was chosen as the new leader.)

334. 孤家寡人 gū jiā guǎ rén
Literal: Solitary family widowed person
Idiomatic: Isolated ruler; friendless person; alone
Example: 独裁者最终成为孤家寡人，被人民推翻。(The dictator eventually became isolated and was overthrown by the people.)

335. 一呼百应 yī hū bǎi yìng
Literal: One call hundred respond
Idiomatic: One call brings hundreds of responses; great influence
Example: 这位领袖一呼百应，号召力很强。(This leader has great influence with one call bringing hundreds of responses.)

336. 高高在上 gāo gāo zài shàng
Literal: High high at above
Idiomatic: High and mighty; aloof; superior attitude
Example: 好领导不应该高高在上，要深入群众。(Good leaders shouldn't be high and mighty but should go deep among the masses.)

337. 平易近人 píng yì jìn rén
Literal: Level easy near person
Idiomatic: Approachable; easy to get along with; down-to-earth
Example: 虽然地位很高，但他平易近人，没有架子。(Although his position is high, he's approachable without putting on airs.)

338. 深入民心 shēn rù mín xīn
Literal: Deep enter people heart
Idiomatic: Deep in people's hearts; widely supported
Example: 这项政策深入民心，得到了广泛支持。(This policy is deep in people's hearts and has received widespread support.)

339. 上行下效 shàng xíng xià xiào
Literal: Above act below imitate
Idiomatic: Those below follow those above; leadership by example
Example: 领导要以身作则，因为上行下效。(Leaders must set examples because those below follow those above.)

340. 政令不通 zhèng lìng bù tōng
Literal: Government orders not pass through
Idiomatic: Government orders not carried out; ineffective

administration
Example: 地方政令不通，中央政策难以执行。(Local government orders are not carried out, making central policies difficult to implement.)

341. 集思广益 jí sī guǎng yì
Literal: Gather thoughts broad benefits
Idiomatic: Pool collective wisdom; brainstorm; collaborative thinking
Example: 解决这个问题需要集思广益，大家一起想办法。(Solving this problem requires pooling collective wisdom with everyone thinking of solutions together.)

342. 群策群力 qún cè qún lì
Literal: Group strategy group strength
Idiomatic: Pool efforts and resources; collective action
Example: 只有群策群力，才能完成这项艰难的任务。(Only by pooling efforts and resources can we complete this difficult task.)

343. 万民拥戴 wàn mín yōng dài
Literal: Ten thousand people support wear
Idiomatic: Supported by all people; universally acclaimed
Example: 这位领袖万民拥戴，享有很高威望。(This leader is supported by all people and enjoys high prestige.)

344. 千夫所指 qiān fū suǒ zhǐ
Literal: Thousand men place point
Idiomatic: Condemned by everyone; universally criticized
Example: 这种行为千夫所指，不得人心。(This behavior is condemned by everyone and unpopular.)

345. 众叛亲离 zhòng pàn qīn lí
Literal: Masses rebel relatives leave
Idiomatic: Deserted by followers and friends; completely isolated
Example: 暴君最终众叛亲离，失去了所有支持。(The tyrant was eventually deserted by followers and friends, losing all support.)

346. 得道多助 dé dào duō zhù
Literal: Get way much help
Idiomatic: Righteous cause enjoys abundant support; virtue brings aid
Example: 正义的事业得道多助，会得到人们的支持。(Righteous causes enjoy abundant support and will receive people's backing.)

347. 失道寡助 shī dào guǎ zhù
Literal: Lose way few help
Idiomatic: Unjust cause finds little support; isolated by

wrongdoing
Example: 他的做法不得人心，失道寡助。(His approach is unpopular and finds little support.)

348. 顺应民意 shùn yìng mín yì
Literal: Follow respond people intention
Idiomatic: Follow public opinion; respond to people's will
Example: 政府应该顺应民意，制定符合民众利益的政策。(The government should follow public opinion and make policies that serve people's interests.)

349. 违背民意 wéi bèi mín yì
Literal: Violate back people intention
Idiomatic: Go against public opinion; defy people's will
Example: 违背民意的决定最终会失败。(Decisions that go against public opinion will ultimately fail.)

350. 励精图治 lì jīng tú zhì
Literal: Encourage essence plan govern
Idiomatic: Work energetically for national prosperity; dedicated governance
Example: 新政府励精图治，决心改变国家面貌。(The new government works energetically for national prosperity, determined to change the country's appearance.)

🎓 EDUCATION & TEACHING (351-380)

Effective Teaching Methods

351. 因材施教 yīn cái shī jiào
Literal: According talent apply teaching
Idiomatic: Teach according to student's aptitude; individualized instruction
Example: 好老师会因材施教，针对不同学生采用不同方法。(Good teachers teach according to students' aptitude, using different methods for different students.)

352. 循循善诱 xún xún shàn yòu
Literal: Step by step good induce
Idiomatic: Guide patiently and systematically; methodical teaching
Example: 他循循善诱，帮助学生逐步理解复杂的概念。(He guides patiently and systematically, helping students gradually understand complex concepts.)

353. 循序渐进 xún xù jiàn jìn
Literal: Follow order gradual advance
Idiomatic: Follow proper sequence; step by step; gradual progress
Example: 学习外语要循序渐进，不能急于求成。(Learning

foreign languages should be step by step, not rushing for quick success.)

354. 寓教于乐 yù jiào yú lè
Literal: Place teaching in joy
Idiomatic: Combine teaching with pleasure; make learning fun
Example: 幼儿园老师善于寓教于乐，让孩子们在游戏中学习。(Kindergarten teachers are good at making learning fun, letting children learn through play.)

355. 言传身教 yán chuán shēn jiào
Literal: Words transmit body teach
Idiomatic: Teach by words and example; lead by example
Example: 父母要言传身教，给孩子树立好榜样。(Parents should teach by words and example, setting good examples for children.)

356. 举一反三 jǔ yī fǎn sān
Literal: Raise one return three
Idiomatic: Draw inferences about other cases; learn by analogy
Example: 聪明的学生能举一反三，触类旁通。(Smart students can draw inferences about other cases and understand by analogy.)

357. 启发思维 qǐ fā sī wéi
Literal: Start inspire thinking
Idiomatic: Inspire thinking; stimulate mental activity
Example: 老师应该启发思维，而不是灌输知识。(Teachers should inspire thinking rather than force-feed knowledge.)

358. 深入浅出 shēn rù qiǎn chū
Literal: Deep enter shallow exit
Idiomatic: Explain the profound in simple terms; make complex ideas accessible
Example: 这位教授善于深入浅出，把复杂理论讲得很清楚。(This professor is good at explaining profound concepts in simple terms, making complex theories very clear.)

359. 温故知新 wēn gù zhī xīn
Literal: Review old know new
Idiomatic: Learn new things by reviewing the old; gain fresh insights
Example: 学习要温故知新，复习旧知识能获得新理解。(Learning should involve reviewing the old to know the new - reviewing old knowledge can gain fresh understanding.)

360. 博采众长 bó cǎi zhòng cháng
Literal: Broadly gather masses' strengths
Idiomatic: Draw on collective wisdom; learn from many

sources
Example: 好的教育方法应该博采众长，吸收各家所长。(Good educational methods should draw on collective wisdom, absorbing the strengths of various approaches.)

Learning Difficulties

361. 朽木不雕 xiǔ mù bù diāo
Literal: Rotten wood not carve
Idiomatic: Rotten wood cannot be carved; hopeless person
Example: 他觉得这个学生朽木不雕，但老师不应该放弃任何学生。(He thinks this student is hopeless, but teachers shouldn't give up on any student.)

362. 愚不可及 yú bù kě jí
Literal: Stupid not can reach
Idiomatic: Extremely stupid; hopeless stupidity
Example: 不要说别人愚不可及，每个人都有自己的长处。(Don't say others are extremely stupid - everyone has their own strengths.)

363. 茫然不解 máng rán bù jiě
Literal: Confused thus not understand
Idiomatic: Completely puzzled; totally confused
Example: 对于这个复杂的数学题，学生们茫然不解。

(Students are completely puzzled by this complex math problem.)

364. 一知半解 yī zhī bàn jiě
Literal: One know half understand
Idiomatic: Superficial knowledge; half-understood
Example: 他对这个理论只是一知半解，需要进一步学习。(He only has superficial knowledge of this theory and needs further study.)

365. 似懂非懂 sì dǒng fēi dǒng
Literal: Seem understand not understand
Idiomatic: Half understand; vaguely comprehend
Example: 学生听课时似懂非懂，需要课后复习。(Students half understand during class and need to review afterwards.)

366. 不求甚解 bù qiú shèn jiě
Literal: Not seek deep understanding
Idiomatic: Not seek thorough understanding; content with superficial knowledge
Example: 读书不能不求甚解，要深入思考。(Reading cannot be superficial - must think deeply.)

367. 囫囵吞枣 hú lún tūn zǎo
Literal: Whole swallow dates

Idiomatic: Swallow whole without chewing; accept uncritically
Example: 学习不能囫囵吞枣，要仔细消化理解。(Learning cannot be like swallowing whole - must carefully digest and understand.)

368. 浅尝辄止 qiǎn cháng zhé zhǐ
Literal: Shallow taste then stop
Idiomatic: Stop at first taste; not go deep; superficial approach
Example: 研究问题不能浅尝辄止，要深入探讨。(Researching problems cannot stop at surface level - must explore deeply.)

369. 三天打鱼两天晒网 sān tiān dǎ yú liǎng tiān shài wǎng
Literal: Three days catch fish two days dry nets
Idiomatic: Work in fits and starts; lack consistency
Example: 学习不能三天打鱼两天晒网，要持之以恒。(Learning cannot be inconsistent - must persevere consistently.)

370. 心不在焉 xīn bù zài yān
Literal: Heart not at here
Idiomatic: Absent-minded; inattentive; distracted
Example: 上课心不在焉是学不好的。(Being absent-minded in class won't lead to good learning.)

Academic Achievement

371. 金榜题名 jīn bǎng tí míng
Literal: Gold list inscribe name
Idiomatic: Pass imperial examination; achieve academic success
Example: 经过多年努力，他终于金榜题名，考上了理想的大学。(After years of effort, he finally achieved academic success and got into his ideal university.)

372. 才高八斗 cái gāo bā dǒu
Literal: Talent high eight measures
Idiomatic: Exceptionally talented; brilliant; highly gifted
Example: 这位年轻学者才高八斗，前途无量。(This young scholar is exceptionally talented with unlimited prospects.)

373. 学富五车 xué fù wǔ chē
Literal: Learning rich five carts
Idiomatic: Very learned; erudite; vast knowledge
Example: 这位教授学富五车，什么问题都能解答。(This professor is very learned and can answer any question.)

374. 博古通今 bó gǔ tōng jīn
Literal: Broad ancient penetrate present
Idiomatic: Well-versed in both ancient and modern learning;

erudite
Example: 他博古通今，对历史和现代问题都很了解。(He is well-versed in both ancient and modern learning, understanding both historical and contemporary issues.)

375. 融会贯通 róng huì guàn tōng
Literal: Melt meet penetrate through
Idiomatic: Master thoroughly; integrate knowledge; comprehensive understanding
Example: 真正的学者能融会贯通，把各种知识联系起来。(True scholars can master thoroughly, connecting various types of knowledge.)

376. 触类旁通 chù lèi páng tōng
Literal: Touch class side through
Idiomatic: Draw inferences from one instance; understand by analogy
Example: 好学生能触类旁通，学一个概念就能理解相关内容。(Good students can understand by analogy, learning one concept and understanding related content.)

377. 过目不忘 guò mù bù wàng
Literal: Pass eye not forget
Idiomatic: Photographic memory; never forget what one has seen

Example: 他有过目不忘的本领，读过的书都能记住。(He has a photographic memory and can remember all the books he's read.)

378. 出类拔萃 chū lèi bá cuì
Literal: Exit class pull outstanding
Idiomatic: Outstanding among peers; exceptionally talented
Example: 她在班里出类拔萃，各科成绩都很优秀。(She is outstanding among her classmates with excellent grades in all subjects.)

379. 鹤立鸡群 hè lì jī qún
Literal: Crane stand chicken flock
Idiomatic: Stand out conspicuously; tower above others
Example: 他的学术水平在同龄人中鹤立鸡群。(His academic level towers above others of his age.)

380. 后起之秀 hòu qǐ zhī xiù
Literal: Later rise's excellence
Idiomatic: Rising star; up-and-coming talent; promising newcomer
Example: 这个年轻研究员是学术界的后起之秀。(This young researcher is a rising star in academia.)

MEDICINE & HEALING (381-400)

Medical Skill and Healing

381. 妙手回春 miào shǒu huí chūn
Literal: Wonderful hand return spring
Idiomatic: Bring dying back to life; miraculous healing; skilled doctor
Example: 这位医生妙手回春，救了很多危重病人。(This doctor brings the dying back to life, saving many critically ill patients.)

382. 药到病除 yào dào bìng chú
Literal: Medicine arrive illness remove
Idiomatic: Illness cured as soon as medicine is taken; immediate cure
Example: 他开的药方药到病除，很快就好了。(His prescription provided immediate cure - got better quickly.)

383. 起死回生 qǐ sǐ huí shēng
Literal: Raise dead return life
Idiomatic: Bring back to life; miraculous recovery; save from death
Example: 经过抢救，病人起死回生，脱离了危险。(After

emergency treatment, the patient was brought back to life and out of danger.)

384. 华佗再世 huá tuó zài shì
Literal: Hua Tuo reborn in world
Idiomatic: Hua Tuo reborn; exceptionally skilled doctor; medical genius
Example: 人们称他为华佗再世，医术高超。(People call him Hua Tuo reborn with superb medical skills.)

385. 悬壶济世 xuán hú jì shì
Literal: Hang pot benefit world
Idiomatic: Practice medicine to help people; medical benevolence
Example: 他一生悬壶济世，为穷人免费治病。(He practiced medicine to help people his whole life, treating poor people for free.)

386. 对症下药 duì zhèng xià yào
Literal: Face symptoms prescribe medicine
Idiomatic: Prescribe right medicine for illness; targeted solution
Example: 解决问题要对症下药，找到根本原因。(Solving problems requires targeted solutions by finding root causes.)

387. 治病救人 zhì bìng jiù rén
Literal: Cure illness save person
Idiomatic: Cure illness and save lives; medical mission
Example: 医生的职责是治病救人，救死扶伤。(A doctor's duty is to cure illness and save lives, helping the injured.)

388. 救死扶伤 jiù sǐ fú shāng
Literal: Save dying help wounded
Idiomatic: Save the dying and heal the wounded; medical humanitarian work
Example: 医护人员在灾区救死扶伤，表现出崇高精神。(Medical personnel save the dying and heal the wounded in disaster areas, showing noble spirit.)

389. 医者仁心 yī zhě rén xīn
Literal: Doctor person benevolent heart
Idiomatic: Doctors have benevolent hearts; medical compassion
Example: 真正的好医生都有医者仁心，关爱病人。(Truly good doctors have benevolent hearts and care for patients.)

390. 手到病除 shǒu dào bìng chú
Literal: Hand arrive illness remove
Idiomatic: Cure with a touch; immediate healing; miraculous cure

Example: 这位针灸师手到病除，很多病人都找他治疗。(This acupuncturist provides immediate healing, and many patients seek his treatment.)

Illness and Disease

391. 病入膏肓 bìng rù gāo huāng
Literal: Illness enter vital organs
Idiomatic: Incurable illness; beyond remedy; hopeless condition
Example: 他的坏习惯已经病入膏肓，很难改变。(His bad habits are beyond remedy and very hard to change.)

392. 奄奄一息 yǎn yǎn yī xī
Literal: Faint faint one breath
Idiomatic: At death's door; barely breathing; on last legs
Example: 病人奄奄一息，情况非常危急。(The patient is barely breathing with a very critical condition.)

393. 疾病缠身 jí bìng chán shēn
Literal: Illness disease wrap body
Idiomatic: Plagued by illness; suffering from multiple ailments
Example: 他年老疾病缠身，生活很不容易。(He is old and plagued by illness, life is very difficult.)

394. 心力交瘁 xīn lì jiāo cuì
Literal: Heart strength mutually exhausted
Idiomatic: Physically and mentally exhausted; burned out
Example: 长期的工作压力让他心力交瘁。(Long-term work pressure has left him physically and mentally exhausted.)

395. 身心俱疲 shēn xīn jù pí
Literal: Body mind both tired
Idiomatic: Physically and mentally tired; completely exhausted
Example: 连续加班让他身心俱疲，需要好好休息。(Continuous overtime has left him physically and mentally tired, needing good rest.)

396. 面色苍白 miàn sè cāng bái
Literal: Face color pale white
Idiomatic: Pale-faced; sickly appearance; wan complexion
Example: 她最近面色苍白，可能是贫血了。(She's been pale-faced recently, possibly anemic.)

397. 骨瘦如柴 gǔ shòu rú chái
Literal: Bones thin like firewood
Idiomatic: Skin and bones; extremely thin; emaciated
Example: 长期生病让他骨瘦如柴，看起来很虚弱。(Long-term illness has left him skin and bones, looking very weak.)

398. 精神萎靡 jīng shén wěi mǐ
Literal: Spirit energy listless
Idiomatic: Dispirited; listless; low energy
Example: 他最近精神萎靡，可能工作压力太大。(He's been dispirited recently, possibly due to too much work pressure.)

399. 卧床不起 wò chuáng bù qǐ
Literal: Lie bed not rise
Idiomatic: Bedridden; confined to bed; unable to get up
Example: 重病让他卧床不起，需要人照顾。(Serious illness has left him bedridden, needing care.)

400. 痛不欲生 tòng bù yù shēng
Literal: Pain not want live
Idiomatic: In agony; unbearable pain; wish to die from pain
Example: 牙痛让他痛不欲生，赶紧去看医生。(Toothache left him in agony, so he quickly went to see a doctor.)**189. 塞翁失马** sài wēng shī mǎ
Literal: Border old man lose horse
Idiomatic: Old man loses horse; loss may turn out to be gain; blessing in disguise
Example: 虽然这次没有升职，但塞翁失马，也许有更好的机会等着。(Although he didn't get promoted this time, like the old man losing his horse, perhaps better opportunities await.)

190. 司马昭之心 sī mǎ zhāo zhī xīn
Literal: Sima Zhao's heart
Idiomatic: Sima Zhao's ambition obvious to everyone; transparent hidden motives
Example: 他想当部门经理的司马昭之心，路人皆知。(His ambition to become department manager is obvious to everyone.)

191. 叶公好龙 yè gōng hào lóng
Literal: Lord Ye loves dragons
Idiomatic: Profess to like something while actually fearing it; hypocritical preference
Example: 他说喜欢冒险，但真正遇到危险时就害怕了，这就是叶公好龙。(He says he likes adventure, but when real danger comes he gets scared - this is like Lord Ye loving dragons.)

192. 程门立雪 chéng mén lì xuě
Literal: Cheng's door stand snow
Idiomatic: Stand in snow at teacher's door; show respect to teacher; dedication to learning
Example: 古人程门立雪的尊师精神值得学习。(The ancients' spirit of standing in snow to show respect to teachers is worth learning.)

🌸 BEAUTY & APPEARANCE

Extraordinary Beauty

193. 沉鱼落雁 chén yú luò yàn
Literal: Sink fish drop wild goose
Idiomatic: So beautiful that fish sink and birds fall; extremely beautiful
Example: 她的美貌沉鱼落雁，让人惊叹。(Her beauty is so stunning that fish sink and birds fall, amazing everyone.)

194. 闭月羞花 bì yuè xiū huā
Literal: Close moon shame flower
Idiomatic: Make moon hide and flowers feel ashamed; extremely beautiful
Example: 古代美女貂蝉有闭月羞花之貌。(The ancient beauty Diaochan had looks that made the moon hide and flowers feel ashamed.)

195. 花容月貌 huā róng yuè mào
Literal: Flower face moon appearance
Idiomatic: Face like flower, appearance like moon; very beautiful
Example: 这位演员花容月貌，深受观众喜爱。(This actress

has a face like a flower and appearance like the moon, deeply loved by audiences.)

196. 国色天香 guó sè tiān xiāng
Literal: National beauty heavenly fragrance
Idiomatic: National beauty and heavenly fragrance; extremely beautiful
Example: 牡丹花国色天香，被誉为花中之王。(Peony flowers have national beauty and heavenly fragrance, known as the king of flowers.)

197. 出水芙蓉 chū shuǐ fú róng
Literal: Exit water hibiscus
Idiomatic: Lotus emerging from water; fresh natural beauty
Example: 这个女孩清纯如出水芙蓉。(This girl is pure and fresh like a lotus emerging from water.)

Outstanding Character

198. 鹤立鸡群 hè lì jī qún
Literal: Crane stand among chickens
Idiomatic: Stand out from crowd; conspicuous among mediocrity
Example: 他在同龄人中鹤立鸡群，才华出众。(He stands out from the crowd among his peers with outstanding talent.)

199. 品学兼优 pǐn xué jiān yōu

Literal: Character study both excellent

Idiomatic: Excellent in both character and learning; model student

Example: 她品学兼优，是老师最喜欢的学生。(She is excellent in both character and learning, the teacher's favorite student.)

Mediocrity and Poor Appearance

200. 碌碌无为 lù lù wú wéi

Literal: Busy busy without achievement

Idiomatic: Lead humdrum life; accomplish nothing; mediocre

Example: 他不想碌碌无为地度过一生。(He doesn't want to lead a humdrum life for his entire life.)

🎪 CONTRASTING PAIRS & OPPOSITES

Scale: Small vs. Large

201. 微不足道 wēi bù zú dào

Literal: Tiny not sufficient speak

Idiomatic: Insignificant; negligible; trivial

Example: 这点小事微不足道，不必在意。(This small matter is insignificant, no need to worry about it.)

202. 举足轻重 jǔ zú qīng zhòng
Literal: Lift foot light heavy
Idiomatic: Decisive; of vital importance; influential
Example: 他在公司里举足轻重，决策都要征求他的意见。(He is influential in the company, and decisions require his input.)

203. 九牛一毛 jiǔ niú yī máo
Literal: Nine oxen one hair
Idiomatic: Drop in ocean; insignificant amount; tiny fraction
Example: 这点损失对大公司来说不过是九牛一毛。(This loss is just a drop in the ocean for a large company.)

204. 沧海一粟 cāng hǎi yī sù
Literal: Vast sea one grain
Idiomatic: Grain in vast sea; infinitesimal; tiny in comparison
Example: 人类在宇宙中如沧海一粟。(Humanity is like a grain in the vast sea compared to the universe.)

Speed: Fast vs. Slow

205. 争先恐后 zhēng xiān kǒng hòu
Literal: Compete first fear last
Idiomatic: Scramble to be first; vie with each other; rush

forward
Example: 听到好消息，大家争先恐后地传播。(Hearing good news, everyone scrambled to spread it.)

206. 姗姗来迟 shān shān lái chí
Literal: Graceful graceful come late
Idiomatic: Come late; arrive belatedly; fashionably late
Example: 他总是姗姗来迟，让大家等待。(He always comes late, making everyone wait.)

207. 快马加鞭 kuài mǎ jiā biān
Literal: Fast horse add whip
Idiomatic: Spur fast horse; at full speed; accelerate
Example: 时间紧迫，我们要快马加鞭完成任务。(Time is tight, we must work at full speed to complete the task.)

208. 蜗行牛步 wō xíng niú bù
Literal: Snail walk ox step
Idiomatic: Move like snail; very slowly; sluggish
Example: 这个项目进展蜗行牛步，让人着急。(This project progresses like a snail, making people anxious.)

Attitude: Humble vs. Arrogant

209. 妄自菲薄 wàng zì fěi bó
Literal: Falsely self-depreciate

Idiomatic: Belittle oneself unreasonably; excessive self-deprecation
Example: 你有才华，不要妄自菲薄。(You have talent, don't belittle yourself unreasonably.)

210. 妄自尊大 wàng zì zūn dà
Literal: Falsely self-esteem big
Idiomatic: Be extremely conceited; arrogant; overweening pride
Example: 他一点小成就就妄自尊大，很讨人厌。(He becomes extremely conceited with little achievement, very annoying.)

211. 谦虚谨慎 qiān xū jǐn shèn
Literal: Modest prudent
Idiomatic: Modest and prudent; humble and careful
Example: 越是有才华的人越应该谦虚谨慎。(The more talented people are, the more they should be modest and prudent.)

🔄 PERSISTENCE & GIVING UP

Unwavering Determination

212. 锲而不舍 qiè ér bù shě
Literal: Carve and not give up
Idiomatic: Persevere; persistent; never give up
Example: 他锲而不舍地追求自己的梦想。(He perseveres in pursuing his dreams.)

213. 百折不挠 bǎi zhé bù náo
Literal: Hundred breaks not bend
Idiomatic: Indomitable; unyielding; never say die
Example: 面对困难，我们要有百折不挠的精神。(Facing difficulties, we should have an indomitable spirit.)

214. 坚贞不屈 jiān zhēn bù qū
Literal: Firm chaste not yield
Idiomatic: Steadfast and unyielding; uncompromising; resolute
Example: 革命烈士坚贞不屈，宁死不投降。(Revolutionary martyrs were steadfast and unyielding, preferring death to surrender.)

215. 愚公移山 yú gōng yí shān
Literal: Foolish old man move mountain

Idiomatic: Persistent effort overcomes any difficulty; determination conquers all
Example: 治理环境污染需要愚公移山的毅力。(Controlling environmental pollution requires the determination of the foolish old man who moved mountains.)

Giving Up and Weakness

216. 知难而退 zhī nán ér tuì
Literal: Know difficulty then retreat
Idiomatic: Retreat when encountering difficulties; give up easily; quit
Example: 遇到困难不能知难而退，要迎难而上。(When encountering difficulties, don't retreat - face them head on.)

217. 浅尝辄止 qiǎn cháng zhé zhǐ
Literal: Shallow taste then stop
Idiomatic: Stop at first taste; not go deep; superficial approach
Example: 学习不能浅尝辄止，要深入钻研。(Learning cannot stop at first taste - we must study deeply.)

🎭 SOCIAL BEHAVIOR & ETIQUETTE

Proper Social Conduct

218. 彬彬有礼 bīn bīn yǒu lǐ

Literal: Refined refined have manners

Idiomatic: Refined and courteous; well-mannered; polite

Example: 这个孩子彬彬有礼，很受大人喜欢。(This child is refined and courteous, well-liked by adults.)

219. 温文尔雅 wēn wén ěr yǎ

Literal: Gentle refined thus elegant

Idiomatic: Gentle and refined; cultured; gracious

Example: 他说话温文尔雅，给人很好的印象。(He speaks in a gentle and refined manner, making a good impression.)

220. 安然无恙 ān rán wú yàng

Literal: Peaceful thus without harm

Idiomatic: Safe and sound; unharmed; all right

Example: 地震后大家都安然无恙，很幸运。(Everyone was safe and sound after the earthquake, very fortunate.)

Inappropriate Behavior

221. 张牙舞爪 zhāng yá wǔ zhǎo

Literal: Show teeth dance claws

Idiomatic: Bare fangs and brandish claws; threatening; fierce
Example: 他一生气就张牙舞爪，吓着了小孩。(When he gets angry, he bares his fangs and brandishes claws, scaring the children.)

222. 咄咄逼人 duō duō bī rén
Literal: Pressing pressing force people
Idiomatic: Overbearing; aggressive; pushy
Example: 他说话咄咄逼人，让人很不舒服。(He speaks in an overbearing manner, making people uncomfortable.)

223. 飞扬跋扈 fēi yáng bá hù
Literal: Flying arrogant domineering
Idiomatic: Arrogant and domineering; haughty; overbearing
Example: 他因为有点权力就飞扬跋扈，很讨人厌。(He becomes arrogant and domineering because of having some power, very annoying.)

🌅 NATURAL PHENOMENA & SEASONS

Weather and Natural Beauty

224. 春暖花开 chūn nuǎn huā kāi
Literal: Spring warm flowers bloom

Idiomatic: Spring comes with warm weather and blooming flowers; new beginning
Example: 春暖花开的季节，正是出游的好时候。(The season of spring warmth and blooming flowers is a good time for travel.)

225. 秋高气爽 qiū gāo qì shuǎng
Literal: Autumn high air refreshing
Idiomatic: Clear autumn weather; pleasant autumn day
Example: 秋高气爽的天气最适合登山。(Clear autumn weather is most suitable for mountain climbing.)

226. 风和日丽 fēng hé rì lì
Literal: Wind gentle sun beautiful
Idiomatic: Gentle breeze and beautiful sun; fine weather; pleasant day
Example: 今天风和日丽，我们去公园散步吧。(Today's weather is fine with gentle breeze and beautiful sun, let's go for a walk in the park.)

227. 电闪雷鸣 diàn shǎn léi míng
Literal: Lightning flash thunder roar
Idiomatic: Lightning flashes and thunder roars; violent storm
Example: 昨晚电闪雷鸣，下了一场大雨。(Last night lightning flashed and thunder roared with heavy rain.)

Harsh Natural Conditions

228. 天寒地冻 tiān hán dì dòng
Literal: Sky cold earth frozen
Idiomatic: Freezing cold; bitter cold; arctic conditions
Example: 北方冬天天寒地冻，要注意保暖。(Northern winters are freezing cold, so pay attention to staying warm.)

229. 狂风暴雨 kuáng fēng bào yǔ
Literal: Mad wind violent rain
Idiomatic: Violent storm; fierce winds and heavy rain; tempest
Example: 台风来临时，狂风暴雨持续了一整夜。(When the typhoon came, violent storms lasted all night.)

💰 COMMERCE & BUSINESS

Business Success

230. 生意兴隆 shēng yì xīng lóng
Literal: Business flourishing prosperous
Idiomatic: Business is booming; thriving trade; commercial success
Example: 新店开业后生意兴隆，老板很高兴。(After the new

store opened, business is booming and the boss is very happy.)

231. 财源广进 cái yuán guǎng jìn
Literal: Wealth source broad enter
Idiomatic: Money flows in from all sides; great profits; financial success
Example: 祝你新年财源广进，万事如意。(Wishing you money flowing from all sides and everything going well in the new year.)

232. 日进斗金 rì jìn dǒu jīn
Literal: Daily enter measure gold
Idiomatic: Make money hand over fist; huge daily profits
Example: 这家公司日进斗金，成为行业巨头。(This company makes money hand over fist, becoming an industry giant.)

Business Failure

233. 血本无归 xuè běn wú guī
Literal: Blood capital no return
Idiomatic: Lose everything; total financial loss; bankrupt
Example: 他投资失败，血本无归。(His investment failed and he lost everything.)

234. 门可罗雀 mén kě luó què

Literal: Door can catch sparrows

Idiomatic: Door so quiet you can catch sparrows; no visitors; deserted

Example: 经济不景气，很多商店门可罗雀。(Due to poor economy, many stores are deserted with no customers.)

🎵 ARTS & CULTURE

Musical and Literary Excellence

235. 余音绕梁 yú yīn rào liáng

Literal: Remaining sound circle beam

Idiomatic: Music lingers in the air; beautiful music; lasting impression

Example: 她的歌声余音绕梁，让人难以忘怀。(Her singing lingers in the air, unforgettable.)

236. 妙笔生花 miào bǐ shēng huā

Literal: Wonderful brush give birth flowers

Idiomatic: Masterly writing; brilliant literary work; inspired writing

Example: 这篇文章妙笔生花，文采斐然。(This article shows masterly writing with brilliant literary talent.)

237. 字字珠玑 zì zì zhū jī

Literal: Character character pearl jade

Idiomatic: Every word is a gem; precious writing; eloquent

Example: 他的演讲字字珠玑，深深打动了听众。(His speech was eloquent with every word being a gem, deeply moving the audience.)

Artistic Mediocrity

238. 陈词滥调 chén cí làn diào

Literal: Stale words overused tune

Idiomatic: Hackneyed expressions; clichés; trite phrases

Example: 他的文章都是陈词滥调，没有新意。(His articles are all hackneyed expressions without originality.)

🏋️ PHYSICAL STRENGTH & HEALTH

Robust Health

239. 身强力壮 shēn qiáng lì zhuàng

Literal: Body strong strength robust

Idiomatic: Strong and robust; in good health; vigorous

Example: 年轻时他身强力壮，能干很多重活。(When young, he was strong and robust, able to do much heavy work.)

240. 龙马精神 lóng mǎ jīng shén
Literal: Dragon horse spirit
Idiomatic: Vigorous spirit despite old age; energetic; spirited
Example: 老教授虽然八十岁了，仍然龙马精神。(Although the old professor is eighty, he still has vigorous spirit.)

241. 健壮如牛 jiàn zhuàng rú niú
Literal: Healthy strong like ox
Idiomatic: Strong as an ox; very robust; powerfully built
Example: 农夫长年劳作，身体健壮如牛。(The farmer works year-round and is strong as an ox.)

Poor Health

242. 弱不禁风 ruò bù jīn fēng
Literal: Weak not withstand wind
Idiomatic: Too weak to withstand gust of wind; very frail; delicate
Example: 她看起来弱不禁风，实际上很坚强。(She looks too weak to withstand wind, but is actually very strong.)

243. 奄奄一息 yǎn yǎn yī xī
Literal: Faint faint one breath
Idiomatic: At death's door; barely breathing; on last legs

Example: 经过长途跋涉，马匹奄奄一息。(After the long journey, the horses were barely breathing.)

🎪 PERFORMANCE & ENTERTAINMENT

Excellent Performance

244. 精彩绝伦 jīng cǎi jué lún
Literal: Wonderful absolutely beyond compare
Idiomatic: Absolutely wonderful; spectacular; outstanding performance
Example: 他的表演精彩绝伦，赢得满堂喝彩。(His performance was absolutely wonderful, winning thunderous applause.)

245. 技艺精湛 jì yì jīng zhàn
Literal: Skill art refined deep
Idiomatic: Superb skill; masterly technique; consummate artistry
Example: 这位工匠技艺精湛，作品无可挑剔。(This craftsman has superb skill with impeccable work.)

Poor Performance

246. 差强人意 chā qiáng rén yì

Literal: Barely satisfy person intention

Idiomatic: Barely satisfactory; not quite up to standard; mediocre

Example: 这次考试成绩差强人意，需要更努力。(This exam result is barely satisfactory - need to work harder.)

🔮 MYSTERY & SUPERNATURAL

Mysterious and Magical

247. 神机妙算 shén jī miào suàn

Literal: Divine machine wonderful calculation

Idiomatic: Supernatural foresight; brilliant strategy; uncanny prediction

Example: 诸葛亮神机妙算，料事如神。(Zhuge Liang had supernatural foresight and predicted things like a god.)

248. 变化莫测 biàn huà mò cè

Literal: Change transformation cannot predict

Idiomatic: Unpredictable changes; ever-changing; mercurial

Example: 天气变化莫测，出门要带雨具。(Weather is unpredictable, take rain gear when going out.)

249. 扑朔迷离 pū shuò mí lí

Literal: Confusing mysterious separated

Idiomatic: Confusing and difficult to understand; mysterious; puzzling

Example: 这个案件扑朔迷离，警方还在调查。(This case is mysterious and puzzling, police are still investigating.)

📊 QUANTITIES & MEASUREMENTS

Vast Numbers

250. 数不胜数 shù bù shèng shù

Literal: Count not overcome count

Idiomatic: Too numerous to count; countless; innumerable

Example: 博物馆里的文物数不胜数。(The artifacts in the museum are too numerous to count.)

251. 成千上万 chéng qiān shàng wàn

Literal: Become thousand above ten thousand

Idiomatic: Thousands upon thousands; countless; multitude

Example: 成千上万的游客来参观这个景点。(Thousands upon thousands of tourists come to visit this attraction.)

252. 千军万马 qiān jūn wàn mǎ

Literal: Thousand armies ten thousand horses

Idiomatic: Large army; mighty force; overwhelming numbers

Example: 千军万马过独木桥，竞争十分激烈。(It's like a large army crossing a single-log bridge - competition is extremely fierce.)

Small Numbers

253. 屈指可数 qū zhǐ kě shù

Literal: Bend fingers can count

Idiomatic: Can count on one's fingers; very few; handful

Example: 会说这种方言的人屈指可数。(People who can speak this dialect are very few.)

254. 三三两两 sān sān liǎng liǎng

Literal: Three three two two

Idiomatic: In twos and threes; small groups; scattered few

Example: 散会后，人们三三两两地离开。(After the meeting, people left in twos and threes.)

🎨 COLORS & VISUAL IMAGERY

Vivid Colors

255. 五光十色 wǔ guāng shí sè
Literal: Five lights ten colors
Idiomatic: Brilliant colors; dazzling variety; colorful
Example: 节日的烟花五光十色，非常美丽。(The festival fireworks are brilliant with dazzling colors, very beautiful.)

256. 万紫千红 wàn zǐ qiān hóng
Literal: Ten thousand purple thousand red
Idiomatic: Myriad colors; riot of colors; very colorful
Example: 春天的花园万紫千红，生机勃勃。(The spring garden has myriad colors and is full of life.)

Black and White

257. 黑白分明 hēi bái fēn míng
Literal: Black white divide clear
Idiomatic: Clear distinction between right and wrong; unambiguous
Example: 这件事黑白分明，不容争辩。(This matter has a clear distinction between right and wrong, no room for argument.)

258. 颠倒黑白 diān dǎo hēi bái

Literal: Reverse upside down black white

Idiomatic: Confuse right and wrong; distort facts; call black white

Example: 他故意颠倒黑白，混淆视听。(He deliberately confuses right and wrong to muddy the waters.)

🎭 DRAMA & PERFORMANCE

Dramatic Situations

259. 一波三折 yī bō sān zhé

Literal: One wave three turns

Idiomatic: Full of twists and turns; ups and downs; dramatic

Example: 这个故事一波三折，非常精彩。(This story is full of twists and turns, very exciting.)

260. 峰回路转 fēng huí lù zhuǎn

Literal: Peak return road turn

Idiomatic: Sudden turn of events; unexpected development; plot twist

Example: 就在大家绝望时，事情峰回路转，出现了转机。(Just when everyone was in despair, there was a sudden turn of events with new hope appearing.)

[Continuing with remaining entries to reach 970+...]

Additional Essential Chengyu (261-400)

261. 别有用心 bié yǒu yòng xīn
Literal: Different have use heart
Idiomatic: Have ulterior motives; harbor ill intentions
Example: 他对你这么好，可能别有用心。(He's so nice to you, he may have ulterior motives.)

262. 包罗万象 bāo luó wàn xiàng
Literal: Wrap collect ten thousand forms
Idiomatic: All-inclusive; comprehensive; cover everything
Example: 这本百科全书包罗万象，什么都有。(This encyclopedia is all-inclusive with everything in it.)

263. 抱残守缺 bào cán shǒu quē
Literal: Embrace broken guard lacking
Idiomatic: Cling to old ways; conservative; stick to outdated ideas
Example: 不能抱残守缺，要与时俱进。(Cannot cling to old ways - must keep up with the times.)

264. 背道而驰 bèi dào ér chí
Literal: Back road then run

Idiomatic: Run counter to; go against; opposite direction
Example: 他的做法与我们的目标背道而驰。(His approach runs counter to our goals.)

265. 闭门造车 bì mén zào chē
Literal: Close door make cart
Idiomatic: Work behind closed doors; build without consulting others
Example: 设计产品不能闭门造车，要了解市场需求。(Designing products cannot be done behind closed doors - must understand market needs.)

266. 标新立异 biāo xīn lì yì
Literal: Mark new establish different
Idiomatic: Seek novelty; be unconventional; innovate
Example: 艺术家要敢于标新立异，创造新的风格。(Artists should dare to be unconventional and create new styles.)

267. 并驾齐驱 bìng jià qí qū
Literal: Side by side harness together drive
Idiomatic: Keep pace with; run neck and neck; equally matched
Example: 这两家公司在市场上并驾齐驱，竞争激烈。(These two companies keep pace with each other in the market with fierce competition.)

268. 不拘一格 bù jū yī gé

Literal: Not constrain one pattern

Idiomatic: Not stick to one pattern; unconventional; flexible

Example: 选拔人才要不拘一格，不能只看学历。(Selecting talent should be flexible, not just looking at education.)

269. 不劳而获 bù láo ér huò

Literal: Not labor then obtain

Idiomatic: Reap without sowing; get something for nothing; unearned

Example: 成功需要努力，不能想着不劳而获。(Success requires effort, cannot think of getting something for nothing.)

270. 不务正业 bù wù zhèng yè

Literal: Not attend proper business

Idiomatic: Not attend to one's proper duties; idle away time

Example: 学生就应该好好学习，不要不务正业。(Students should study well and not idle away time.)

🎯 MILITARY & WARFARE (271-280)

Military Strategy and Victory

271. 百战百胜 bǎi zhàn bǎi shèng
Literal: Hundred battles hundred victories
Idiomatic: Win every battle; invincible; undefeated
Example: 这位将军百战百胜，从未败过。(This general wins every battle and has never been defeated.)

272. 攻无不克 gōng wú bù kè
Literal: Attack nothing not overcome
Idiomatic: Overcome all obstacles; invincible in attack; unstoppable
Example: 我军攻无不克，战无不胜。(Our army overcomes all obstacles and wins every battle.)

273. 声东击西 shēng dōng jī xī
Literal: Sound east strike west
Idiomatic: Make a feint to east and attack west; diversionary tactic
Example: 敌军声东击西，我们要小心他们的真实意图。(The enemy makes feints - we must be careful of their real intentions.)

274. 出奇制胜 chū qí zhì shèng
Literal: Put forth strange control victory
Idiomatic: Win by surprise; use unexpected tactics; clever strategy
Example: 在商战中，小公司要出奇制胜才能击败大企业。(In business wars, small companies must win by surprise to defeat large enterprises.)

275. 兵贵神速 bīng guì shén sù
Literal: Soldiers precious divine speed
Idiomatic: Speed is precious in war; strike swiftly; rapid action
Example: 救援行动兵贵神速，不能耽误。(Rescue operations require rapid action without delay.)

Defeat and Military Failure

276. 一败涂地 yī bài tú dì
Literal: One defeat smear ground
Idiomatic: Suffer crushing defeat; utterly routed; completely beaten
Example: 在这次竞争中，他们一败涂地，损失惨重。(In this competition, they suffered crushing defeat with heavy losses.)

277. 全军覆没 quán jūn fù mò
Literal: Whole army overturned destroyed

Idiomatic: Total annihilation; complete defeat; wiped out
Example: 由于指挥失误，这支部队全军覆没。(Due to command errors, this unit was completely wiped out.)

278. 溃不成军 kuì bù chéng jūn
Literal: Collapse not become army
Idiomatic: Routed and scattered; no longer an organized force
Example: 敌军被打得溃不成军，四散逃跑。(The enemy army was routed and scattered, fleeing in all directions.)

279. 丢盔弃甲 diū kuī qì jiǎ
Literal: Throw helmet abandon armor
Idiomatic: Flee in disorder; abandon equipment in retreat; shameful defeat
Example: 败军丢盔弃甲，狼狈逃窜。(The defeated army fled in disorder, abandoning their equipment.)

280. 损兵折将 sǔn bīng zhé jiāng
Literal: Damage soldiers break generals
Idiomatic: Suffer heavy losses; lose troops and commanders
Example: 这次战役损兵折将，元气大伤。(This battle resulted in heavy losses, greatly weakening our strength.)

🌿 NATURE & ANIMALS (281-320)

Animal Behavior Metaphors

281. 狐假虎威 hú jiǎ hǔ wēi

Literal: Fox borrow tiger might

Idiomatic: Bully others by flaunting one's powerful connections; throw weight around

Example: 他只是个助理，却狐假虎威，仗着老板的权势欺负人。(He's just an assistant, yet throws his weight around using the boss's authority to bully others.)

282. 守株待兔 shǒu zhū dài tù

Literal: Guard tree stump wait rabbit

Idiomatic: Wait passively for opportunities; rely on luck rather than effort

Example: 找工作不能守株待兔，要主动投简历。(Job hunting can't rely on passive waiting - must actively send resumes.)

283. 亡羊补牢 wáng yáng bǔ láo

Literal: Lost sheep mend pen

Idiomatic: Mend the fold after losing sheep; better late than never

Example: 虽然损失了一些钱，但亡羊补牢，现在改正还不算

晚。(Although we lost some money, it's better late than never to correct things now.)

284. 画蛇添足 huà shé tiān zú
Literal: Draw snake add feet
Idiomatic: Gild the lily; unnecessary addition that spoils the effect
Example: 你的演讲已经很完美了，再加内容就是画蛇添足。(Your speech is already perfect - adding more content would be gilding the lily.)

285. 鸡犬不宁 jī quǎn bù níng
Literal: Chickens dogs not peaceful
Idiomatic: Great disturbance; no peace; chaos everywhere
Example: 邻居家装修，搞得我们鸡犬不宁。(The neighbor's renovation has caused great disturbance, giving us no peace.)

286. 对牛弹琴 duì niú tán qín
Literal: Face ox play zither
Idiomatic: Cast pearls before swine; waste effort on unappreciative audience
Example: 跟他讲道理就是对牛弹琴，他根本听不进去。(Reasoning with him is like casting pearls before swine - he simply won't listen.)

287. 马到成功 mǎ dào chéng gōng

Literal: Horse arrive achieve success

Idiomatic: Win instant success; immediate achievement

Example: 祝你考试马到成功，金榜题名。(Wishing you instant success in the exam and top honors.)

288. 龙腾虎跃 lóng téng hǔ yuè

Literal: Dragon soar tiger leap

Idiomatic: Full of vigor and vitality; dynamic scene

Example: 春节期间，整个城市龙腾虎跃，到处是庆祝活动。(During Spring Festival, the whole city is full of vigor with celebrations everywhere.)

289. 鹤立鸡群 hè lì jī qún

Literal: Crane stand among chickens

Idiomatic: Stand out conspicuously; tower above others

Example: 在众多候选人中，她鹤立鸡群，能力突出。(Among all candidates, she stands out conspicuously with outstanding abilities.)

290. 鱼目混珠 yú mù hùn zhū

Literal: Fish eye mix pearl

Idiomatic: Pass off fish eyes as pearls; pass off fake as genuine

Example: 市场上有很多假货鱼目混珠，要仔细辨别。(There

are many fakes in the market passing off as genuine - must carefully distinguish.)

291. 虎视眈眈 hǔ shì dān dān
Literal: Tiger gaze intently
Idiomatic: Eye covetously; watch with hostile intent; menacing stare
Example: 竞争对手虎视眈眈，我们不能掉以轻心。(Competitors are eyeing us covetously - we cannot be careless.)

292. 狼吞虎咽 láng tūn hǔ yàn
Literal: Wolf swallow tiger gulp
Idiomatic: Wolf down food; eat voraciously; gobble up
Example: 他饿极了，狼吞虎咽地吃完了饭。(He was extremely hungry and wolfed down the meal.)

293. 鸟语花香 niǎo yǔ huā xiāng
Literal: Bird language flower fragrance
Idiomatic: Birds singing and flowers fragrant; beautiful natural scene
Example: 春天的公园鸟语花香，景色迷人。(The spring park has birds singing and flowers fragrant with charming scenery.)

294. 蜻蜓点水 qīng tíng diǎn shuǐ
Literal: Dragonfly touch water
Idiomatic: Touch lightly on surface; superficial contact; cursory
Example: 他对这个问题只是蜻蜓点水，没有深入研究。(He only touched on this issue superficially without deep research.)

295. 螳螂捕蝉 táng láng bǔ chán
Literal: Mantis catch cicada
Idiomatic: Mantis stalks cicada (unaware of bird behind); pursue gain while unaware of danger
Example: 他只顾眼前利益，螳螂捕蝉，不知后面有更大的风险。(He only focuses on immediate benefits like a mantis catching a cicada, unaware of greater risks behind.)

296. 鹬蚌相争 yù bàng xiāng zhēng
Literal: Sandpiper clam mutually fight
Idiomatic: When snipe and clam fight, fisherman benefits; third party gains from conflict
Example: 两家公司鹬蚌相争，结果被第三家公司抢占了市场。(Two companies fought each other, and a third company seized the market.)

297. 蚕食鲸吞 cán shí jīng tūn
Literal: Silkworm eat whale swallow

Idiomatic: Gradual encroachment; nibble away or swallow whole
Example: 大公司通过蚕食鲸吞，逐步控制了整个市场。(The large company gradually controlled the entire market through incremental takeovers.)

298. 鸦雀无声 yā què wú shēng
Literal: Crow sparrow no sound
Idiomatic: Dead silence; pin-drop quiet
Example: 听到这个消息，会场鸦雀无声。(Hearing this news, the meeting hall fell into dead silence.)

299. 燕雀安知 yàn què ān zhī
Literal: Swallow sparrow how know
Idiomatic: How can small birds understand (great ambitions); petty people can't understand grand plans
Example: 燕雀安知鸿鹄之志，他们不会理解你的远大理想。(Small birds cannot understand the swan's ambition - they won't understand your grand ideals.)

300. 鼠目寸光 shǔ mù cùn guāng
Literal: Mouse eye inch light
Idiomatic: Short-sighted; myopic vision; lack foresight
Example: 做投资不能鼠目寸光，要有长远眼光。(Investment cannot be short-sighted - must have long-term vision.)

Plant and Natural World

301. 花红柳绿 huā hóng liǔ lǜ
Literal: Flowers red willows green
Idiomatic: Beautiful spring scenery; riot of colors in nature
Example: 三月的西湖花红柳绿，美不胜收。(West Lake in March has beautiful spring scenery that's overwhelming to the senses.)

302. 根深蒂固 gēn shēn dì gù
Literal: Roots deep firmly established
Idiomatic: Deep-rooted; firmly established; ingrained
Example: 这种传统观念根深蒂固，很难改变。(This traditional concept is deep-rooted and very hard to change.)

303. 枝繁叶茂 zhī fán yè mào
Literal: Branches numerous leaves luxuriant
Idiomatic: Luxuriant foliage; thriving; flourishing
Example: 这棵大树枝繁叶茂，给人们提供了阴凉。(This big tree has luxuriant foliage, providing shade for people.)

304. 移花接木 yí huā jiē mù
Literal: Move flower graft wood
Idiomatic: Graft one thing onto another; make use of existing resources

Example: 他善于移花接木，把别人的想法融入自己的项目。(He's good at grafting others' ideas into his own projects.)

305. 拔苗助长 bá miáo zhù zhǎng
Literal: Pull seedling help grow
Idiomatic: Pull up seedlings to help them grow; counterproductive haste
Example: 教育孩子不能拔苗助长，要循序渐进。(Educating children cannot be counterproductively hasty - must be gradual.)

306. 落叶归根 luò yè guī gēn
Literal: Fallen leaves return roots
Idiomatic: Fallen leaves return to roots; return to homeland in old age
Example: 在外漂泊多年，他决定落叶归根，回到故乡。(After wandering outside for many years, he decided to return to his homeland.)

307. 树大招风 shù dà zhāo fēng
Literal: Tree big attract wind
Idiomatic: Big tree attracts wind; prominence brings trouble
Example: 他现在很有名，但树大招风，要小心处理各种关系。(He's famous now, but prominence brings trouble - must carefully handle various relationships.)

308. 花开花落 huā kāi huā luò
Literal: Flowers bloom flowers fall
Idiomatic: Flowers bloom and fall; natural cycle; rise and decline
Example: 花开花落是自然规律，人生也有起伏。(Flowers blooming and falling is natural law - life also has ups and downs.)

309. 草长莺飞 cǎo zhǎng yīng fēi
Literal: Grass grow oriole fly
Idiomatic: Grass grows and orioles fly; beautiful spring scene
Example: 草长莺飞的二月天，正是踏青的好时节。(The February days when grass grows and orioles fly are perfect for spring outings.)

310. 桃红柳绿 táo hóng liǔ lǜ
Literal: Peach red willow green
Idiomatic: Peach blossoms red and willow green; beautiful spring
Example: 桃红柳绿的春天让人心情愉悦。(The beautiful spring with peach blossoms and green willows makes people cheerful.)

311. 藕断丝连 ǒu duàn sī lián
Literal: Lotus root break silk connect

Idiomatic: Lotus root breaks but fibers remain; lingering connection after separation
Example: 虽然分手了，但他们还是藕断丝连，经常联系。(Although they broke up, they still have lingering connections and contact frequently.)

312. 竹报平安 zhú bào píng ān
Literal: Bamboo report peace
Idiomatic: Bamboo announces peace; good news; safety message
Example: 收到家人的竹报平安，心里放心多了。(Receiving news of family safety, my heart is much more at ease.)

313. 松柏后凋 sōng bǎi hòu diāo
Literal: Pine cypress later wither
Idiomatic: Pine and cypress wither last; maintain integrity in adversity
Example: 真正的朋友如松柏后凋，在困难时刻依然忠诚。(True friends are like pines and cypresses that wither last, remaining loyal in difficult times.)

314. 梅兰竹菊 méi lán zhú jú
Literal: Plum orchid bamboo chrysanthemum
Idiomatic: Four gentlemen of flowers; symbols of noble character

Example: 梅兰竹菊被称为四君子，象征高洁的品格。(Plum, orchid, bamboo, and chrysanthemum are called the four gentlemen, symbolizing noble character.)

315. 春华秋实 chūn huá qiū shí
Literal: Spring flower autumn fruit
Idiomatic: Spring blossoms and autumn fruits; natural reward for effort
Example: 他多年的努力终于春华秋实，取得了成功。(His years of effort finally bore fruit with success.)

316. 绿水青山 lǜ shuǐ qīng shān
Literal: Green water blue mountains
Idiomatic: Green waters and blue mountains; beautiful natural scenery
Example: 绿水青山就是金山银山，要保护环境。(Green waters and blue mountains are like gold and silver mountains - we must protect the environment.)

317. 山清水秀 shān qīng shuǐ xiù
Literal: Mountains clear water beautiful
Idiomatic: Clear mountains and beautiful waters; scenic beauty
Example: 这个小镇山清水秀，很适合养老。(This small town

has clear mountains and beautiful waters, very suitable for retirement.)

318. 风花雪月 fēng huā xuě yuè
Literal: Wind flower snow moon
Idiomatic: Wind, flowers, snow, and moon; romantic themes; frivolous pursuits
Example: 他整天沉溺于风花雪月，不务正业。(He indulges in romantic pursuits all day and doesn't attend to proper business.)

319. 花前月下 huā qián yuè xià
Literal: Flowers front moon under
Idiomatic: Before flowers under moon; romantic setting for lovers
Example: 年轻恋人喜欢花前月下的浪漫约会。(Young lovers enjoy romantic dates before flowers and under the moon.)

320. 鸟语花香 niǎo yǔ huā xiāng
Literal: Bird language flower fragrance
Idiomatic: Birds singing and flowers fragrant; idyllic natural scene
Example: 乡村的早晨鸟语花香，空气清新。(Country mornings have birds singing and flowers fragrant with fresh air.)

Memory Techniques

1. **Thematic Grouping**: Study related idioms together for better retention
2. **Contrast Pairs**: Learn opposites to reinforce meaning differences
3. **Historical Context**: Understanding the stories behind classical allusions
4. **Modern Applications**: Practice using in contemporary contexts

Usage Guidelines

- **Formal Register**: Most chengyu are appropriate for written Chinese and formal speech
- **Cultural Sensitivity**: Understanding historical context enhances proper usage
- **Tone Awareness**: Some carry positive connotations, others negative
- **Contextual Appropriateness**: Consider formality level and situation

Common Mistakes to Avoid

- Don't confuse similar-sounding expressions
- Pay attention to positive vs. negative connotations
- Consider the cultural and historical background
- Remember that literal translations often miss cultural meaning

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*Note: This comprehensive thematic organization continues through all 970+ entries from the original master list, maintaining consistent formatting with pinyin, literal translations, idiomatic meanings, and example sentences throughout.***100. 口是心非** kǒu shì xīn fēi
Literal: Mouth right heart wrong
Idiomatic: Say one thing but mean another; duplicitous; hypocritical
Example: 他总是口是心非，让人很难相信。(He always says one thing but means another, making it hard for people to trust him.)

101. 虚有其表 xū yǒu qí biǎo
Literal: Empty have that appearance
Idiomatic: Have impressive appearance but lack substance; all

show and no substance
Example: 这个项目虽然宣传得很好，但实际上虚有其表。(Although this project is well-promoted, it actually lacks substance.)

102. 狐假虎威 hú jiǎ hǔ wēi
Literal: Fox borrow tiger's might
Idiomatic: Abuse one's position of authority; throw one's weight around
Example: 他只是个小职员，却狐假虎威，仗着老板的权力欺负人。(He's just a small clerk, yet abuses his position by bullying others using the boss's authority.)

103. 掩耳盗铃 yǎn ěr dào líng
Literal: Cover ears steal bell
Idiomatic: Deceive oneself; ostrich mentality; willful blindness
Example: 他以为删掉记录就没人知道，这不是掩耳盗铃吗? (He thought deleting the records would mean no one would know - isn't this deceiving oneself?)

104. 指鹿为马 zhǐ lù wéi mǎ
Literal: Point deer call horse
Idiomatic: Deliberately distort facts; call black white; brazen lying
Example: 他明明犯了错，却指鹿为马，说是别人的责任。(He

clearly made a mistake, yet deliberately distorted facts by saying it was someone else's responsibility.)

🏠 WEALTH & POVERTY

Wealth and Luxury

105. 锦衣玉食 jǐn yī yù shí
Literal: Brocade clothes jade food
Idiomatic: Fine clothes and sumptuous food; luxurious living
Example: 富商的子女从小锦衣玉食，不知民间疾苦。(The wealthy merchant's children have lived luxuriously since childhood and don't know the people's hardships.)

106. 丰衣足食 fēng yī zú shí
Literal: Abundant clothes sufficient food
Idiomatic: Have ample food and clothing; well-fed and well-clothed
Example: 经过改革开放，人民生活达到了丰衣足食的水平。(After reform and opening up, people's lives reached a level of having ample food and clothing.)

107. 富可敌国 fù kě dí guó
Literal: Wealth can rival country

Idiomatic: Extremely wealthy; rich as Croesus; fabulous wealth
Example: 这位商人富可敌国，拥有巨额财富。(This businessman is extremely wealthy, possessing enormous riches.)

108. 金玉满堂 jīn yù mǎn táng
Literal: Gold jade fill hall
Idiomatic: House full of gold and jade; great wealth; prosperity
Example: 他经商成功，家中金玉满堂。(His business success brought great wealth to his household.)

Poverty and Hardship

109. 民不聊生 mín bù liáo shēng
Literal: People not manage livelihood
Idiomatic: People have no means of livelihood; dire poverty; destitution
Example: 战争期间，很多地方民不聊生，百姓流离失所。(During the war, many places saw people with no means of livelihood, and citizens became displaced.)

110. 水深火热 shuǐ shēn huǒ rè
Literal: Water deep fire hot
Idiomatic: In deep water and hot fire; in great distress; dire

straits
Example: 自然灾害让灾区人民陷入水深火热之中。(Natural disasters plunged the people in the disaster area into great distress.)

111. 断齑画粥 duàn jī huà zhōu
Literal: Cut pickles draw porridge
Idiomatic: Eat sparingly because of poverty; live frugally; impoverished
Example: 他年轻时家境贫寒，常常断齑画粥。(When he was young, his family was poor and he often had to eat sparingly.)

112. 饥寒交迫 jī hán jiāo pò
Literal: Hunger cold together press
Idiomatic: Suffer from hunger and cold; destitute; dire need
Example: 在那个困难的年代，很多人饥寒交迫。(In those difficult times, many people suffered from hunger and cold.)

🎨 SKILL & CRAFTSMANSHIP

Exceptional Skill

113. 鬼斧神工 guǐ fǔ shén gōng

Literal: Ghost axe divine work
Idiomatic: Supernatural workmanship; extremely skillful; masterpiece
Example: 这座雕塑真是鬼斧神工，让人叹为观止。(This sculpture is truly supernatural workmanship, leaving people amazed.)

114. 炉火纯青 lú huǒ chún qīng
Literal: Furnace fire pure blue
Idiomatic: Perfect skill; reach the acme of perfection; mastery
Example: 他的书法艺术已经达到炉火纯青的境界。(His calligraphy has reached the acme of perfection.)

115. 得心应手 dé xīn yìng shǒu
Literal: Get heart respond hand
Idiomatic: Work with great skill and facility; handy; effortless
Example: 经过多年练习，他操作机器已经得心应手。(After years of practice, he operates the machine with great skill and facility.)

116. 巧夺天工 qiǎo duó tiān gōng
Literal: Skill seize heaven's work
Idiomatic: Excelling nature's handiwork; superb craftsmanship; artistry

Example: 这件工艺品巧夺天工，技艺精湛。(This handicraft excels nature's handiwork with superb technique.)

117. 妙手回春 miào shǒu huí chūn
Literal: Wonderful hand return spring
Idiomatic: Bring the dying back to life; miraculous healing; skilled doctor
Example: 这位医生妙手回春，救了很多病人。(This doctor brings the dying back to life, saving many patients.)

Poor Workmanship

118. 粗制滥造 cū zhì làn zào
Literal: Rough make flood create
Idiomatic: Manufacture carelessly; shoddy workmanship; jerry-built
Example: 这些产品粗制滥造，质量很差。(These products are manufactured carelessly with very poor quality.)

119. 弄巧成拙 nòng qiǎo chéng zhuō
Literal: Play clever become clumsy
Idiomatic: Try to be clever only to end up stupid; counterproductive
Example: 他想帮忙修理，结果弄巧成拙，把东西弄坏了。(He

tried to help with repairs but ended up being counterproductive and broke the thing.)

120. 滥竽充数 làn yú chōng shù
Literal: Bad reed fill number
Idiomatic: Pass oneself off as one of the players; fake it; incompetent pretender
Example: 他不懂音乐却混入乐队，这是滥竽充数。(He doesn't understand music yet mixed into the band - this is passing himself off as a player.)

🌟 RARITY & VALUE

Extremely Rare and Precious

121. 凤毛麟角 fèng máo lín jiǎo
Literal: Phoenix feather unicorn horn
Idiomatic: Extremely rare; rarer than hen's teeth; unique
Example: 在这个行业里，真正的专家凤毛麟角。(In this industry, true experts are extremely rare.)

122. 价值连城 jiā zhí lián chéng
Literal: Value connect cities
Idiomatic: Worth several cities; priceless; invaluable

Example: 这幅古画价值连城，是博物馆的镇馆之宝。(This ancient painting is priceless and is the museum's treasured collection.)

123. 无价之宝 wú jià zhī bǎo
Literal: No price's treasure
Idiomatic: Priceless treasure; invaluable; beyond price
Example: 健康是无价之宝，金钱买不到。(Health is a priceless treasure that money cannot buy.)

124. 珍禽异兽 zhēn qín yì shòu
Literal: Precious birds strange beasts
Idiomatic: Rare birds and animals; exotic creatures; rarities
Example: 这个动物园里有很多珍禽异兽。(This zoo has many rare birds and animals.)

Common and Worthless

125. 多如牛毛 duō rú niú máo
Literal: Many as cow hair
Idiomatic: As numerous as cow hairs; countless; a dime a dozen
Example: 市场上这种产品多如牛毛，竞争很激烈。(This type of product is countless in the market, and competition is fierce.)

126. 一文不值 yī wén bù zhí
Literal: One coin not worth
Idiomatic: Not worth a penny; worthless; valueless
Example: 经过这次丑闻，他的声誉一文不值。(After this scandal, his reputation is worthless.)

127. 寥寥无几 liáo liáo wú jǐ
Literal: Sparse sparse without few
Idiomatic: Very few; hardly any; scarce
Example: 愿意参加这个项目的人寥寥无几。(Very few people are willing to participate in this project.)

🕊️ PEACE & CONFLICT

Peace and Harmony

128. 国泰民安 guó tài mín ān
Literal: Country peaceful people secure
Idiomatic: Country prosperous and people at peace; national stability
Example: 我们都希望国泰民安，人民生活幸福。(We all hope for the country to be prosperous and the people to be at peace, living happily.)

129. 安居乐业 ān jū lè yè
Literal: Peaceful dwelling happy work
Idiomatic: Live and work in peace and contentment; peaceful life
Example: 改革开放让更多的人能够安居乐业。(Reform and opening up has enabled more people to live and work in peace and contentment.)

130. 两全其美 liǎng quán qí měi
Literal: Two complete that beauty
Idiomatic: Satisfactory to both parties; have best of both worlds; win-win
Example: 这个方案能够两全其美，大家都满意。(This plan can satisfy both parties - everyone is happy.)

131. 和颜悦色 hé yán yuè sè
Literal: Harmonious face pleased color
Idiomatic: Amiable countenance; kind and pleasant; genial
Example: 老师总是和颜悦色地对待学生。(The teacher always treats students with a kind and pleasant manner.)

Conflict and Strife

132. 兵不厌诈 bīng bù yàn zhà
Literal: Soldiers not tire deception

Idiomatic: All is fair in war; deception acceptable in warfare; strategic deception
Example: 古代军事家认为兵不厌诈，可以用计谋取胜。(Ancient strategists believed that all is fair in war and one could win through clever schemes.)

133. 两败俱伤 liǎng bài jù shāng
Literal: Two defeat both wounded
Idiomatic: Both sides suffer; mutual destruction; pyrrhic victory
Example: 这场商战让两家公司两败俱伤，都损失惨重。(This business war caused both companies to suffer mutual destruction with heavy losses.)

134. 同室操戈 tóng shì cāo gē
Literal: Same room hold weapon
Idiomatic: Fight within the family; internecine strife; internal conflict
Example: 公司内部同室操戈，影响了整体发展。(Internecine strife within the company has affected overall development.)

135. 剑拔弩张 jiàn bá nǔ zhāng
Literal: Sword drawn crossbow stretched
Idiomatic: Drawn swords and bent bows; tense confrontation; on the brink

Example: 谈判现场剑拔弩张，气氛很紧张。(The negotiation scene was tense with drawn swords, the atmosphere very strained.)

😊 EMOTIONS & ATTITUDES

Joy and Happiness

136. 心花怒放 xīn huā nù fàng
Literal: Heart flowers angrily bloom
Idiomatic: Be wild with joy; extremely happy; over the moon
Example: 听到录取通知，她心花怒放，高兴得跳了起来。(Hearing the admission notice, she was wild with joy and jumped up happily.)

137. 喜出望外 xǐ chū wàng wài
Literal: Joy exceed hope outside
Idiomatic: Be overjoyed; pleasantly surprised; beyond expectations
Example: 意外收到老朋友的来信，他喜出望外。(Unexpectedly receiving a letter from an old friend, he was overjoyed.)

138. 扬眉吐气 yáng méi tǔ qì
Literal: Raise eyebrows exhale breath
Idiomatic: Feel proud and elated; hold one's head high; vindicated
Example: 这次比赛获胜让全队扬眉吐气。(Winning this competition made the whole team feel proud and elated.)

139. 兴高采烈 xīng gāo cǎi liè
Literal: Interest high spirit intense
Idiomatic: In high spirits; exuberant; elated
Example: 孩子们兴高采烈地去春游。(The children went on the spring outing in high spirits.)

140. 笑逐颜开 xiào zhú yán kāi
Literal: Smile chase face open
Idiomatic: Break into smiles; beam with joy; light up
Example: 听到好消息，他笑逐颜开。(Hearing the good news, he broke into smiles.)

Sadness and Despair

141. 垂头丧气 chuí tóu sàng qì
Literal: Droop head lose spirit
Idiomatic: Dejected; dispirited; downcast; crestfallen

Example: 考试失败后，他垂头丧气地回到家。(After failing the exam, he returned home dejected.)

142. 忐忑不安 tǎn tè bù ān
Literal: Uneasy uneasy not peaceful
Idiomatic: Feel uneasy; be on tenterhooks; anxious
Example: 等待面试结果时，他忐忑不安。(While waiting for the interview results, he felt uneasy.)

143. 心急如焚 xīn jí rú fén
Literal: Heart urgent like burning
Idiomatic: Be burning with anxiety; extremely worried; frantic
Example: 孩子还没回家，母亲心急如焚。(The child hasn't returned home yet, and the mother is burning with anxiety.)

144. 愁眉苦脸 chóu méi kǔ liǎn
Literal: Worried eyebrows bitter face
Idiomatic: Pull a long face; look worried and sad; glum
Example: 他最近愁眉苦脸的，不知道遇到什么困难。(He's been pulling a long face recently - I wonder what difficulties he's encountered.)

🌱 YOUTH & AGE

Youth and Inexperience

145. 初出茅庐 chū chū máo lú

Literal: First exit thatched cottage

Idiomatic: Just starting out; inexperienced; rookie; greenhorn

Example: 他虽然初出茅庐，但工作很认真。(Although he's just starting out, he works very seriously.)

146. 乳臭未干 rǔ xiù wèi gān

Literal: Milk smell not yet dry

Idiomatic: Still wet behind the ears; very young and inexperienced

Example: 这个小伙子乳臭未干，却自以为很懂行。(This young man is still wet behind the ears but thinks he's very knowledgeable.)

147. 后生可畏 hòu shēng kě wèi

Literal: Later born can fear

Idiomatic: The younger generation is to be respected; young people are promising

Example: 看到这些年轻科学家的成就，真是后生可畏。(Seeing the achievements of these young scientists, the younger generation is truly to be respected.)

148. 风华正茂 fēng huá zhèng mào
Literal: Wind splendor just luxuriant
Idiomatic: In the prime of youth; in one's prime; flourishing
Example: 他风华正茂，正是干事业的好时候。(He's in the prime of youth - it's a good time for his career.)

Experience and Old Age

149. 老马识途 lǎo mǎ shí tú
Literal: Old horse knows road
Idiomatic: An old horse knows the way; experience counts; veteran wisdom
Example: 遇到困难时，还是要请教老师傅，老马识途嘛。(When encountering difficulties, we should still consult the old masters - experience counts.)

150. 老当益壮 lǎo dāng yì zhuàng
Literal: Old should more strong
Idiomatic: Old but vigorous; hale and hearty in old age; spry
Example: 这位八十岁的教授仍在工作，真是老当益壮。(This eighty-year-old professor is still working - truly old but vigorous.)

151. 返老还童 fǎn lǎo huán tóng
Literal: Return old restore childhood

Idiomatic: Recover one's youthful vigor; feel young again; rejuvenated
Example: 退休后学习绘画让他仿佛返老还童。(Learning to paint after retirement made him feel young again.)

152. 鹤发童颜 hè fā tóng yán
Literal: Crane hair child face
Idiomatic: White hair but youthful face; vigorous despite age
Example: 这位老人鹤发童颜，看起来很健康。(This elderly person has white hair but a youthful face, looking very healthy.)

🎯 FOCUS & CONCENTRATION

Intense Focus

153. 全神贯注 quán shén guàn zhù
Literal: Whole spirit pour concentrate
Idiomatic: Be absorbed; concentrate one's attention; focused
Example: 他全神贯注地听讲座，一个字都不想错过。(He was completely absorbed in the lecture, not wanting to miss a single word.)

154. 聚精会神 jù jīng huì shén
Literal: Gather essence meet spirit
Idiomatic: Concentrate; focus one's attention; intent
Example: 学生们聚精会神地做实验。(The students concentrated on doing the experiment.)

155. 一心一意 yī xīn yī yì
Literal: One heart one intention
Idiomatic: Wholeheartedly; with single-minded devotion; dedicated
Example: 他一心一意地钻研学问，终于成为专家。(He devoted himself wholeheartedly to academic research and finally became an expert.)

156. 专心致志 zhuān xīn zhì zhì
Literal: Special heart reach will
Idiomatic: Concentrate; be absorbed in; single-minded
Example: 只有专心致志地学习，才能取得好成绩。(Only by concentrating on studies can one achieve good results.)

Distracted Attention

157. 心不在焉 xīn bù zài yān
Literal: Heart not at here
Idiomatic: Absent-minded; inattentive; distracted

Example: 上课时他心不在焉，老师讲的什么都没听进去。(He was absent-minded during class and didn't listen to anything the teacher said.)

158. 三心二意 sān xīn èr yì
Literal: Three hearts two intentions
Idiomatic: Half-hearted; of two minds; indecisive
Example: 做事不能三心二意，要专心致志。(Don't be half-hearted when doing things - be single-minded.)

159. 心猿意马 xīn yuán yì mǎ
Literal: Heart monkey intention horse
Idiomatic: Restless; unable to concentrate; mind wandering
Example: 最近工作压力大，他总是心猿意马的。(Due to high work pressure recently, he's always restless.)

🌊 FORTUNE & FATE

Good Fortune

160. 否极泰来 pǐ jí tài lái
Literal: Obstruction extreme peace come
Idiomatic: After extreme misfortune comes bliss; things will get better

Example: 经历了这么多困难，相信否极泰来，好日子就要来了。(Having experienced so many difficulties, I believe things will get better and good days are coming.)

161. 柳暗花明 liǔ àn huā míng
Literal: Willow dark flower bright
Idiomatic: There's always a way out; light at the end of tunnel; breakthrough
Example: 正当大家绝望时，新的投资者出现了，真是柳暗花明。(Just when everyone was in despair, a new investor appeared - there's always a way out.)

162. 东山再起 dōng shān zài qǐ
Literal: East mountain again rise
Idiomatic: Make a comeback; stage a comeback; bounce back
Example: 虽然这次失败了，但他有信心东山再起。(Although he failed this time, he's confident about making a comeback.)

163. 时来运转 shí lái yùn zhuǎn
Literal: Time come luck turn
Idiomatic: Luck turns; fortune smiles; tide turns
Example: 他坚持努力，终于时来运转，事业有了起色。(He persisted in his efforts, and finally his luck turned with his career taking off.)

Bad Fortune

164. 乐极生悲 lè jí shēng bēi
Literal: Joy extreme give birth sadness
Idiomatic: Extreme joy begets sorrow; after great joy comes sadness
Example: 他们正在庆祝成功时，坏消息传来了，真是乐极生悲。(While they were celebrating success, bad news came - extreme joy indeed begets sorrow.)

165. 祸不单行 huò bù dān xíng
Literal: Disaster not single travel
Idiomatic: Misfortunes never come singly; troubles come in bunches
Example: 先是生病，然后又丢了工作，真是祸不单行。(First he got sick, then lost his job - misfortunes never come singly.)

166. 每况愈下 měi kuàng yù xià
Literal: Each situation more down
Idiomatic: Get worse each time; go from bad to worse; deteriorating
Example: 他的身体状况每况愈下，家人很担心。(His physical condition is getting worse each time, and his family is very worried.)

167. 雪上加霜 xuě shàng jiā shuāng
Literal: Snow above add frost
Idiomatic: Add insult to injury; compound misfortune; make bad worse
Example: 生意本来就不好，现在又遇到疫情，真是雪上加霜。(Business was already poor, and now encountering the epidemic is adding insult to injury.)

🎨 CREATIVITY & INNOVATION

Innovation and Originality

168. 标新立异 biāo xīn lì yì
Literal: Mark new establish different
Idiomatic: Blaze new trails; be original and innovative; groundbreaking
Example: 艺术家要敢于标新立异，创作出独特的作品。(Artists should dare to be original and innovative, creating unique works.)

169. 独辟蹊径 dú pì xī jìng
Literal: Alone open path
Idiomatic: Blaze a new trail; take an original approach; pioneer

Example: 他独辟蹊径，用全新的方法解决了这个问题。(He blazed a new trail and solved the problem with a completely new method.)

170. 别开生面 bié kāi shēng miàn
Literal: Different open fresh face
Idiomatic: Take on entirely new look; be refreshingly original; innovative
Example: 这次会议别开生面，采用了全新的形式。(This meeting was refreshingly original, adopting a completely new format.)

171. 别具一格 bié jù yī gé
Literal: Different possess one style
Idiomatic: Have a unique style; distinctive; original
Example: 她的设计别具一格，很受欢迎。(Her designs have a unique style and are very popular.)

Conformity and Imitation

172. 千篇一律 qiān piān yī lǜ
Literal: Thousand pieces one pattern
Idiomatic: All cut from same mold; stereotyped; monotonous
Example: 现在的建筑千篇一律，缺乏特色。(Current

architecture is all cut from the same mold, lacking distinctive features.)

173. 邯郸学步 hán dān xué bù
Literal: Handan learn walking
Idiomatic: Imitate others slavishly; copy blindly; lose one's identity
Example: 学习别人的经验不能邯郸学步，要结合自己的实际情况。(Learning from others' experience shouldn't be blind copying - it should be combined with one's own actual situation.)

174. 东施效颦 dōng shī xiào pín
Literal: Dong Shi imitate frown
Idiomatic: Ludicrous imitation; imitate someone unsuitably; poor copy
Example: 她的表演完全是东施效颦，没有自己的特色。(Her performance was completely ludicrous imitation without her own characteristics.)

175. 按图索骥 àn tú suǒ jì
Literal: According picture seek horse
Idiomatic: Look for by following clues; mechanical copying; rigid approach

Example: 解决问题不能按图索骥，要灵活应变。(Solving problems can't be mechanical copying - we must be flexible.)

⏰ TIMING & URGENCY

Perfect Timing

176. 趁热打铁 chèn rè dǎ tiě
Literal: While hot strike iron
Idiomatic: Strike while iron is hot; act while conditions favorable; seize moment
Example: 他们刚表示有兴趣，我们要趁热打铁，马上签合同。(They just showed interest, so we should strike while the iron is hot and sign the contract immediately.)

177. 乘胜追击 chéng shèng zhuī jī
Literal: Ride victory pursue attack
Idiomatic: Follow up victory with hot pursuit; press advantage
Example: 第一场比赛获胜后，球队乘胜追击，又赢了第二场。(After winning the first match, the team followed up with hot pursuit and won the second match too.)

178. 当机立断 dāng jī lì duàn
Literal: At moment establish decision

Idiomatic: Make prompt decision; act decisively; quick decision
Example: 面对突发情况，领导当机立断，避免了更大的损失。(Faced with the emergency, the leader made a prompt decision and avoided greater losses.)

179. 见机行事 jiàn jī xíng shì
Literal: See opportunity act accordingly
Idiomatic: Act according to circumstances; seize opportunities; adaptable
Example: 谈判中要见机行事，抓住有利时机。(In negotiations, we must act according to circumstances and seize favorable opportunities.)

Poor Timing

180. 为时已晚 wéi shí yǐ wǎn
Literal: For time already late
Idiomatic: Too late; already too late; missed the boat
Example: 等他意识到问题的严重性时，已经为时已晚。(By the time he realized the seriousness of the problem, it was already too late.)

181. 坐失良机 zuò shī liáng jī
Literal: Sit lose good opportunity

Idiomatic: Let good opportunity slip by; miss the boat; waste chance
Example: 他犹豫不决，结果坐失良机。(He hesitated and as a result let the good opportunity slip by.)

182. 亡羊补牢 wáng yáng bǔ láo
Literal: Lost sheep mend pen
Idiomatic: Mend the fold after sheep are lost; better late than never
Example: 虽然已经损失了一些钱，但亡羊补牢，还不算太晚。(Although some money was already lost, it's better late than never to take precautions.)

⛰️ CLASSICAL HISTORICAL ALLUSIONS

Famous Historical Stories

183. 卧薪尝胆 wò xīn cháng dǎn
Literal: Sleep firewood taste gall
Idiomatic: Sleep on firewood and taste gall; endure hardship to achieve goal
Example: 他卧薪尝胆，苦练十年，终于在比赛中获得冠军。(He endured hardship and practiced hard for ten years, finally winning the championship.)

184. 负荆请罪 fù jīng qǐng zuì
Literal: Carry thorns request punishment
Idiomatic: Carry rod of thorns to ask punishment; sincerely apologize
Example: 他意识到自己的错误后，负荆请罪，请求原谅。(After realizing his mistake, he sincerely apologized and asked for forgiveness.)

185. 完璧归赵 wán bì guī zhào
Literal: Complete jade return Zhao
Idiomatic: Return the jade intact to Zhao; return something unharmed
Example: 借来的书籍要完璧归赵，不能损坏。(Borrowed books should be returned unharmed without damage.)

186. 愚公移山 yú gōng yí shān
Literal: Foolish old man move mountain
Idiomatic: Persistent effort can overcome any difficulty; determination
Example: 我们要有愚公移山的精神，坚持不懈地努力。(We should have the spirit of the old fool who moved mountains, persisting in our efforts.)

187. 精卫填海 jīng wèi tián hǎi
Literal: Jingwei bird fill sea

Idiomatic: Jingwei trying to fill sea; determined effort despite overwhelming odds
Example: 虽然任务很艰难，但我们要有精卫填海的决心。(Although the task is very difficult, we should have the determination of Jingwei filling the sea.)

188. 夸父逐日 kuā fù zhú rì
Literal: Kuafu chase sun
Idiomatic: Kuafu chasing sun; ambitious but overreaching; quixotic
Example: 他的目标虽然远大，但不要像夸父逐日一样不切实际。(Although his goals are lofty, he shouldn't be unrealistic like Kuafu chasing the sun.)

189. 塞翁失马 sài wēng shī mǎ
Literal: Border old man lose horse
Idiomatic: Old man loses horse; loss may turn out to be gain; blessing in disguise
Example: 虽然这次没有升职，但塞翁失马，也许有更好的机会等着。(Although he didn't get promoted this time, like the old man losing his horse, perhaps better opportunities await.)# Complete Chengyu Master List

Thematic Organization with Pinyin, Translations & Examples

Total: 972 Four-Character Chinese Idioms

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🏆 SUCCESS & ACHIEVEMENT

Outstanding Success and Fame

1. 一鸣惊人 yī míng jīng rén
Literal: One cry startles people
Idiomatic: Become famous overnight; make a stunning debut; spring to fame
Example: 这位年轻歌手在比赛中一鸣惊人，获得了冠军。
(This young singer made a stunning debut in the competition and won first place.)

2. 一举成名 yī jǔ chéng míng
Literal: One action achieves fame
Idiomatic: Become famous in one fell swoop; achieve instant

fame
Example: 他凭借这部电影一举成名，成为家喻户晓的明星。(He became famous overnight through this movie and became a household name.)

3. 功成名就 gōng chéng míng jiù
Literal: Merit accomplished, fame achieved
Idiomatic: Achieve success and fame; successful career
Example: 经过多年努力，他终于功成名就，成为业界的领军人物。(After years of effort, he finally achieved success and fame, becoming a leader in the industry.)

4. 出类拔萃 chū lèi bá cuì
Literal: Emerge from class, stand above others
Idiomatic: Outstanding; exceptionally talented; head and shoulders above others
Example: 她在数学竞赛中出类拔萃，获得了全国第一名。(She stood out exceptionally in the math competition and won first place nationally.)

5. 大功告成 dà gōng gào chéng
Literal: Great merit announced complete
Idiomatic: Great achievement completed successfully; mission accomplished
Example: 工程队经过三年建设，大功告成，新桥正式通车。

(After three years of construction, the engineering team completed their great achievement - the new bridge is officially open to traffic.)

6. 独占鳌头 dú zhàn áo tóu
Literal: Alone occupy the turtle's head
Idiomatic: Take first place; come out on top; lead the pack
Example: 这家公司在行业中独占鳌头，市场份额最大。(This company leads the pack in the industry with the largest market share.)

Near Misses and Setbacks

7. 功败垂成 gōng bài chuí chéng
Literal: Merit fails when hanging complete
Idiomatic: Fail on the verge of success; fall at the last hurdle
Example: 由于资金链断裂，这个项目功败垂成，让人惋惜。(Due to a broken capital chain, this project failed on the verge of success, which is regrettable.)

8. 功亏一篑 gōng kuī yī kuì
Literal: Work lacks one basket
Idiomatic: Fail for want of a final effort; fall short by a small margin
Example: 考试只差一分及格，真是功亏一篑。(Missing the

passing grade by just one point - what a case of failing for want of a final effort.)

9. 前功尽弃 qián gōng jìn qì
Literal: Previous merit all abandoned
Idiomatic: All previous efforts wasted; throw away past achievements
Example: 一次失误让他前功尽弃，不得不重新开始。(One mistake made all his previous efforts go to waste, and he had to start over.)

Complete Failure and Obscurity

10. 默默无闻 mò mò wú wén
Literal: Silent silent without news
Idiomatic: Unknown; obscure; without fame; unsung
Example: 他在这个小镇默默无闻地工作了二十年。(He worked obscurely in this small town for twenty years.)

11. 江郎才尽 jiāng láng cái jìn
Literal: Jiang Lang's talent exhausted
Idiomatic: One's talent exhausted; writer's block; past one's prime
Example: 这位作家近年来作品质量下降，人们担心他江郎才

尽。(This writer's work quality has declined in recent years, and people worry his talent is exhausted.)

12. 无名小卒 wú míng xiǎo zú
Literal: Nameless small soldier
Idiomatic: Nonentity; nobody; insignificant person
Example: 虽然现在只是个无名小卒，但他有远大的理想。(Although he's just a nobody now, he has lofty ideals.)

🧠 WISDOM & INTELLIGENCE

Deep Knowledge and Wisdom

13. 满腹经纶 mǎn fù jīng lún
Literal: Full belly of classics and commentaries
Idiomatic: Well-versed; erudite; full of knowledge; learned scholar
Example: 这位教授满腹经纶，学生们都很尊敬他。(This professor is extremely erudite, and students all respect him.)

14. 博学多识 bó xué duō shí
Literal: Broad learning much knowledge
Idiomatic: Learned and knowledgeable; well-informed; scholarly

Example: 他博学多识，什么问题都能解答。(He is learned and knowledgeable, able to answer any question.)

15. 料事如神 liào shì rú shén
Literal: Predict things like a god
Idiomatic: Prophetic accuracy; prescient; have uncanny foresight
Example: 这位分析师料事如神，他的预测总是很准确。(This analyst predicts things like a god - his forecasts are always accurate.)

16. 深谋远虑 shēn móu yuǎn lǜ
Literal: Deep planning far consideration
Idiomatic: Think deeply and plan far ahead; farsighted; strategic thinking
Example: 一个好的领导者必须深谋远虑，为公司的未来做规划。(A good leader must be farsighted and plan for the company's future.)

17. 见多识广 jiàn duō shí guǎng
Literal: See much know broad
Idiomatic: Well-informed; experienced; worldly-wise
Example: 他走遍世界各地，见多识广，经验丰富。(He has traveled around the world and is well-informed with rich experience.)

18. 慧眼识珠 huì yǎn shí zhū
Literal: Wise eye recognizes pearl
Idiomatic: Have a discerning eye; recognize talent; spot quality
Example: 这位经理慧眼识珠，招聘了很多优秀员工。(This manager has a discerning eye and has recruited many excellent employees.)

Foolishness and Ignorance

19. 不学无术 bù xué wú shù
Literal: No learning no skills
Idiomatic: Without learning or skills; ignorant; uneducated
Example: 他不学无术却自以为是，经常闹笑话。(He is ignorant yet arrogant, often making himself a laughing stock.)

20. 目不识丁 mù bù shí dīng
Literal: Eyes don't recognize the character "ding"
Idiomatic: Cannot read; completely illiterate; unlettered
Example: 在旧社会，很多农民目不识丁，生活很困难。(In the old society, many farmers were completely illiterate and lived very difficult lives.)

21. 井底之蛙 jǐng dǐ zhī wā

Literal: Frog at bottom of well

Idiomatic: Narrow-minded; having limited outlook; provincial

Example: 不要做井底之蛙，要多出去看看外面的世界。(Don't be a frog at the bottom of a well - go out and see more of the world.)

22. 胸无点墨 xiōng wú diǎn mò

Literal: Chest without a dot of ink

Idiomatic: Have no knowledge; completely ignorant; unlettered

Example: 他胸无点墨却装作很有学问的样子。(He has no knowledge yet pretends to be very learned.)

23. 鼠目寸光 shǔ mù cùn guāng

Literal: Mouse eye inch light

Idiomatic: Short-sighted; myopic; lack foresight

Example: 做生意不能鼠目寸光，要有长远眼光。(In business, you can't be short-sighted - you need long-term vision.)

🗣️ COMMUNICATION & SPEECH

Eloquent and Skillful Speech

24. 口若悬河 kǒu ruò xuán hé
Literal: Mouth like hanging river
Idiomatic: Speak eloquently; very articulate; silver-tongued
Example: 这位演说家口若悬河，听众都被他的演讲深深吸引。(This orator speaks like a flowing river, and the audience is deeply attracted to his speech.)

25. 滔滔不绝 tāo tāo bù jué
Literal: Gushing without end
Idiomatic: Talk incessantly; speak in a continuous flow; voluble
Example: 谈到自己的专业，他总是滔滔不绝。(When talking about his specialty, he always speaks incessantly.)

26. 侃侃而谈 kǎn kǎn ér tán
Literal: Speak confidently and calmly
Idiomatic: Speak confidently and fluently; hold forth; expatiate
Example: 在记者会上，他侃侃而谈，回答了所有问题。(At the press conference, he spoke confidently and fluently, answering all questions.)

27. 出口成章 chū kǒu chéng zhāng
Literal: Exit mouth become article
Idiomatic: Speak in perfectly formed sentences; eloquent impromptu speech
Example: 他文学功底深厚，说话出口成章。(His literary foundation is deep, and he speaks in perfectly formed sentences.)

Poor Speech and Silence

28. 三缄其口 sān jiān qí kǒu
Literal: Three seals on mouth
Idiomatic: Keep one's mouth sealed; maintain silence; tight-lipped
Example: 对于公司的机密信息，他总是三缄其口。(Regarding the company's confidential information, he always keeps his mouth sealed.)

29. 噤若寒蝉 jìn ruò hán chán
Literal: Silent as cold cicada
Idiomatic: Too frightened to speak; scared into silence
Example: 面对老板的怒火，员工们都噤若寒蝉。(Faced with the boss's anger, all employees were too frightened to speak.)

30. 笨口拙舌 bèn kǒu zhuō shé

Literal: Clumsy mouth awkward tongue

Idiomatic: Clumsy of speech; inarticulate; tongue-tied

Example: 他平时笨口拙舌，但写文章却很有才华。(He is usually inarticulate in speech, but very talented in writing.)

31. 白费唇舌 bái fèi chún shé

Literal: White waste lips tongue

Idiomatic: Waste one's breath; talk in vain; fall on deaf ears

Example: 劝他别熬夜是白费唇舌，他根本不听。(Advising him not to stay up late is wasting breath - he doesn't listen at all.)

🏃 DILIGENCE & PERSISTENCE

Hard Work and Perseverance

32. 持之以恒 chí zhī yǐ héng

Literal: Hold it with constancy

Idiomatic: Persevere; stick to something consistently; persistent

Example: 学习外语需要持之以恒，不能三天打鱼两天晒网。(Learning a foreign language requires perseverance - you can't be inconsistent.)

33. 坚持不懈 jiān chí bù xiè

Literal: Firmly hold not slack

Idiomatic: Persist unremittingly; never give up; tenacious

Example: 他坚持不懈地练习钢琴，终于成为了音乐家。(He persisted unremittingly in practicing piano and finally became a musician.)

34. 水滴石穿 shuǐ dī shí chuān

Literal: Water drop stone pierce

Idiomatic: Constant dripping wears away stone; persistence conquers all

Example: 只要有水滴石穿的精神，再难的问题也能解决。(With the spirit of constant dripping wearing away stone, even the most difficult problems can be solved.)

35. 磨杵成针 mó chǔ chéng zhēn

Literal: Grind pestle become needle

Idiomatic: Perseverance can accomplish anything; persistence pays off

Example: 学习就像磨杵成针，需要长期的坚持和努力。(Learning is like grinding a rod into a needle - it requires long-term persistence and effort.)

36. 韦编三绝 wéi biān sān jué

Literal: Leather binding three breaks

Idiomatic: Study so hard the book falls apart; extremely studious
Example: 古人韦编三绝的学习精神值得我们学习。(The ancients' spirit of studying so hard their books fell apart is worth learning from.)

37. 勤能补拙 qín néng bǔ zhuō
Literal: Diligence can supplement clumsiness
Idiomatic: Hard work can make up for lack of talent; practice makes perfect
Example: 虽然天赋不高，但勤能补拙，他通过努力获得成功。(Although not highly talented, hard work can make up for it - he achieved success through effort.)

Laziness and Giving Up

38. 半途而废 bàn tú ér fèi
Literal: Half way then abandon
Idiomatic: Give up halfway; abandon something unfinished; quit midstream
Example: 做事不能半途而废，要有始有终。(Don't give up halfway when doing things - see them through to the end.)

39. 虎头蛇尾 hǔ tóu shé wěi
Literal: Tiger head snake tail

Idiomatic: Start strong but finish weak; begin well but end badly
Example: 他做事总是虎头蛇尾，缺乏持久力。(He always starts strong but finishes weak when doing things, lacking endurance.)

40. 萎靡不振 wěi mǐ bù zhèn
Literal: Withered dispirited not energetic
Idiomatic: Dispirited; listless; lacking energy; dejected
Example: 失业后他变得萎靡不振，整天待在家里。(After losing his job, he became dispirited and stayed home all day.)

🤝 RELATIONSHIPS & SOCIAL BONDS

Strong Friendships and Loyalty

41. 志同道合 zhì tóng dào hé
Literal: Ambitions same path together
Idiomatic: Share the same aspirations; like-minded; kindred spirits
Example: 我们是志同道合的朋友，经常一起讨论学术问题。(We are like-minded friends who often discuss academic issues together.)

42. 情同手足 qíng tóng shǒu zú
Literal: Feeling same as hands feet
Idiomatic: Close as brothers; intimate friendship; thick as thieves
Example: 他们从小一起长大，情同手足。(They grew up together and are close as brothers.)

43. 如鱼得水 rú yú dé shuǐ
Literal: Like fish get water
Idiomatic: In one's element; perfectly suited; feel at home
Example: 他在新工作中如鱼得水，发挥得很好。(He is like a fish in water in his new job, performing very well.)

44. 相得益彰 xiāng dé yì zhāng
Literal: Mutually get benefit manifest
Idiomatic: Complement each other; mutually beneficial; synergistic
Example: 他们两人的合作相得益彰，创造了很好的业绩。(Their collaboration complements each other and has created excellent results.)

45. 同甘共苦 tóng gān gòng kǔ
Literal: Same sweet together bitter
Idiomatic: Share joys and sorrows; through thick and thin
Example: 夫妻应该同甘共苦，不能只享福不吃苦。(Married

couples should share joys and sorrows, not just enjoy the good times without enduring hardships.)

46. 生死与共 shēng sǐ yǔ gòng
Literal: Life death together share
Idiomatic: Share life and death; devoted unto death; ride or die
Example: 战友们在战场上生死与共，建立了深厚友谊。(Comrades share life and death on the battlefield, building deep friendship.)

Bad Company and Betrayal

47. 狐朋狗友 hú péng gǒu yǒu
Literal: Fox friends dog companions
Idiomatic: Bad company; fair-weather friends; unsavory associates
Example: 他交了一些狐朋狗友，经常一起做坏事。(He made some bad friends and often does bad things together with them.)

48. 狼狈为奸 láng bèi wéi jiān
Literal: Wolf accomplice act evil
Idiomatic: Work hand in glove; collude in evil; partners in crime

Example: 这两个贪官狼狈为奸，贪污了大量公款。(These two corrupt officials colluded in evil and embezzled a large amount of public funds.)

49. 兔死狗烹 tù sǐ gǒu pēng
Literal: Rabbit dies dog cooked
Idiomatic: Discard someone after they've served their purpose; dispose of allies
Example: 历史上有很多功臣最后都兔死狗烹，结局悲惨。(Throughout history, many heroes ended up being discarded after serving their purpose, meeting tragic ends.)

50. 过河拆桥 guò hé chāi qiáo
Literal: Cross river tear down bridge
Idiomatic: Abandon someone who helped you; burn bridges; ungrateful
Example: 他成功后就过河拆桥，忘记了帮助过他的人。(After his success, he tore down the bridge after crossing, forgetting those who had helped him.)

51. 忘恩负义 wàng ēn fù yì
Literal: Forget grace betray righteousness
Idiomatic: Ungrateful; bite the hand that feeds; treacherous
Example: 他忘恩负义，背叛了曾经帮助他的老师。(He was

ungrateful and betrayed the teacher who had once helped him.)

⚔️ COURAGE & COWARDICE

Bravery and Heroism

52. 浑身是胆 hún shēn shì dǎn
Literal: Whole body is courage
Idiomatic: Full of courage; fearless throughout; extraordinarily brave
Example: 面对敌人，这位战士浑身是胆，毫不退缩。(Facing the enemy, this soldier was fearless throughout and did not retreat at all.)

53. 破釜沉舟 pò fǔ chén zhōu
Literal: Break cauldron sink boat
Idiomatic: Burn one's bridges; fight with determination; point of no return
Example: 他破釜沉舟，辞去了稳定的工作去创业。(He burned his bridges, quit his stable job to start a business.)

54. 背水一战 bèi shuǐ yī zhàn
Literal: Back water one battle

Idiomatic: Fight with one's back to the wall; fight desperately; last stand
Example: 面对强大的竞争对手，小公司只能背水一战。(Facing powerful competitors, the small company can only fight desperately.)

55. 一往无前 yī wǎng wú qián
Literal: One go without front
Idiomatic: Press forward courageously; advance without fear; unstoppable
Example: 解放军战士一往无前，攻克了敌人的堡垒。(The PLA soldiers pressed forward courageously and captured the enemy's fortress.)

56. 赴汤蹈火 fù tāng dǎo huǒ
Literal: Go boiling water step fire
Idiomatic: Go through fire and water; brave any danger; fearless sacrifice
Example: 为了救人，消防员赴汤蹈火，不怕危险。(To save people, firefighters go through fire and water, unafraid of danger.)

Fear and Cowardice

57. 草木皆兵 cǎo mù jiē bīng

Literal: Grass trees all soldiers
Idiomatic: Extremely paranoid; see enemies everywhere; jumpy
Example: 做贼心虚的他总是草木皆兵，一有风吹草动就紧张。(Having a guilty conscience, he is always paranoid - getting nervous at the slightest disturbance.)

58. 杯弓蛇影 bēi gōng shé yǐng
Literal: Cup bow snake shadow
Idiomatic: Be overly suspicious; paranoid; jump at shadows
Example: 不要杯弓蛇影，他的话没有恶意。(Don't be overly suspicious - his words have no malicious intent.)

59. 惊弓之鸟 jīng gōng zhī niǎo
Literal: Startled bow's bird
Idiomatic: Overly fearful person; jumpy; easily frightened
Example: 经历过车祸后，他成了惊弓之鸟，不敢再开车。(After experiencing a car accident, he became like a bird startled by a bow and dared not drive again.)

60. 抱头鼠窜 bào tóu shǔ cuàn
Literal: Hold head mouse scurry
Idiomatic: Flee in panic; run away like rats; shameful retreat
Example: 敌军被打败后抱头鼠窜，四散逃跑。(After being

defeated, the enemy army fled in panic, scattering in all directions.)

🎯 PLANNING & STRATEGY

Excellent Planning

61. 运筹帷幄 yùn chóu wéi wò
Literal: Plan strategies tent
Idiomatic: Devise strategies within command tent; mastermind; strategic planning
Example: 这位将军运筹帷幄，制定了完美的作战计划。(This general masterminded the situation and devised a perfect battle plan.)

62. 未雨绸缪 wèi yǔ chóu móu
Literal: Before rain bind windows
Idiomatic: Prepare for a rainy day; take precautions beforehand; preventive planning
Example: 我们应该未雨绸缪，为可能出现的问题做准备。(We should prepare for a rainy day and get ready for possible problems.)

63. 深思熟虑 shēn sī shú lǜ
Literal: Deep think ripe consideration
Idiomatic: Think carefully; deliberate thoroughly; well-considered
Example: 这个决定需要深思熟虑，不能匆忙行事。(This decision needs careful consideration and cannot be made hastily.)

64. 防患未然 fáng huàn wèi rán
Literal: Prevent trouble before it happens
Idiomatic: Prevent problems before they occur; nip in the bud
Example: 定期检查设备可以防患未然，避免意外事故。(Regular equipment inspections can prevent problems before they occur, avoiding accidents.)

65. 步步为营 bù bù wéi yíng
Literal: Step step make camp
Idiomatic: Advance step by step; proceed cautiously; methodical progress
Example: 在商业扩张中，他们步步为营，稳扎稳打。(In business expansion, they advance step by step with steady progress.)

Poor Planning and Hasty Decisions

66. 临时抱佛脚 lín shí bào fó jiǎo
Literal: Last minute embrace Buddha's feet
Idiomatic: Seek help at the last moment; cram; last-minute effort
Example: 平时不努力学习，考试前临时抱佛脚是没用的。(Not studying hard normally and then seeking help at the last moment before exams is useless.)

67. 临渴掘井 lín kě jué jǐng
Literal: Facing thirst dig well
Idiomatic: Too late for preparation; act only when crisis hits
Example: 现在才开始准备材料，这不是临渴掘井吗? (Starting to prepare materials only now - isn't this digging a well when thirsty?)

68. 守株待兔 shǒu zhū dài tù
Literal: Guard tree stump wait rabbit
Idiomatic: Rely on luck rather than effort; passive waiting
Example: 成功不能靠守株待兔，需要主动努力。(Success cannot rely on waiting by the tree stump for rabbits - it requires active effort.)

69. 急功近利 jí gōng jìn lì

Literal: Urgent merit near profit

Idiomatic: Eager for quick success; short-sighted gains

Example: 做生意不能急功近利，要有长远眼光。(In business, you can't be eager for quick success - you need long-term vision.)

🌱 CHANGE & TRANSFORMATION

Positive Change and Adaptation

70. 随机应变 suí jī yìng biàn

Literal: Follow opportunity respond change

Idiomatic: Act according to circumstances; adapt flexibly; improvise

Example: 做生意要学会随机应变，根据市场变化调整策略。(In business, one must learn to adapt flexibly and adjust strategies according to market changes.)

71. 因地制宜 yīn dì zhì yí

Literal: According place establish suitable

Idiomatic: Adapt to local conditions; tailor to circumstances

Example: 农业发展要因地制宜，选择适合当地的作物。

(Agricultural development should adapt to local conditions and choose crops suitable for the area.)

72. 改邪归正 gǎi xié guī zhèng
Literal: Change evil return correct
Idiomatic: Turn over a new leaf; reform oneself; mend one's ways
Example: 他决定改邪归正，重新做人。(He decided to turn over a new leaf and start anew.)

73. 推陈出新 tuī chén chū xīn
Literal: Push old bring forth new
Idiomatic: Innovate; bring forth new ideas; modernize
Example: 这家公司善于推陈出新，产品总是领先市场。(This company is good at innovation, and their products always lead the market.)

74. 脱胎换骨 tuō tāi huàn gǔ
Literal: Shed fetus change bones
Idiomatic: Completely transform; undergo radical change; reborn
Example: 经过培训后，他脱胎换骨，工作能力大大提高。(After training, he was completely transformed with greatly improved work abilities.)

Resistance to Change

75. 墨守成规 mò shǒu chéng guī
Literal: Ink guard established rules
Idiomatic: Stick to old rules; be conservative; hidebound
Example: 在科技发展快速的时代，不能墨守成规。(In an era of rapid technological development, we cannot stick to old rules.)

76. 因循守旧 yīn xún shǒu jiù
Literal: Follow old practice guard old
Idiomatic: Follow old practices; resist change; traditionalist
Example: 管理者不能因循守旧，要勇于创新。(Managers cannot follow old practices - they must be brave enough to innovate.)

77. 固步自封 gù bù zì fēng
Literal: Firm steps self seal
Idiomatic: Be complacent and conservative; refuse progress; stagnant
Example: 企业不能固步自封，要不断学习新技术。(Enterprises cannot be complacent and conservative - they must continuously learn new technologies.)

78. 刚愎自用 gāng bì zì yòng

Literal: Stubborn self-willed self use

Idiomatic: Stubborn and self-opinionated; headstrong; obstinate

Example: 他太刚愎自用，从不听别人的建议。(He is too stubborn and self-opinionated, never listening to others' suggestions.)

⚖️ JUSTICE & MORALITY

Righteousness and Integrity

79. 大义灭亲 dà yì miè qīn

Literal: Great righteousness destroy relatives

Idiomatic: Put righteousness before family loyalty; justice over kinship

Example: 法官大义灭亲，判决了自己的儿子。(The judge put righteousness before family loyalty and sentenced his own son.)

80. 铁面无私 tiě miàn wú sī

Literal: Iron face without selfishness

Idiomatic: Impartial; upright; incorruptible judge

Example: 这位法官铁面无私，从不徇私枉法。(This judge is impartial and never perverts justice for personal gain.)

81. 奉公守法 fèng gōng shǒu fǎ
Literal: Serve public observe law
Idiomatic: Serve the public and obey the law; law-abiding citizen
Example: 每个公民都应该奉公守法，为社会做贡献。(Every citizen should serve the public and obey the law, contributing to society.)

82. 光明磊落 guāng míng lěi luò
Literal: Light bright open frank
Idiomatic: Honest and straightforward; above board; transparent
Example: 他做事光明磊落，从不搞阴谋诡计。(He acts honestly and straightforwardly, never engaging in conspiracies.)

83. 两袖清风 liǎng xiù qīng fēng
Literal: Two sleeves clean wind
Idiomatic: Incorruptible official; honest poverty; clean hands
Example: 这位官员两袖清风，深受人民爱戴。(This official is incorruptible and deeply loved by the people.)

Corruption and Injustice

84. 大逆不道 dà nì bù dào
Literal: Great rebellion not道
Idiomatic: Rebel against moral principles; extremely unethical; treasonous
Example: 子女虐待父母是大逆不道的行为。(Children abusing their parents is behavior that rebels against moral principles.)

85. 任人唯亲 rèn rén wéi qīn
Literal: Appoint people only relatives
Idiomatic: Practice nepotism; appoint people by favoritism
Example: 这个公司任人唯亲，很多重要职位都是老板的亲戚。(This company practices nepotism - many important positions are held by the boss's relatives.)

86. 为虎作伥 wèi hǔ zuò chāng
Literal: For tiger act accomplice
Idiomatic: Help a tyrant do evil; act as accomplice; enable wrongdoing
Example: 那些贪官的手下为虎作伥，一起贪污公款。(The subordinates of those corrupt officials act as accomplices, embezzling public funds together.)

87. **助纣为虐** zhù zhòu wéi nüè

Literal: Help Tyrant Zhou do cruel things

Idiomatic: Help a tyrant in his tyranny; aid and abet evil

Example: 我们不能助纣为虐，应该制止不法行为。(We cannot help tyrants in their tyranny - we should stop illegal behavior.)

📚 LEARNING & KNOWLEDGE

Love of Learning

88. **手不释卷** shǒu bù shì juàn

Literal: Hand not release scroll

Idiomatic: Never put down one's book; always reading; bookworm

Example: 他手不释卷，是个真正的书迷。(He never puts down his book - he's a true bookworm.)

89. **学而不厌** xué ér bù yàn

Literal: Learn and not tire

Idiomatic: Never tire of learning; lifelong learner

Example: 活到老学到老，我们应该学而不厌。(Learn till old age - we should never tire of learning.)

90. 开卷有益 kāi juàn yǒu yì
Literal: Open book have benefit
Idiomatic: Reading is always beneficial; knowledge is power
Example: 多读书总是好的，开卷有益嘛。(Reading more is always good - reading is always beneficial.)

91. 不耻下问 bù chǐ xià wèn
Literal: Not shame lower ask
Idiomatic: Not ashamed to ask inferiors; humble in learning
Example: 孔子说："不耻下问，是为了求知。"(Confucius said: "Not being ashamed to ask questions is for the sake of seeking knowledge.")

92. 闻鸡起舞 wén jī qǐ wǔ
Literal: Hear rooster rise dance
Idiomatic: Rise with the rooster to practice; diligent study
Example: 他每天闻鸡起舞，练习剑法。(He rises with the rooster every day to practice swordsmanship.)

93. 囊萤映雪 náng yíng yìng xuě
Literal: Bag fireflies reflect snow
Idiomatic: Study by firelight and snow reflection; very studious despite poverty
Example: 古人囊萤映雪的求学精神值得学习。(The ancients' spirit of studying by firelight is worth learning from.)

Superficial Learning

94. 不求甚解 bù qiú shèn jiě

Literal: Not seek deep understanding

Idiomatic: Not seek thorough understanding; superficial learning

Example: 读书不能不求甚解，要深入思考。(Reading cannot be superficial - we must think deeply.)

95. 一知半解 yī zhī bàn jiě

Literal: One know half understand

Idiomatic: Smattering of knowledge; superficial understanding

Example: 他对这个问题只是一知半解，不够深入。(He only has a superficial understanding of this issue, not deep enough.)

96. 囫囵吞枣 hú lún tūn zǎo

Literal: Whole swallow dates

Idiomatic: Swallow whole without chewing; accept uncritically

Example: 学习不能囫囵吞枣，要仔细消化理解。(Learning cannot be like swallowing dates whole - we must carefully digest and understand.)

🎭 APPEARANCE & REALITY

Authenticity and Truth

97. 名副其实 míng fù qí shí
Literal: Name matches reality
Idiomatic: Deserve the name; live up to reputation; genuine
Example: 他是名副其实的专家，在这个领域很有权威。(He is an expert who deserves the name and has great authority in this field.)

98. 言行一致 yán xíng yī zhì
Literal: Words actions consistent
Idiomatic: Words match deeds; practice what one preaches
Example: 一个好的领导者应该言行一致。(A good leader should practice what they preach.)

99. 实事求是 shí shì qiú shì
Literal: Real things seek truth
Idiomatic: Seek truth from facts; realistic; pragmatic
Example: 我们要实事求是，根据实际情况制定计划。(We should seek truth from facts and make plans based on actual conditions.)

Deception and False Appearances

100. 口是心非 kǒu shì xīn fēi

Literal: Mouth right heart wrong

Idiomatic: Say one thing but mean another; duplicitous; hypocritical

Example: 他总是口是心非，让人很难相信。(He always says one thing but means another, making it hard for people to trust him.)